When Governments Look Away: Extremist Violence in the West Bank*

This Version: October 31, 2026

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Abstract

Why do capable governments tolerate extremist violence? I develop a formal theory of institutional forbearance: when independently initiated violence advances objectives governments partly share, the gains from tolerance can outweigh the costs of non-enforcement. Anticipated leniency then weakens deterrence and encourages further violence. I test the argument in the West Bank following Trump's unexpected 2016 election, a shock external to local conflict dynamics. Reduced U.S. opposition to Israeli settlement expansion facilitated settlement approvals and the growth of outposts—unauthorized settlements. This lowered the government's costs of tolerance and radical settlers' expected punishment. Using difference-in-differences and predetermined suitability for outposts, I find persistent increases in settler violence where expansion is feasible. The differential increase exceeds six times these locations' pre-election mean. Consistent with forbearance, new outposts concentrate in the same areas and governing politicians' responses reveal weak demands to punish settler violence. These findings provide evidence on politically motivated selective enforcement.

Keywords: Political violence, institutional forbearance, settler violence, Israeli-Palestinian conflict, diplomatic shocks, difference-in-differences
Word count: 11,409

*I am grateful to Marco Di Cataldo, Giovanni Mastrobuoni, Juan Vargas, Livia Schubiger, Paolo Buonanno, Ruben Durante, Belal Fallah, Sergi Martínez, Jonathan Elkobi, Francisco Tomás-Valiente Jordá and Luca Scotti for helpful comments and discussions. I also thank Jana Kissling, my discussant at the Zurich Political Economy Seminar Series (ZPESS), and conference and seminar participants at the European Public Choice Society (EPCS), the IRDS and ICR research groups at ETH Zürich, the London School of Economics, the Political Economy Workshop at Università Cattolica, and Sapienza University of Rome for valuable feedback. I owe a particular debt to Dror Etkes for the time he generously devoted to this project and for the data he shared. I also thank Miguel Bello Escibano for excellent research assistance. Finally, this research project would not have been possible without the work of Peace Now, B'Tselem, Yesh Din, and Kerem Navot. All remaining errors are my own.

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Introduction

The standard explanation for why states fail to restrain violent non-state actors is that they cannot: the state lacks the capacity to police its territory, and violence fills the vacuum (Fearon and Laitin, 2003; Migdal, 1988; Herbst, 2000). Yet enforcement also fails where capacity is abundant, and existing work explains such tolerance mainly through organization and exchange: governments delegate violence to militias and armed auxiliaries to obtain information, manpower, and deniability (Carey et al., 2013; Jentzsch et al., 2015); tolerate paramilitaries in exchange for electoral or security benefits (Acemoglu et al., 2013); strike wartime bargains with insurgent organizations (Staniland, 2012) or calibrate repression in ongoing confrontations with criminal groups (Lessing, 2015, 2018). In these accounts the state's benefit mostly runs through an organizational tie to the perpetrators: command, a bargain, or an exchange.

Some episodes fit neither account. In Bolsonaro-era Brazil, permissive environmental politics coincided with Amazon land grabbing (Caetano, 2021; Nunes et al., 2024); in BJP-era India, cow-protection politics accompanied vigilante violence against Muslims and Dalits (Human Rights Watch, 2019; Maskara, 2021). In these cases capacity is not the binding constraint, and the perpetrators are not state agents or formal militias. They are private actors whose violence advances objectives that political elites might share. The question is therefore why a government with extensive coercive and administrative authority enforces the law selectively, that is, why it looks away.

This paper's answer is *institutional forbearance*, a term I borrow from Holland (2016). When privately initiated violence advances objectives the government partly shares, authorities can benefit from it without directing or organizing it, simply by choosing how strongly to enforce the law against its perpetrators. The mechanism requires neither delegation nor a bargain. Non-state actors, or *aligned actors*, weigh the expected returns to violence against the punishment they expect to face, and enforcement sets that punishment. The government, in turn, weighs the gains it values against the legal, diplomatic, and domestic costs of tolerating them. The Theoretical Framework section formalizes this trade-off and derives two predictions. First, a shock that weakens the constraints on forbearance lowers the cost of tolerance and raises violence. Second, the increase is larger where violence can produce larger territorial or political gains, because tolerance is then worth more both to the actors who use violence and to a government that partly values what it produces. A dynamic extension lets tolerated violence build a political

leverage of its beneficiaries, so that also temporary shock can leave violence persistently higher (Appendix F).

The West Bank offers a setting in which the actors are aligned and capacity is not the constraint. Israeli authority in the territory is extensive, and the relevant actors are radical settlers associated with unauthorized outposts, sites established without the official approvals (Supreme Court of Israel, sitting as the High Court of Justice, 2014, 2011; Kurtzer, 2016).[1] Their expansion creates facts on the ground that Israeli governments have often valued.[2] The setting also holds the other ingredients of the model fixed, which is what makes the shock informative: the same Netanyahu government held office from 2015 through 2019, settlers' aims did not change, and the geography that determines where expansion is feasible is predetermined. What changed was the external cost of tolerance. Donald Trump's unexpected election in November 2016 marked a reversal in the U.S. stance on the West Bank: the Obama administration's opposition to settlement expansion gave way, from the inauguration onward, to a sequence of increasingly explicit signals of support, culminating in the recognition of Jerusalem as Israel's capital in December 2017. The Background section describes this sequence.

Testing the predictions requires a measure of where encroachment could produce gains that does not depend on where outposts were later placed. Outposts emerge where geography, land access, and proximity to the settler network make encroachment feasible, features that may independently shape violence, and their placement after 2016 is itself an outcome of the forbearance under study. I therefore estimate a model of outpost expansion on pre-Trump data alone (1990–2016) and use its fitted values as a pre-determined measure of suitability. I then compare the monthly evolution of geo-referenced violent events across a fine hexagonal grid between cells with high and low suitability. I use an event-study design and a TWFE regression centered on the election to trace the dynamic response through the inauguration, the Jerusalem Declaration, and later events.

[1] "Authorized" throughout means authorized within that Israeli-administered regime, not lawful under international law. The ICJ, the UN General Assembly, and the UN Security Council regard the West Bank, including East Jerusalem, as occupied and Israeli settlement policy as contrary to Article 49(6) of the Fourth Geneva Convention (International Court of Justice, 2024; International Committee of the Red Cross, 2024; United Nations Security Council, 2016); Israel disputes both (Ministry of Foreign Affairs, State of Israel, 2015). Israel's Supreme Court applies the law of belligerent occupation to the military commander but has generally avoided ruling on the legality of settlements as a class (Supreme Court of Israel, sitting as the High Court of Justice, 2005).

[2] Weymouth (2013); Reuters (2015); Heilman (2015); Israel Hayom (2017)

The empirical findings are consistent with the model's predictions. After the Declaration, the treated–control gap in monthly settler attacks widens to more than six times the pre-election level of attacks in high-suitability cells. The timing follows the shock in steps: settler violence against Palestinians does not rise at the election, the gap starts to widen at the inauguration in January 2017, and it breaks sharply in January 2018, one month after the Declaration. There is no reversal in the pattern, with violence remaining elevated through 2023. A structural-break procedure that estimates break dates from the same violence data, without imposing the political calendar, recovers the same sequence: a modest break in April 2017, the main escalation in January 2018, and no comparable break in Palestinian violence against settlers until 2022. Consistent with the model's second prediction, the increase concentrates at the outpost frontier rather than near established settlements in general, and survives conditioning flexibly on where outposts already stood in 2016. Palestinian violence against settlers on the other hand shows the opposite pattern and follows existing outposts.

Two further pieces of evidence are consistent with forbearance. First, new outposts proliferate after the Trump-era shift, and the same event-study design shows that they appear disproportionately in the high-opportunity locations where violence rises; because the state retains the capacity to remove outposts, those left standing reveal its tolerance. That capacity is exercised nearby. The Civil Administration, the same authority that left the outposts standing, demolished Palestinian homes and structures built without permits a few kilometres away, continuously after 2016 and at a rising pace from 2020: for 75% of the outposts founded in 2017–2023, a Palestinian structure was demolished in a community within 5 km in the twelve months after the founding date. Within Area C, what the same administrative authority demolishes and what it leaves standing is a choice. Second, descriptively, recorded confrontations between settlers and the Israeli security apparatus do not scale with the increase in settler violence.

I also examine Knesset speeches from 2016–2023 and show that right-wing blocs condemn killings far more readily when the perpetrators are Palestinians than when they are settlers. An incident-level comparison of the same governing politicians in 2014–2019 also documents weaker public demands for accountability after the shift and interventions on behalf of suspects. Together with the outpost and enforcement evidence, these findings are consistent with forbearance under weak domestic constraints and reduced U.S. pressure. They support the enforcement channel indirectly: the reduced-form estimates identify where and when violence responded to the shift, rather than the enforcement

decisions behind it.

The paper contributes to the literature on non-state violence by identifying a distinct way governments can benefit from privately initiated violence without organizing it. Existing work shows that political incentives shape whether governments protect civilians from communal violence (Wilkinson, 2004; Nellis et al., 2016), and that governments may tolerate or cooperate with organized armed groups that provide electoral, military, or political benefits (Acemoglu et al., 2013; Staniland, 2015; Dube and Naidu, 2015). The mechanism here is different. Aligned actors pursue their own ideological objectives and initiate violence independently. Such alignment does not require loyalty to the government: radical settlers associated with the hilltop youth have rejected the authority of both the Israeli state and the established settler leadership (Eiran and Krause, 2018; Levizky and Benziman, 2024). Furthermore, political authorities need neither mobilize them through propaganda (Yanagizawa-Drott, 2014) nor bargain or reach accommodations with them to benefit from the outcomes they produce (Staniland, 2012).[3] Their instrument is enforcement itself. By deciding how costly privately initiated violence will be, governments can encourage or restrain actions that advance objectives they partly share while remaining formally separate from those who carry them out. Extending Holland (2016), the object of non-enforcement is not informal redistribution but violence and encroachment: looking away changes the expected price of violent action. The paper shows theoretically and empirically when this form of indirect political support becomes consequential, that is when the outcomes produced by aligned violence are sufficiently valuable to political authorities.

The argument also relates to research on elite signaling and norm erosion. Political shocks can change behavior by altering the social sanctions attached to previously stigmatized views and actions (Bursztyn et al., 2020; Giani and Méon, 2021; Müller and Schwarz, 2023; Albornoz et al., 2022; Alvarez-Benjumea and Valentim, 2024). This paper points to a different sanctioning institution. When the relevant behavior is illegal, political authorities themselves determine an important component of its expected cost through enforcement. Political change can therefore affect private behavior not only by changing what others are willing to condone (Bursztyn et al., 2020; Giani and Méon,

[3]This characterization applies primarily to the period studied here. Since the coalition formed at the end of December 2022, and especially after the events of October 7 2023, the boundary between state and settler violence has become increasingly blurred (Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights, 2023).

2021), but also by changing what the state is willing to punish. The contribution here is to study this latter margin in a setting where private actors' actions can themselves advance objectives valued by political authorities.

Finally, the paper offers a new lens on the Israeli-Palestinian conflict, where empirical work has focused on the strategic behavior of recognized actors or the economic effects of occupation (Durante and Zhuravskaya, 2018; Calì and Miaari, 2018; Adnan, 2015). The closest work studies the other side of the same interactions: how exposure to settler hostilities and outposts shapes Palestinian political attitudes (Wayne et al., 2026), building on research on violence and attitudes among Palestinians and Israelis (Jaeger et al., 2012; Berrebi and Klor, 2008; Getmansky and Zeitzoff, 2014; Hirsch-Hoefler et al., 2016; Freedman and Klor, 2023). This paper asks instead what triggers the violence on the Israeli side. It does so by assembling a novel fine-grained spatial dataset that combines geo-referenced violent events, comprehensive mappings of Israeli settlements, outposts, and Palestinian communities, satellite-based detection of outpost emergence, Knesset parliamentary speeches, and an incident-level record of political responses to settler violence.

The next section presents the model, followed by the background, the data and methodology, the baseline results and their timing, the geography of activation, outpost expansion and the enforcement environment, robustness checks, and the conclusion.

Theoretical Framework

This section develops a model of enforcement forbearance from which the paper's empirical predictions derive. I adapt Holland (2016)'s concept of *forbearance*: intentional and revocable non-enforcement, in which the state retains the capacity to sanction a legal violation but chooses not to do so. As in Holland (2016), non-enforcement is therefore a political choice rather than evidence of limited state capacity. The difference lies in what makes that choice valuable. Holland (2016) studies forbearance as distributive policy, through which politicians tolerate illegal activity in order to benefit constituencies and obtain electoral support or rents. Here, the government instead partially values the political gains generated by non-state actors' actions. The model formalizes the interaction between private actors' incentives, government enforcement decisions, and

the political and institutional constraints on forbearance.[4]

Primitives and payoffs Consider locations indexed by $i = 1, \ldots, N$. In each location, a radical non-state actor chooses violence $v_i \geq 0$. A government or political executive chooses local enforcement or forbearance, $f_i \in [0, 1]$, where $f_i = 0$ denotes full enforcement and $f_i = 1$ full tolerance. Under full enforcement, radical actors face the full expected punishment cost. More generally, f_i captures the permissiveness of the enforcement environment faced by the actor, including expected intervention, prosecution, or other sanctions. In the empirical analysis, this is the latent enforcement margin the supporting evidence seeks to characterize. The political and institutional environment is summarized by S. Higher values of S correspond to weaker scrutiny: a more permissive environment in which tolerance carries lower diplomatic, legal, political, or institutional costs.

Each location has local opportunity $E_i \geq 0$, which captures the extent to which violence can produce strategic gains in location i. The strategic return to violence is $\pi(E_i)$, with $\pi(E_i) \geq 0$ and $\pi_E(E_i) > 0$. Thus, violence is more productive in high-opportunity locations. In the empirical analysis, E_i is proxied by an estimate of the geographic scope for territorial expansion, $\hat{E}_i$.[5] Forbearance determines how much of this local opportunity the radical actor can exploit.

Given f_i, the radical actor chooses violence to maximize

$$U_i^R(v_i; f_i) = [r_i + f_i \pi(E_i) - (1 - f_i)L]\, v_i - K_i(v_i),$$

where r_i is the actor's intrinsic return to violence, $L > 0$ is the punishment or enforcement cost under full enforcement, and $K_i(v_i)$ is a strictly convex private cost of violence.

The government partially internalizes the political or territorial gains generated by radical action. This is summarized by $\lambda \in [0, 1]$, which captures the extent to which the government values gains produced through violence by aligned non-state actors. I treat λ as fixed with respect to S, so changes in permissiveness operate through the cost of tolerating radical action rather than through government preferences. For any induced level of violence v_i, the government's local payoff is

[4] Extending the framework to non-aligned actors, against whom the state may use direct force, is beyond the scope of the paper.

[5] More on this in the Methodology section.

$$U_i^G(f_i, v_i; S) = \lambda f_i \pi(E_i) v_i - C_i(f_i, v_i; S).$$

The term $f_i\pi(E_i)v_i$ is realized violent output and λ the extent to which the government values these gains.[6] The cost function $C_i(f_i, v_i; S)$ collects the legal, diplomatic, institutional, and public-order costs of tolerating radical violence. I assume $C_i^f(f_i, v_i; S) \geq 0$, with strict inequality for $f_i > 0$, and $C_i^v(f_i, v_i; S) \geq 0$. Weaker political constraints lower the relevant marginal costs, so $C_i^{fS}(f_i, v_i; S) \leq 0$ and $C_i^{vS}(f_i, v_i; S) \leq 0$.[7] Thus, a higher S lowers the marginal cost of tolerating radical action. The cost function bundles constraints of different origin, including domestic accountability pressures, such as parliamentary scrutiny, electoral backlash, judicial oversight, and media attention, as well as external diplomatic pressure. The empirical analysis considers evidence on both margins.

Timing and equilibrium The game unfolds sequentially. First, S is realized. Second, the government chooses local forbearance f_i. Third, the radical actor observes f_i and chooses violence v_i. Forbearance is an observable enforcement stance that remains operative while the actor acts. I solve the model by backward induction.

The radical actor is inactive when the net marginal payoff from violence is too low. On the active branch, i.e. $v_i^* > 0$, the best response satisfies

$$v_i^*(f_i) = (K_i')^{-1}\left(r_i - L + f_i[\pi(E_i) + L]\right).$$

Thus, forbearance increases violence because it lowers expected punishment and allows radical actors to exploit local opportunity. On the active branch, the radical actor's best response is increasing in f_i.

Anticipating this best response, the government chooses f_i to solve

$$f_i^* \in \arg\max_{f_i \in [0,1]} \left\{\lambda f_i \pi(E_i) v_i^*(f_i) - C_i\left(f_i, v_i^*(f_i); S\right)\right\}.$$

At an interior optimum, the government balances the additional political gains from radical action against the additional costs of tolerating it. A more permissive political environment lowers the relevant marginal costs, making greater forbearance more attractive. This response operates through enforcement rather than through changes in actors'

[6] When $\lambda = 0$, the government derives no benefit from these gains.

[7] At least one inequality is strict in the relevant interior region.

underlying preferences or in the government's valuation of their political goals.[8] An important feature of this model is that enforcement can shape behavior through sanctions that remain off the equilibrium path: when anticipated punishment deters an offense, neither the offense nor its punishment is observed. In other words, low levels of observed punishment can therefore reflect either effective deterrence or extensive forbearance. The framework delivers two main empirical predictions.

Prediction 1: Political permissiveness increases violence. Weaker political constraints on forbearance lower the marginal cost of non-enforcement. In schematic form,

$$S \uparrow \quad \Rightarrow \quad \text{marginal cost of forbearance} \downarrow \quad \Rightarrow \quad f_i^* \uparrow \quad \Rightarrow \quad v_i^* \uparrow .$$

The government tolerates more radical action, and radical actors respond by increasing violence.

Prediction 2: Effects are stronger in high-opportunity locations. Other things equal, greater permissiveness should have its largest effects where violence can generate larger strategic gains. On the active branch,

$$\frac{\partial v_i^*}{\partial f_i} = \frac{\pi(E_i) + L}{K_i''(v_i^*)}.$$

Higher E_i raises the potential gains from a relaxation in enforcement through $\pi(E_i)$. It can also lower the level of forbearance required for violence to become privately worthwhile. Under the conditions stated in Appendix F, higher opportunity therefore facilitates activation and amplifies the response once actors are active.[9] Empirically, this predicts a larger increase in violence where the scope for territorial expansion is greater.

Dynamic extension The static model explains the activation of violence but does not let violence reshape the environment in which enforcement decisions are made. In Appendix F I endogenize part of that environment by allowing tolerated violence that produces material gains to increase leverage over the institutions governing future enforcement. This creates a feedback: weaker constraints raise forbearance and violence today, and tolerated violence weakens those constraints tomorrow. A temporary shock can therefore leave forbearance and violence elevated after external conditions revert and,

[8] Lemma 1 in Appendix F establishes global monotonicity; the appendix also provides a stylized numerical illustration.

[9] The ranking holds locally at active interior equilibria under quadratic private costs and the government-response complementarity condition in Appendix F.

when the feedback is strong enough, push the system past a threshold beyond which the political environment remains more permissive. Non-enforcement remains revocable, but the political conditions governing whether that capacity is exercised need not return to their initial configuration.[10]

Background

Historical Context

The Israeli-Palestinian conflict is one of the most protracted disputes in modern history. A major turning point came with the 1967 Six-Day War, when Israel occupied the West Bank, the Gaza Strip, the Golan Heights, and Sinai. Following the occupation, Israeli citizens began establishing civilian settlements in the West Bank, the Golan Heights and, for a time, in the Gaza Strip.[11] The ICRC, the ICJ, the UN General Assembly and the Security Council regard Israeli settlement policy in the occupied Palestinian territory, including East Jerusalem, as a contrary to international law.[12] Settlement construction began shortly after the war under left-wing governments and intensified after 1977 with the Likud party's victory (Pappe, 2017; Hirsch-Hoefler and Mudde, 2020).[13]

The 1993 Declaration of Principles then initiated an interim framework for Palestinian self-government and permanent-status negotiations, and the 1995 Interim Agreement, known as Oslo II, divided the West Bank into Areas A, B and C (Government of Israel and Palestine Liberation Organization, 1993, 1995). The Palestinian Authority assumed civil affairs and public order in Areas A and B and internal security in Area A, while Israel retained external security, the security of Israeli citizens, overriding security responsibility in Area A and B, and full civil and security control in Area C, roughly 60% of the territory (U.S. Department of State, 2021). The process was never completed: the 2000 Camp David summit collapsed, the Second Intifada followed, and Area C remained under Israeli control and became the central arena of settlement expansion.

[10] This feedback is inspired by the decentralized-violence extension in Bisin et al. (2026), in which greater political weight for a violent group reduces police enforcement and increases private violence.

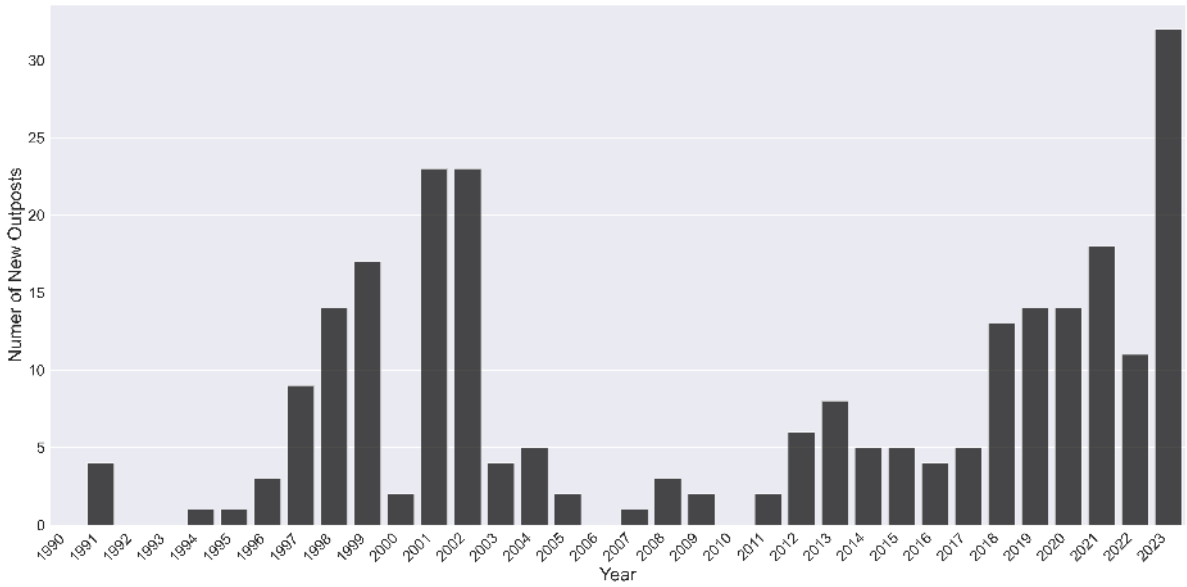
[11] Settlements in the Gaza Strip were dismantled in 2005 as part of Israel's unilateral disengagement plan.

[12] United Nations Security Council (1979, 2016); International Committee of the Red Cross (1949); International Court of Justice (2024); International Committee of the Red Cross (2024); United Nations General Assembly (2024).

[13] Likud (Hebrew for 'Consolidation') is the major center-right to right-wing political party in Israel.

Beginning in the early 1990s, unauthorized structures known as *outposts* began to emerge throughout the West Bank. These are small clusters of structures, often established by ideologically motivated settlers without all the required governmental and planning approvals, that have proliferated over the last decades (Peace Now, 2017).[14] Typically located on hilltops, they often begin as temporary encampments and evolve into agricultural or shepherding farms that enable control over large surrounding areas (B'Tselem and Kerem Navot, 2021) (Appendix Figure E.1 shows examples), and their expansion has been facilitated by political authorities at times permissive or ambivalent toward their presence (Peace Now, 2017; B'Tselem, 2021). Violence and intimidation often accompany this process: they can precede an outpost's establishment and continue as settlers expand and consolidate control over surrounding land (Etkes, 2013; B'Tselem, 2021). Figure 1 shows that after an increase around the Second Intifada (2000–2005) and a period of stability, outpost creation rises again from 2017–2018 and remains high through 2023.

Figure 1: Outposts in the Occupied West Bank



Notes: Number of new outposts created over time. Source B'Tselem (2024) and Peace Now (2024).

Outposts are closely associated with the "hilltop youth"—loosely organized settlers,

[14]Status varies across sites and over time, and some outposts are later granted recognition or planning authorization. The Migron and Amona judgments (Supreme Court of Israel, sitting as the High Court of Justice, 2011, 2014) concern particular outposts built on privately owned Palestinian land.

often from second- or third-generation settler families, who operate in small, semi-autonomous groups and reject formal authority, both the Israeli state and the established settler leadership (Shalom Hartman Institute, 2022; Neumann, 2025; Eiran and Krause, 2018). Their activities center on creating "facts on the ground": asserting territorial claims, pre-empting future concessions, and displacing Palestinian communities (Neumann, 2025; Peace Now, 2017). Violence serves these ends directly: attacks and intimidation keep Palestinian farmers and herders off surrounding land, extending the area an outpost controls well beyond its structures (B'Tselem, 2021). This combination of ideological motivation, decentralized organization, and weak external constraint makes the outpost frontier particularly relevant for understanding localized violence.[15] By contrast, many residents of government-authorized settlements move largely because of housing costs and other cost-of-living considerations.[16]

The Trump-Era Shift in U.S. Policy

The Trump-era shift marked a break from the preceding U.S. policy environment. The Obama administration consistently opposed settlement expansion and described continued settlement activity as illegitimate. In December 2016 the United States abstained, allowing the adoption of Security Council Resolution 2334, which stated that the establishment of settlements had "no legal validity" and constituted a "flagrant violation under international law" (United Nations Security Council, 2016).

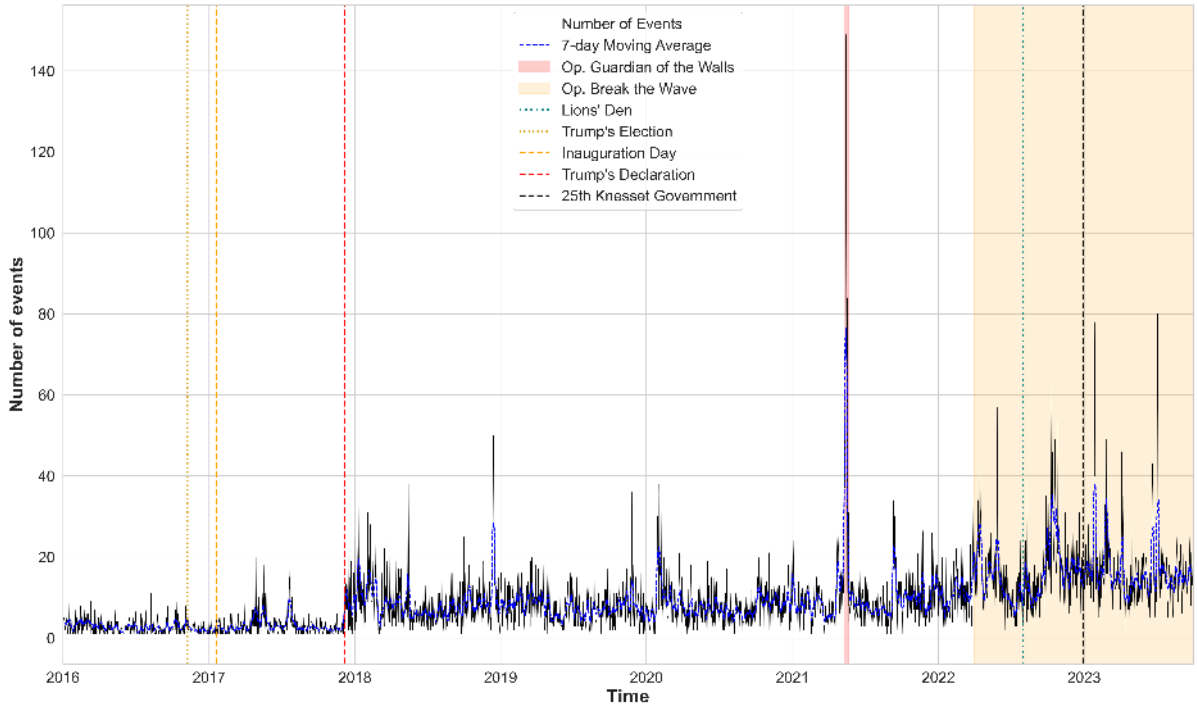
Before 2017, Israeli governments signaled low tolerance for settler violence in several instances, and each time violence declined. In December 2011, after settlers attacked an army base, Netanyahu approved administrative detention and military trials for suspects (Al Jazeera, 2011). In June 2013, the Security Cabinet expanded the tools against "price tag" attacks on Palestinians and their property (Israel Ministry of Foreign Affairs, 2013). After the Duma arson of July 2015,[17] the cabinet authorized administrative detention of Jewish suspects (Oster, 2015). OCHA's count of settler attacks causing Palestinian casualties or property damage fell after each episode (OCHA, 2019, 2026).

[15] Figure E.2 in the Appendix shows that polling stations within 2 km of an outpost consistently record higher vote shares for right-wing and far-right parties than those farther away, with support near outposts remaining above 80%.

[16] Ben-Shahar et al. (2019)

[17] The Encroachment and Forbearance section discusses the Duma arson and the government's response in more detail.

Figure 2: Number of Daily Violent Events in the West Bank



Notes: Daily violent events in the West Bank from ACLED, to September 2023; the blue line is a 7-day moving average. Dashed lines: Trump's election, inauguration, and the Jerusalem Declaration. Shaded areas: Operations Guardian of the Walls and Break the Wave, and the emergence of Lions' Den.

Trump's election marked a departure from this trajectory, as the constraints on settlers began to ease. During the campaign, Trump had signaled strong support for Israel and openness to settlement expansion, breaking with longstanding bipartisan restraint. Four days after his inauguration, Israel's Defense Ministry announced plans to advance approximately 2,500 housing units in West Bank settlements (Kershner, 2017). In February 2017 the Knesset enacted the Regularization Law, which let the state take possession and use rights over privately owned Palestinian land and allocate them to settlements, an appropriation the owners had no right to refuse; in 2020 the High Court of Justice invalidated it (Supreme Court of Israel, sitting as the High Court of Justice, 2020; Sharvit Baruch, 2020).[18] The shift became operational in March 2017: the cabinet approved the establishment of Amichai as permanent housing for the evacuees from the

[18]Owners retained underlying title and were compensated with 125% of use value or alternative land. Chief Justice Hayut wrote that the law *"knowingly and unequally infringes upon the property rights of Palestinian residents of the area alone"* (Supreme Court of Israel, sitting as the High Court of Justice, 2020).

Amona outpost[19], a decision widely described at the time as approval of the first wholly new government-authorized settlement in roughly two decades (Ahren and TOI Staff, 2017; Ravid, 2017). The same day, the government issued tenders for additional construction and classified some 900 dunams[20] around existing outposts as "state land" under the Israeli-administered land regime (Ahren and TOI Staff, 2017; Ravid, 2017). Figures E.4a and E.4b document a broader increase in state transfers to settlements and construction tenders beginning in 2017.

The most explicit diplomatic signal came on December 6, 2017, when Trump formally recognized Jerusalem as Israel's capital, a move that every U.S. president had deferred since the 1995 Jerusalem Embassy Act (U.S. Congress, 1995).[21] Jerusalem lies at the heart of the conflict's most intractable claims: for Israel, it is the biblical heart of the Jewish people and the site of their ancient Temples; for Palestinians, it is the home of the Al-Aqsa Mosque and the intended capital of their future state (European Parliament, 2012).[22] The declaration was particularly salient for radical settlers, who are disproportionately drawn from messianic currents of Religious Zionism within which sovereignty over Jerusalem carries redemptive significance well beyond ordinary diplomacy (Shalom Hartman Institute, 2022; Hershkowitz, 2026).[23] It was therefore perceived as a validation of their maximalist territorial claims, a step toward Jewish sovereignty over the entirety of *Eretz Yisrael*.[24]

The declaration triggered Palestinian mobilization and clashes with Israeli forces, while reinforcing radical settlers' perception that territorial expansion would face less external opposition. In January 2018, a Palestinian gunman killed Rabbi Raziel Shevach near Havat Gilad, the unauthorized outpost where he lived (TOI Staff, 2018). His killing

[19]The Supreme Court ordered full evacuation of the outpost in December 2014. The government sought delays, and the evacuation was carried out only in February 2017 (Reuters Staff, 2017b; Associated Press, 2016; Reuters Staff, 2017a).

[20]Approximately 90 hectares (222 acres).

[21]The proclamation did not determine Jerusalem's boundaries or recognize Israeli sovereignty over the entire city; it expressly left boundaries and other final-status questions to negotiations (Trump, 2017).

[22]East Jerusalem is the portion of the city captured and occupied by Israel during the 1967 Six-Day War. Under international law, it is considered occupied territory (United Nations Security Council, 1980, 2016).

[23]For some of the most radical activists this symbolism extends to aspirations for the restoration of the Temple (Don-Yehiya, 2014; Nicolle-Hasid, 2019).

[24]Hebrew for "Land of Israel", referring to the biblical promised land (Havrelock, 2011). In modern political use, particularly by nationalists, it often denotes a territory that includes the West Bank (Likud, 1977).

was followed by settler violence and calls to legalize the outpost. Netanyahu ordered its connection to the electricity grid, and within a month the cabinet unanimously agreed to begin a process of official recognition and planning authorization (Magid, 2018b,a). Netanyahu presented the decision as support for the broader settlement project, giving political backing to settlers' territorial claims in the West Bank.

Together, these events mark a sequence of increasing political permissiveness: Trump's election shifted expectations, early 2017 policy moves made the shift concrete, and the Jerusalem Declaration and the reaction to Havat Gilad's killing provided the most salient signals. Figure 2 depicts daily violent events in the West Bank from January 2016 to September 2023: the figure shows modest peaks after Trump's inauguration and the first sustained increase after the Jerusalem Declaration and Havat Gilad. The increase never fully reverts, with a consistently higher level of violence through 2023 than in the pre-2017 period.

Data

This section describes the data sources used in this study: daily geo-referenced violent events from the ACLED (2024b) project, and comprehensive spatial data from Israeli NGOs and international bodies (Peace Now, 2024; B'Tselem, 2024; Kerem Navot, 2024), complemented by satellite imagery to date outpost emergence (European Space Agency, 2025; Maxar Technologies, 2023).

Violent Events ACLED (2024b) maintains daily, geo-referenced records of political violence events, demonstrations, and other politically relevant developments across the West Bank (ACLED, 2024a). The database systematically compiles information from diverse local, national, and international news sources, capturing detailed information on location, timing, and event characteristics, along with a short textual description of each event.[25]

The data start on January 1, 2016 and are analyzed here through September 2023. For the remainder of the paper, a "violent event" is defined broadly to include riots, acts against individuals and directed at property, e.g. looting, property destruction, and so forth. I feed each event's textual description to GPT-5-mini, which classifies perpetra-

[25]Several studies rely on ACLED (Kafando and Sakurai, 2024; Rohner et al., 2013; Bertoni et al., 2019; Berman and Couttenier, 2015).

tors, targets, and casualties. Events coded with several actors enter every perpetrator–target outcome they match. Appendix G describes the procedure and displays validation with a random sample of human-coded events. Figure G.1 shows a mild increase in settler violence starting 2017, followed by another sharp increase the next year and enduring over time.

Geography, Settlements, Outposts, and Demolitions I rely on detailed spatial data from two key Israeli civil society organizations. Peace Now, through its Settlement Watch portal, monitors and campaigns against settlement construction. Similarly, B'Tselem, the Israeli Information Center for Human Rights in the Occupied Territories, maintains an updated database on settlements and outposts. I merge these two sources to obtain an exhaustive list of settlements and outposts, alongside Palestinian towns and villages, with information on location, and year of establishment. I also retrieve geographic covariates from various sources:[26] such as the road network, Jewish, Christian, and Muslim holy sites and terrain elevation. Figure A.2 shows the distribution of settlements, outposts, Palestinian towns and villages, and the Oslo Areas partitions across the West Bank and other relevant information such as military bases and built-up areas.

Since the year of establishment of outposts is often imprecisely recorded, I use satellite imagery to date their emergence, combining high-resolution imagery from Maxar Technologies (2023) to locate the structures characteristic of new outposts with the Sentinel-2 Level 2A time series of the European Space Agency's Copernicus program (European Space Agency, 2025) to identify their first appearance, Figure E.3 in the Appendix provides an example.[27] Importantly, since the high-resolution imagery was retrieved as of 2023, the outposts I map are those still in place at that date, together with the pre-election sites that historical records show were later dismantled or rebuilt.

From B'Tselem's database, I also source data on demolitions of Palestinian structures carried out in the West Bank, outside East Jerusalem, for lack of an Israeli building permit, recording the date, the community, and the number of structures and people affected for each demolition from January 2006 to March 2025 (B'Tselem, 2025b). I geocode each record to its community in the OCHA/PCBS gazetteer (4,527 of 4,693

[26] Palestinian Central Bureau of Statistics (2025), United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA) (2017), OpenStreetMap Contributors (2017), and European Space Agency and Airbus Defence and Space (2021)

[27] Founding dates are recorded from 2016 onward; earlier outposts are dated by year only.

records, 88% of them in communities wholly or partly in Area C). The Encroachment and Forbearance section uses them to compare the state's enforcement against Palestinian construction with its treatment of outposts.

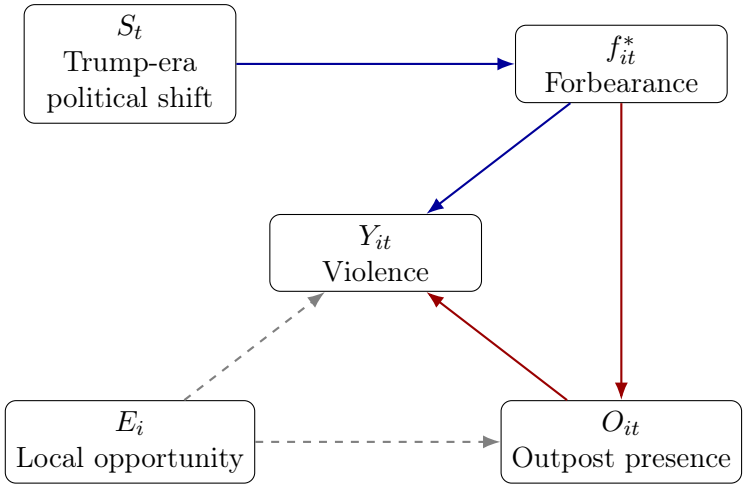
Political Responses To measure political responses to fatal violence between settlers and Palestinians, I use two sources. The first is the corpus of Knesset plenary speeches compiled by Goldin et al. (2025), with full text and metadata on speakers, parties, and dates, which I filter with a coarse text classification to speeches on the occupied territories, settlements, and the Israeli–Palestinian conflict (Appendix I; Figure A.1 shows speeches per year and speakers by party). The second, for the incident-level comparison in the Encroachment and Forbearance section, combines B'Tselem's fatality database and ACLED's settler-perpetrated casualty events with the statements of governing politicians reported in a fixed set of Israeli and international outlets, official and parliamentary archives, and speakers' social media, searched in English and Hebrew (Appendix H).

Methodology

Empirical Framework The model implies that an aggregate political shock should not affect all places equally. Its effects should be strongest where violence can be converted into material gains. In the West Bank, unauthorized outposts provide this empirical margin. They identify the radical outpost frontier, where territorial encroachment is actively pursued. The empirical design therefore asks whether violence increases more after the Trump-era shift in areas that were more exposed, before the shock, to this radical outpost frontier.

Figure 3 translates this logic into the empirical design. The Trump-era political shift S_t affects forbearance f^*_{it}, understood as the expected permissiveness of the enforcement environment faced by radical actors. Higher f^*_{it} can affect violence Y_{it} directly, by lowering expected punishment or obstruction, and indirectly through unauthorized outpost presence O_{it}, e.g. by making territorial encroachment easier to sustain. These pathways are complementary: weaker constraints on forbearance can both activate violent behavior directly and facilitate the expansion or persistence of unauthorized outposts, which may in turn generate more violence. Forbearance is not directly observed, so I treat f^*_{it} as a latent mechanism and return to it in the Encroachment and Forbearance section.

Figure 3: Causal DAG



Notes: Blue arrows indicate the forbearance/activation channel. Red arrows indicate the outpost expansion channel. Gray dashed arrows indicate the confounding path through pre-existing local opportunity E_i, proxied by outpost suitability.

The main empirical challenge is that outposts are not randomly located. Local geography, access, land-use patterns, and proximity to existing settler infrastructure affect both the feasibility of outpost expansion and baseline conflict risk, generating a backdoor path from E_i—local opportunity for encroachment and "productivity" of violence—to both O_{it} and Y_{it}. I therefore construct a pre-shock outpost-suitability measure to proxy for E_i from pre-2016 spatial patterns, described in the next subsection, and compare locations with different ex ante exposure to the radical outpost frontier, conditional on fixed effects and controls.

The design therefore identifies the reduced-form effect of the Trump-era political shift S_t on violence Y_{it} across locations with different pre-shock exposure. It does not separately identify violence around pre-existing outposts from violence generated by subsequent outpost expansion; the Encroachment and Forbearance section provides further evidence on the interaction between geography, outpost location and violence.

Outpost Suitability To operationalize E_i, I model where unauthorized outposts were likely to expand before Trump's election. I begin by discretizing the West Bank into a fine hexagonal grid (1 km sides) and restricting attention to locations exposed to outpost expansion, namely cells with at least 5% of their area in Oslo Area C and within 30 km of a settlement. I then estimate a PPML model of outpost expansion over annual periods from 1990 through October 2016. The dependent variable is the number of new outposts appearing in cell i during year t. The specification combines static geographic

and institutional covariates with dynamic frontier variables that capture the evolution of the existing outpost network:

$$\mathbb{E}\left[O_{it} \mid X_i, D_{it-1}, N_{it-1}\right] = \exp\left(f(t) + X_i'\beta + g(D_{it-1}) + h(N_{it-1})\right), \tag{1}$$

where O_{it} is the number of new unauthorized outposts in cell i during year t, $f(t)$ is a flexible spline in calendar year, X_i includes pre-determined cell characteristics, D_{it-1} captures distance to the nearest existing outpost, and N_{it-1} summarizes local outpost density and neighborhood exposure.[28]

The static component X_i includes institutional, accessibility, settlement-proximity, and terrain characteristics measured prior to the shock.[29] The fitted model yields $\hat{E}_i$, the predicted pre-shock intensity of outpost expansion in each location, which proxies for E_i. The measure predicts post-election outpost formation well (AUC ≈ 0.79); Appendix Table B.1 and Figure A.3 report model fit and the resulting suitability surface.

Because outpost activity often extends beyond the cell in which an outpost is located, the raw suitability score does not fully capture local exposure to the frontier. I therefore construct a binary treatment measure that incorporates this broader spatial footprint. I first identify fine-grid cells in the top decile of the pre-shock suitability distribution and draw a 2 km buffer around them. A regression cell (a hexagon with 1.5 km sides) is then classified as "treated" if at least 50% of its area falls within this buffered high-suitability region. Treatment is thus determined entirely by pre-shock geography and the predicted spatial reach of outpost expansion, rather than by realized post-shock outpost locations. Appendix Figure A.4 shows the construction and resulting treatment assignment.[30]

Estimation I estimate the effect of the Trump-era political shift using an event-study design that compares the evolution of violence in cells with high versus low exposure to radical settler activity, taking Trump's November 2016 election as the onset of the shift. The dynamic coefficients allow the response to build up through subsequent milestones,

[28] Specifically, D_{it-1} is the distance from cell i to the nearest outpost established before t, and N_{it-1} includes (i) a Gaussian kernel density (10 km bandwidth) of those outposts, both entered as splines, and (ii) a spatial lag based on a row-normalised queen-contiguity matrix: the average number of outposts established before t in the cells adjacent to i.

[29] Specifically: the share of cell area in Area C and in natural reserves, a military-zone indicator, distances to settlements, Palestinian villages, the Green Line, Jewish holy sites, roads, counts of nearby settlements, the share of the spatial unit under settlement municipality administration, elevation, elevation dispersion, slope and terrain ruggedness.

[30] The results are robust to alternative specifications, see the Robustness Checks section.

including the inauguration and the December 2017 Jerusalem Declaration.

Outcomes are measured monthly at the hex-cell level, as both event counts and indicators for any event; Appendix Figures E.5–E.7 plot the raw monthly series for treated and control cells. The analysis focuses primarily on settler violence against Palestinians, the outcome most directly linked to the theoretical mechanism, and reports Palestinian violence against settlers as a benchmark. I also report results for civilian targeting and other perpetrator–target pairs as secondary outcomes to document the broader conflict dynamics during this period.

Identification relies on no anticipation and parallel trends assumptions. The identifying assumption is that, absent the shock, violence in high- and low-exposure cells would have evolved in parallel. No anticipation is plausible given that Trump's victory was unexpected. Treated and control cells differ on observables (Table B.2), as expected given that treatment reflects structural exposure to the outpost frontier; I therefore assess parallel trends through the pre-treatment event-study coefficients and a joint Wald test. The Robustness Checks section additionally reports a matched specification restricting the comparison to observationally similar cells.

The baseline specification is:

$$Y_{it} = \alpha_i + \lambda_t + \sum_{\tau \neq -1} \beta_\tau \left(T_i \cdot D_{t,\tau} \right) + \varepsilon_{it}, \tag{2}$$

where Y_{it} is violence in cell i and month t, $T_i \equiv T_i(\hat{E})$ is the binary treatment built from the suitability $\hat{E}$ above, and $D_{t,\tau}$ indexes event time relative to Trump's election in November 2016. The specification with controls adds two sets of terms. The first interacts a post-election indicator, $Post_t = \mathbf{1}[t \geq \text{November 2016}]$, with time-invariant cell characteristics: the shares of the cell in Oslo Areas A and B, and the number of Palestinian villages in the cell and within two rings in the neighboring cells. To capture seasonal exposure, I include the Ramadan and Jewish-holiday shares of the month and an olive-harvest indicator, each interacted with an indicator for cells within 3 km of a Palestinian village (Ramadan and olive harvest) or of an Israeli settlement (Jewish holidays). In the static tables the first set is interacted separately with the two post-shock windows. Appendix Figure A.6 plots the control coefficients alongside the treatment effects. Standard errors are Conley (1999) spatial standard errors with a uniform kernel and a 5 km cutoff, allowing arbitrary correlation over time within that

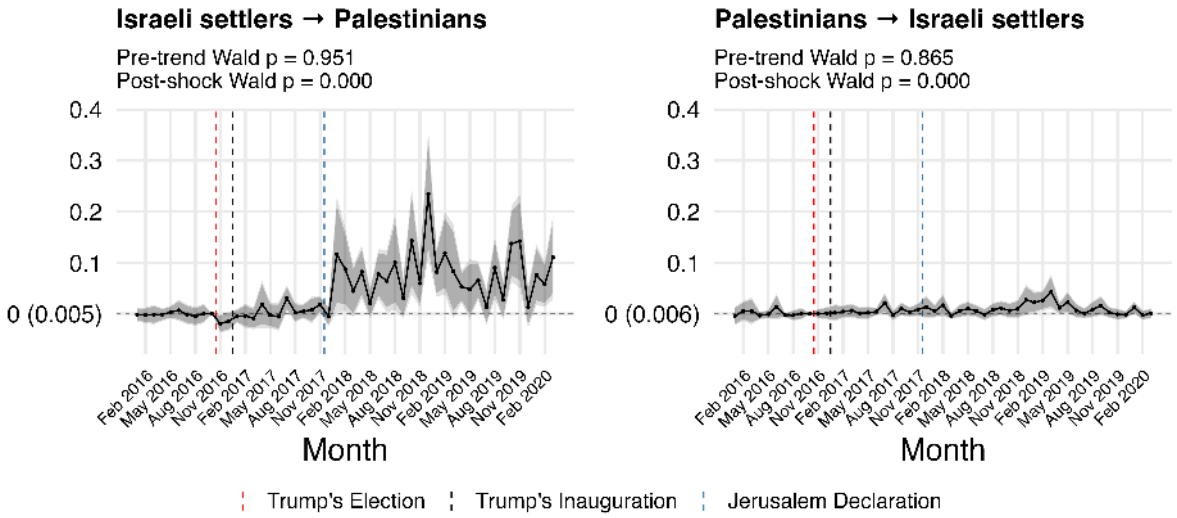
distance; tables also report errors clustered at the hex-cell level. The main sample runs from January 2016 to March 2020.[31]

Results

Main Results

Settler Violence at the Outpost Frontier I begin by estimating equation 2 with monthly counts of settler violence against Palestinians as the outcome, using Palestinian violence against settlers as a benchmark.

Figure 4: Event-Study Estimates: Settler–Palestinian Violence



Notes: Event-study coefficients from equation (2), monthly event counts; omitted period: the month before Trump's election. Hex-cell and month fixed effects, controls, Conley standard errors (5 km). Shaded areas: 95% and 90% confidence intervals. Vertical lines: Trump's election, inauguration, and the Jerusalem Declaration. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean of the outcome. Wald p-values for joint pre- and post-shock coefficients.

Figure 4 reports the results. The left panel shows no jump at the election: the coefficients start to rise at the inauguration, climb through 2017, and break sharply upward in January 2018. The timing follows the Jerusalem Declaration, though the one-month lag suggests the declaration weakened the constraints on forbearance while the Havat Gilad killing may have served as the trigger. The coefficients remain elevated through the end of the sample. The static estimates in Table B.3 split the post-period at

[31] The Results section also reports estimates on the longer horizon through September 2023.

the Declaration. After the Declaration, treated cells record 0.075 more events per month than controls, six times their pre-election mean, and the probability that a cell sees any settler attack in a given month rises by 4.4 percentage points relative to controls, against a pre-election incidence of 1.2 percent.

The right panel shows a different pattern. Palestinian violence against settlers is smaller in magnitude and does not display the same persistent increase, inconsistent with symmetric conflict dynamics or a mechanical settler response to rising Palestinian attacks. Figure A.5 in the Appendix confirms the pattern using linear-probability incidence outcomes.

Broader Conflict As secondary outcomes, I estimate equation 2 for IDF–Palestinian confrontations and civilian-targeting events to document the broader conflict environment at the outpost frontier.[32] IDF–Palestinian confrontations display a pattern closer to symmetric violence (Figures A.7 and A.8).

The static estimates for IDF-perpetrated events are zero between the election and the Declaration and display a sharp increase on December 2017, i.e. month of the Jerusalem Declaration (Table B.4); pre-period coefficients are individually insignificant, but jointly significant in the incidence specification. This is consistent with the fact that military operations reflect a different behavioral margin—institutional deployments driven by intelligence and directives—rather than individual responses to perceived impunity. Palestinian violence against the IDF shows no gradual movement between the election and the declaration, rising only sharply afterward. Civilian-targeting outcomes track the settler-violence results—flat pre-trends in the event count specification, a gradual increase after the election, and a sharp break starting January 2018 as the settler perpetrated incident series (Figures A.9a and A.9b; Table B.5).

Long-Term Dynamics I also estimate equation 2 on the extended sample through September 2023 (Figure 5), to document whether the initial shift persisted, reversed, or was compounded by later events.

Settler violence against Palestinians remains consistently above the pre-2017 baseline across the entire extended period. It does not revert after Biden's election or during the Bennett–Lapid government,[33] suggesting that the initial shift moved the conflict

[32] Civilian targeting follows ACLED's coding of events in which civilians were the main or only target.

[33] The Bennett–Lapid government was more moderate than the Netanyahu-led coalition that followed, but Bennett himself came from the national-religious right and had long taken hawkish positions on settlements and settler violence (TOI Staff, 2021).

environment to a persistently higher level rather than producing a temporary spike. A further increase occurs around Operation Guardian of the Walls in 2021,[34] and the strongest escalation from 2022 onward, with Operation Break the Wave (Israel Defense Forces, 2023),[35] the emergence of the Lions' Den (ACLED, 2023),[36] and the formation of the 25th Knesset government at the end of December 2022, which gave politicians aligned with the settler movement ministerial authority over police priorities and West Bank civilian administration (Chacar, 2022; Williams, 2022). Each of these episodes compounded a conflict that had already shifted to a higher baseline after 2016.

Palestinian violence against settlers follows a different trajectory. It remains muted for most of the period and rises only from 2022 onward with the reactivation of Palestinian armed groups, e.g. Lions' Den (ACLED, 2023). This lag is difficult to reconcile with a simple retaliation account and reinforces the reading of the earlier results: settler violence drove the initial escalation, with a broader and more symmetric conflict dynamic emerging only later. The absence of reversal across governments is consistent with the dynamic extension of the model (Appendix F), in which tolerated violence builds its beneficiaries' leverage over future enforcement. The formation of the 25th Knesset government is the closest observable counterpart to rising leverage, though it does not establish that tolerated violence produced it.

Timing and Local Triggers

The pattern outlined in the main results raises two concerns. The first is that the U.S. shift is incidental: the conflict would have flared up anyway, and the escalation merely happens to follow the political calendar. The second is that the January 2018 jump is retaliation for the killing alone, rather than retaliation that a more permissive enforcement environment allowed to escalate and persist.

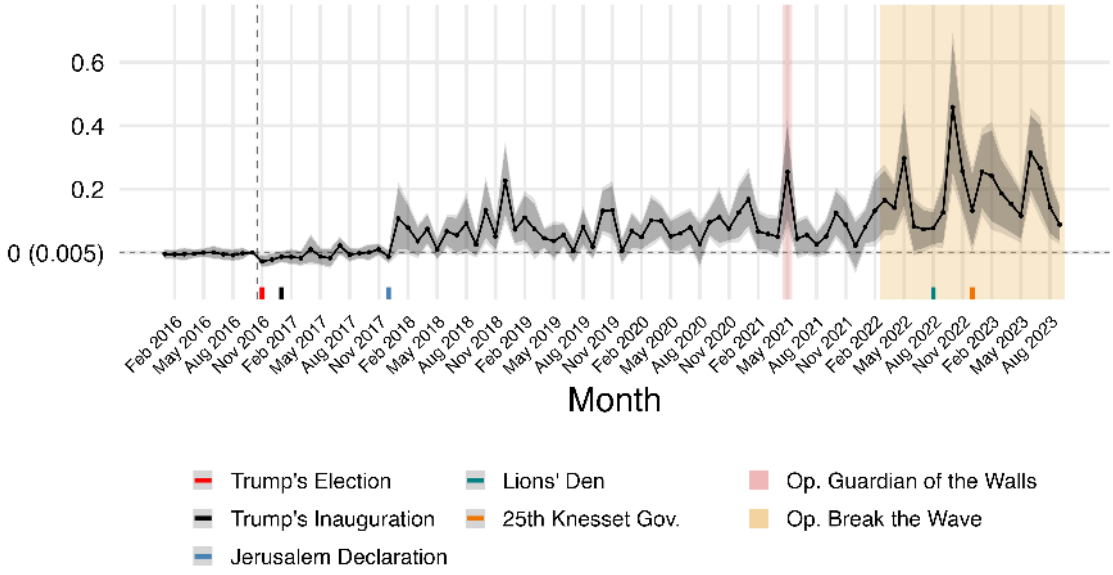
To address the first, I estimate unknown structural breaks in the raw monthly treated–control gap in violence (Andrews, 1993; Bai, 1997; Bai and Perron, 1998, 2003). Figure 6 reports the results. For settler violence against Palestinians (Panel a), the first break falls in April 2017, with a 95% confidence interval from March to May 2017:

[34] The eleven-day Israel–Hamas war of May 2021, sparked by clashes in Jerusalem and accompanied by unrest in the West Bank.

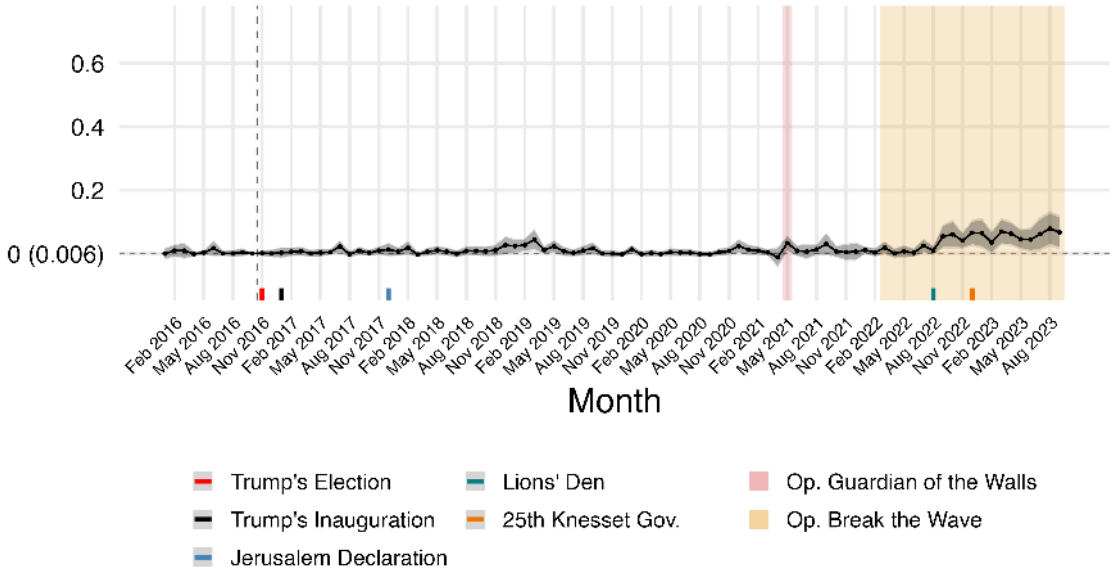
[35] An IDF campaign of near-nightly arrest raids in the northern West Bank, launched in spring 2022 after a wave of attacks inside Israel.

[36] A Nablus-based armed group formed in 2022 outside the established Palestinian factions, claiming attacks on soldiers and settlers.

Figure 5: Event-Study Estimates: Settler–Palestinian Violence, Extended Sample



(a) Israeli Settlers → Palestinians



(b) Palestinians → Israeli Settlers

Notes: Event-study coefficients from equation (2), monthly event counts; both panels share the vertical axis. Bottom markers: Trump's election and inauguration, the Jerusalem Declaration, the emergence of Lions' Den, and the 25th Knesset government. Shaded areas: Operations Guardian of the Walls and Break the Wave. Specification and bands as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean.

between the inauguration and the Declaration, in the weeks after the cabinet approved Amichai for the Amona evacuees (see The Trump-Era Shift in U.S. Policy). A second and much larger level shift follows in January 2018, with a confidence interval from November 2017 to March 2018. Palestinian violence against settlers on the other hand (Panel b) shows no break in 2017 or 2018; its first break comes in 2022. The sequence mirrors the staged structure of the shock: a mild shift after the election and inauguration, and the main escalation after the Declaration. Test statistics, critical values, and the 2022 breaks are reported in Appendix E.

The second concern is whether the January 2018 jump is retaliation for the Shevach killing alone, or retaliation that a more permissive environment allowed to escalate and persist. Figure A.10 re-estimates the event study with the omitted month moved to May 2016, before the first fatal attacks of summer 2016, and marks every fatal attack against settlers. Before the election, the coefficients are statistically zero after such attacks; after it, the response to the two attacks of 2017 is short-lived, and a sustained increase follows only the Declaration. Fatal attacks alone did not produce sustained increases before the shift; what changed in January 2018 was the environment the killing met, not the occurrence of a killing or the identity of the victim.

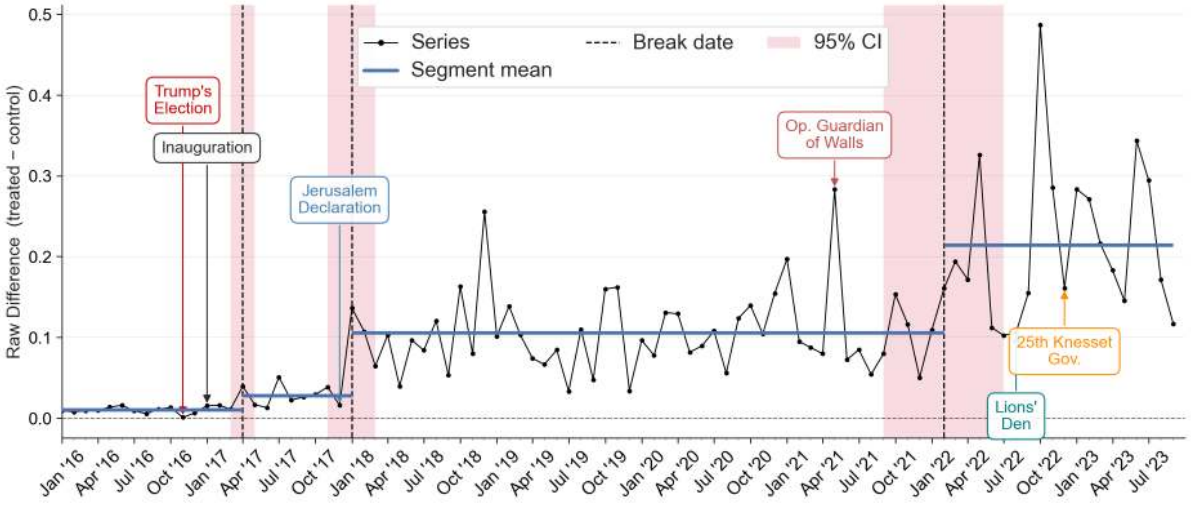
The Geography of Violence

Settlement Proximity or Radical Expansion?

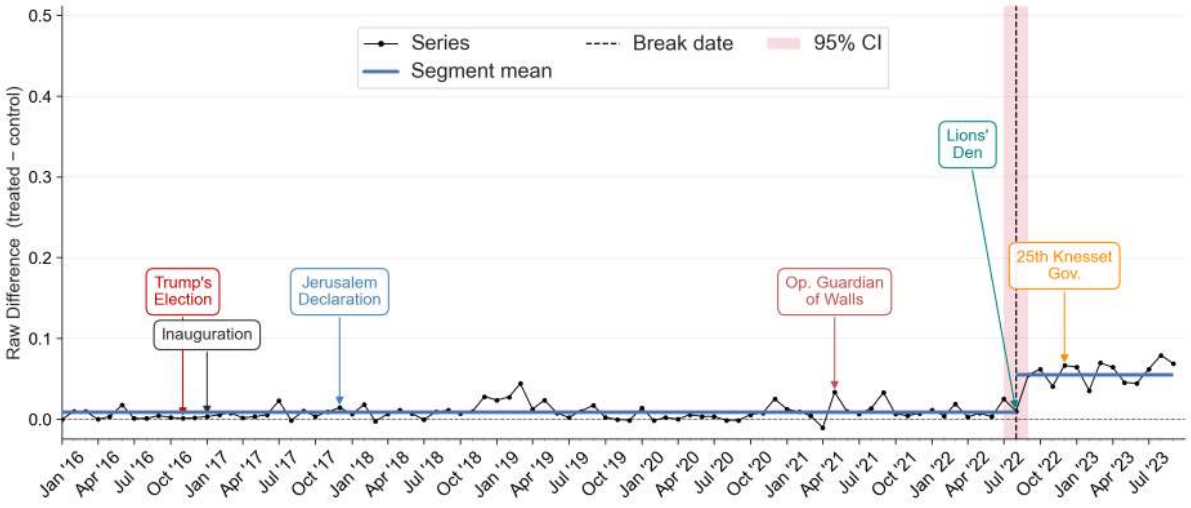
The results might capture proximity to Israeli settlers rather than exposure to the radical frontier. If the effect were driven by contact or friction between Israelis and Palestinians more generally, similar increases should appear near established settlements outside the outpost frontier. To test this, I draw a 2 km buffer around each established settlement and partition buffered cells into two mutually exclusive groups. *Non-frontier settlement-adjacent* cells ($N_i = 1$) lie within the buffer but outside the high outpost-suitability zone: near established settlements, but away from the radical frontier. *Frontier settlement-adjacent* cells ($R_i = 1$) lie within both the buffer and a high-suitability area,[37] where local opportunity E_i is higher. Both groups are estimated against a common control group of cells that are neither settlement-adjacent nor in a high-suitability

[37] High refers to the top decile of outpost suitability used to define treatment areas in the Methodology section.

Figure 6: Structural Break Estimation: Settler–Palestinian Violence



(a) Israeli Settlers → Palestinians



(b) Palestinians → Israeli Settlers

Notes: Agnostic structural-break estimates for the monthly treated–control difference in violence (black line). Blue lines: segment means; dashed lines and shading: break dates with 95% confidence intervals. HAC (Newey–West) long-run variances.

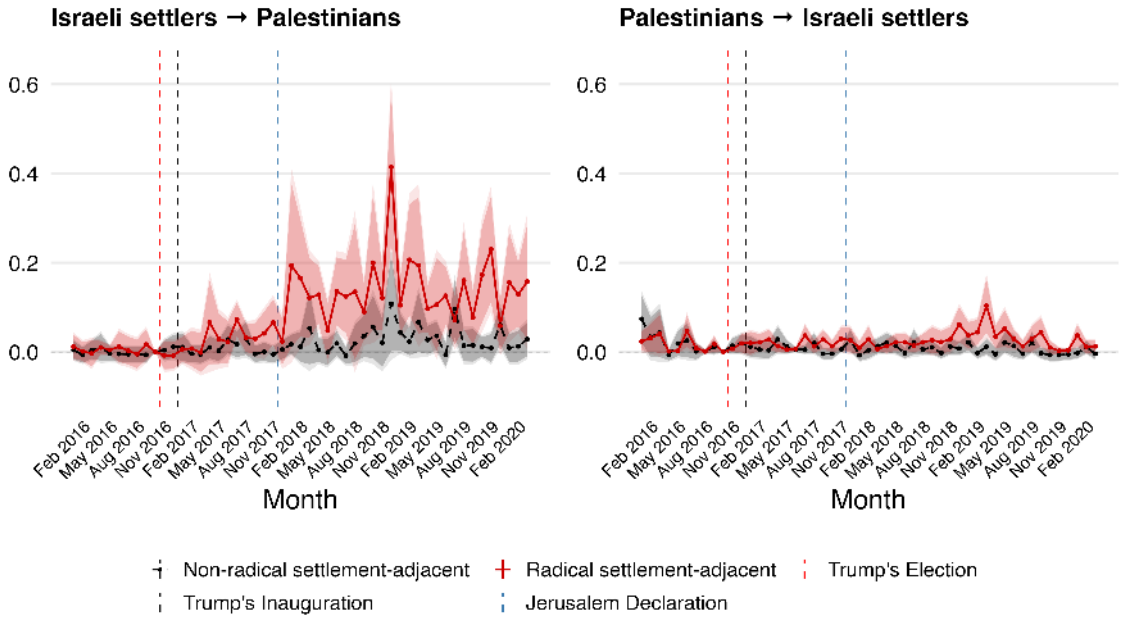
area (Appendix Figure A.13).

I estimate the following two-arm event-study specification:

$$Y_{it} = \alpha_i + \lambda_t + \sum_{\tau \neq -1} \beta_{N,\tau} \left(N_i \times D_{t,\tau} \right) + \sum_{\tau \neq -1} \beta_{R,\tau} \left(R_i \times D_{t,\tau} \right) + u_{it}, \tag{3}$$

where α_i are hex-cell fixed effects, λ_t are period fixed effects, and $D_{t,\tau}$ is the relative-time indicator, equal to one when month t is τ months relative to November 2016 and zero otherwise. Both arms are estimated relative to the same control group. Standard errors are Conley-corrected with a 5 km cutoff, and I include the same controls as in the main specification.

Figure 7: Settlement Proximity vs. Radical Frontier: Event-Study Estimates



Notes: Two-arm event study (equation (3)), monthly event counts, January 2016 to March 2020. Dashed black: non-frontier settlement-adjacent arm ($N_i = 1$); solid red: frontier settlement-adjacent arm ($R_i = 1$); both relative to the same pure-control group. Bands, standard errors, and vertical lines as in Figure 4.

Figure 7 presents the results. The frontier arm ($\beta_{R,\tau}$, red) presents a pattern similar to the results in Figure 4, with a mild increase starting in 2017 and a sharp rise in violence starting 2018. The non-frontier arm ($\beta_{N,\tau}$, dashed black) moves somewhat but remains consistently smaller and, in most months, statistically insignificant. The pattern is consistent with the opportunity mechanism of Prediction 2: violence is not a generic by-product of Israeli–Palestinian proximity but arises at the active expansion margin,

where a shift in political constraints produces the largest behavioral response. Appendix Figure A.14 confirms the pattern using linear-probability incidence outcomes.

Opportunity or Presence?

A potential concern is that the baseline suitability measure partly reflects the pre-existing outpost network, so that high-suitability locations are simply places where radical settlers were already present before the shock; a nationwide change affecting radical settlers could then generate the observed spatial pattern even if territorial opportunity itself played no role. I thus separate the two explanations by distinguishing *structural opportunity* from *pre-shock presence*. If violence rose simply because radical settlers were already nearby, controlling flexibly for the location of existing outposts should absorb the effect; if it instead continues to rise where further outpost expansion was geographically favorable, this points to the opportunity margin emphasized by Prediction 2.

To isolate this margin, I construct an alternative suitability measure, $\hat{E}_i^{NO}$, that removes the contribution of the existing outpost network. Using the fitted outpost-expansion model of the Methodology section, I set the network covariates—distance to prior outposts, $D_{i,t-1}$, and local outpost density, $N_{i,t-1}$—to common reference values throughout the West Bank. The remaining variation therefore comes from terrain, institutional geography, accessibility, and settlement structure rather than from where outposts were already located.[38] I define T_i^{NO} from the top decile of this no-network suitability measure, with the same 2 km buffer and 50% overlap rule as the baseline.

I then estimate an event study that allows pre-shock outpost presence to have its own flexible time path:

$$Y_{it} = \alpha_i + \gamma_t + \sum_{\tau \neq -1} \beta_\tau \left(T_i^{NO} \times D_{t,\tau} \right) + \sum_{\tau \neq -1} \boldsymbol{\theta}_\tau' \left(HC_i \times D_{t,\tau} \right) + \varepsilon_{it}, \tag{4}$$

where $D_{t,\tau}$ indexes months relative to November 2016 and HC_i captures pre-shock outpost presence and proximity; the regression includes the same controls as equation (2).[39]

The coefficient of interest is β_τ. It compares cells with high and low geographic opportunity, holding fixed their pre-shock proximity to existing outposts. A positive

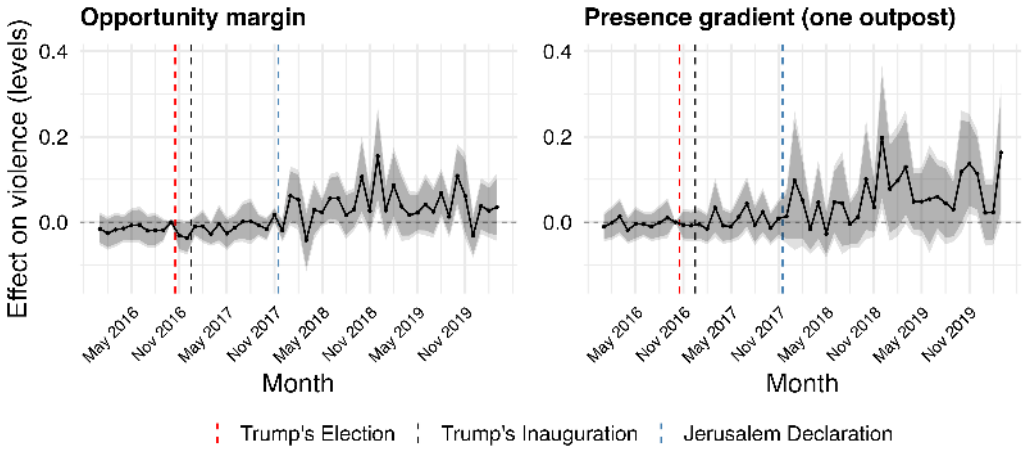
[38] Figure A.15 compares the resulting treatment map with the baseline allocation.

[39] Specifically,

$$HC_i = \left(\mathbf{1}[O_i = 1], \mathbf{1}[O_i \geq 2], d_i \right)',$$

post-shock β_τ means that violence rose more where terrain and institutional geography favored further expansion, not only where radical settlers were already present. The coefficients θ_τ on HC_i trace the evolution of violence in cells near existing outposts. They are conditional associations, not causal effects of an outpost: outposts were not placed at random, and the presence bins and the distance term are linked by construction, since a cell with no outpost within 2 km is necessarily more than 2 km from the nearest one.

Figure 8: Territorial Opportunity vs. Radical Presence: Event-Study Estimates



Notes: Estimates of equation (4) for settler violence against Palestinians; both panels come from one specification. Left: opportunity coefficients β_τ. Right: gradient for exactly one pre-2016 outpost within 2 km, relative to none. Specification, bands, and vertical lines as in Figure 4.

Figure 8 shows a clear difference between the two margins. The opportunity coefficients are flat before the shock, rise after the Jerusalem Declaration, and remain elevated thereafter. The coefficients on pre-existing outposts remain close to zero through 2017 and rise only later, with much wider confidence intervals. Existing presence therefore predicts some subsequent violence, but it does not account for the opportunity effect. The cleanest evidence is Appendix Figure A.16, which restricts the sample to cells with no pre-shock outpost within 2 km. There the opportunity effect is identified entirely from cells beyond the existing frontier, and it remains positive after the Declaration.

Palestinian violence against settlers offers a useful contrast. For that outcome the

where O_i is the number of pre-November-2016 outposts within 2 km and d_i is distance to the nearest pre-shock outpost. Cells with no outpost within 2 km form the omitted presence category. Appendix Table B.6 reports the corresponding static difference-in-differences estimates, and Table B.7 shows that the opportunity coefficient is stable across presence parameterizations.

opportunity coefficient is essentially zero, while pre-existing outpost presence predicts it (joint $p = 0.001$; Table B.6, column 3). This is what one expects when violence depends mainly on the availability of nearby targets. Settler violence follows a different pattern: it rises where further expansion is feasible, even after conditioning on where radical settlers were already located.

Taken together, these results favor an "opportunity" interpretation of the main effect. The post-shock increase in settler violence was not confined to the existing outpost network; it was concentrated where the frontier could expand further. This is the spatial prediction of the model: when expected restraint weakens, violence responds most where it can generate larger territorial gains. The Encroachment and Forbearance section examines why actors could expect those gains to persist.

Encroachment and Forbearance

The previous section established where post-shock violence concentrated. Two questions follow: did territorial encroachment itself shift toward that margin? And why could settlers expect those gains to stand? The first question concerns the expansion channel in Figure 3, $S_t \to f^*_{it} \to O_{it}$; the second concerns forbearance itself, the latent link both channels share.

Trump-Era Outpost Expansion The state has the capacity to remove outposts; whether to use it is a government decision, and for established outposts it is generally taken only when the High Court compels it. Amona was evacuated in February 2017 because the High Court ordered it, after the government had stalled the order for over two years, and the evacuees were compensated with a new authorized settlement (see The Trump-Era Shift in U.S. Policy). Removal, in other words, is a court-driven exception rather than government policy; absent a court order, an outpost usually stays. Smotrich, then a coalition MK, described this on the Knesset floor in January 2017:

> "[. . .] A practice of illegal outposts came into being [. . .]. It was created **deliberately**, because governments wanted to **promote settlement activity**, each for its own reasons: political, diplomatic, security-related, ideological, a bargaining chip for negotiations [. . .]. On the other hand, they did not want to do it with great fanfare, **so as not to anger 'the uncle from America'**. So they created a complex practice. The Supreme Court comes along and

says: [. . .] either regularize or demolish. We cannot demolish everything: **we do not want to**, we do not believe in it, we are not willing." (The Knesset, 2017)[40]

This is what makes outpost emergence informative about forbearance: every new outpost that appears and remains is one the government could have removed and chose not to. If weaker constraints on forbearance made territorial encroachment easier to sustain, new outposts should therefore increasingly appear, and remain, where expansion was structurally most feasible. I examine this using the satellite-based outpost dates described in the Data section.

Because new outposts are rare, I work with a coarser 5 km cell-by-year panel. The key predictor is the geography-only suitability measure $\hat{E}_i^{NO}$, which holds the outpost-network covariates fixed so that variation across cells comes only from geography. To keep the prediction genuinely out of sample, I use a version of $\hat{E}_i^{NO}$ re-estimated on the shorter panel through 2011, and study new outpost formation from 2012 onward.[41]

The test is whether the relationship between geographic opportunity and new outpost formation becomes stronger after the political shock. I estimate

$$Y_{it} = \alpha_i + \lambda_t + \sum_{\tau \neq 2016} \beta_\tau \left(E_i^{rank} \cdot D_{t,\tau} \right) + Post_t \cdot \Gamma' N_i^0 + \eta_{it}, \tag{5}$$

where Y_{it} equals one if a new outpost appears in cell i during year t, and E_i^{rank} is the percentile rank of $\hat{E}_i^{NO}$.[42] The coefficients β_τ therefore show how strongly new outpost formation is associated with geographic opportunity in each year relative to 2016.

The specification also controls for the inherited outpost network at the start of 2017, N_i^0, interacted with the post-shock period. This ensures that the opportunity gradient is not simply picking up expansion around locations where outposts were already con-

[40] Plenary session of 30 January 2017, the week of the Amona evacuation, during a debate on Shabbat trading in Tel Aviv. Emphasis added.

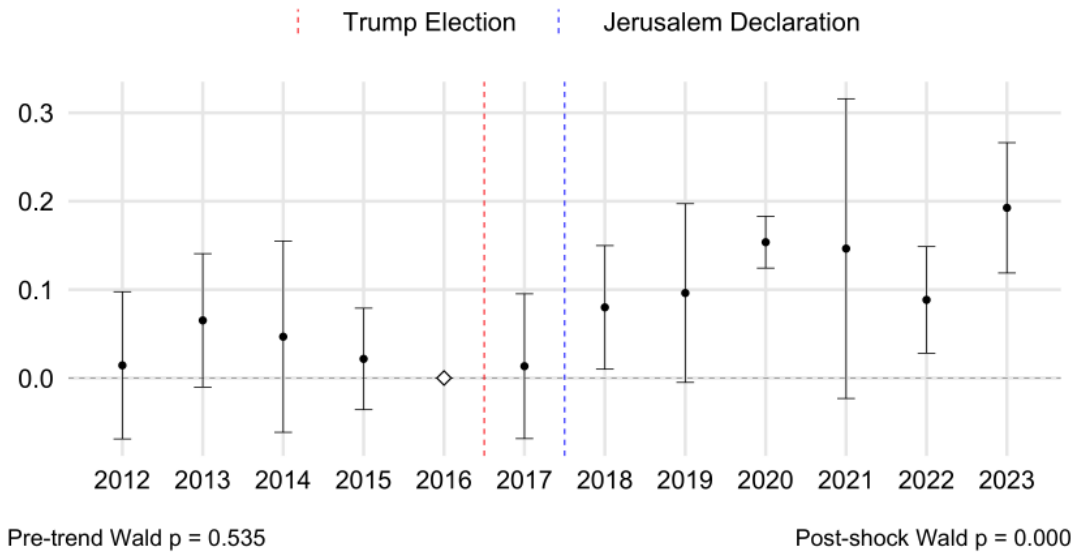
[41] Appendix Figure A.17 maps the resulting opportunity gradient across 5 km hex cells in the West Bank.

[42] Fixing the network covariates at common reference values scales $\hat{E}^{NO}$ by a factor common to all cells, and the measure is severely right-skewed; the rank transformation removes that factor and spreads identifying variation evenly across $[0, 1]$.

centrated.[43] Cell and year fixed effects absorb time-invariant differences across locations and aggregate changes in outpost formation, standard errors are Conley with a 15 km cutoff.

Figure 9 shows a clear change after the shock. Before 2017, the opportunity gradient does not differ from its 2016 level: the pre-period coefficients are jointly indistinguishable from zero. The gradient remains close to zero in 2017, but becomes positive from 2018 onward and stays elevated through the rest of the sample, reaching its largest value in 2023. The timing closely mirrors the violence results: the spatial shift in outpost expansion begins after the Jerusalem Declaration rather than immediately after Trump's election.

Figure 9: New Outpost Formation and Geographic Opportunity



Notes: Event-study estimates of equation (5) on a 5 km cell × year panel, 2012–2023, conditional on the inherited-network block N_i^0. Cell and year fixed effects; omitted year 2016; Conley standard errors with a 15 km cutoff. Vertical lines mark Trump's election and the Jerusalem Declaration. Coefficients identify where new outposts appear, not the total effect of the shock on expansion.

Table B.8 reports the corresponding static estimates. Moving from the bottom to the top of the opportunity distribution increases the annual probability of a new outpost

[43] N_i^0 is a snapshot of the local network at the start of 2017, the first post-shock year of the annual panel, built from outposts dated through 2016, including November–December: in-cell outpost stock (bins 0/1/2+), external outposts within 5 km, and distance to the nearest external outpost (bins). Because it is time-invariant and fixed before the post-period, its levels are absorbed by α_i and only the *Post* interactions enter. The reduced-form specification without these controls is reported in Appendix Figure A.18.

by 5.8 percentage points after 2017. Controlling for the inherited network raises the estimate to 8.1 percentage points, and the count specification produces a similar result. The key point is that post-shock expansion was not confined to places where outposts already existed: new outposts increasingly appeared in locations that were geographically suitable for further expansion but had previously remained empty. Since the data record only outposts still present in the October 2023 imagery, these estimates capture expansion the state let stand rather than every short-lived attempt at establishment.

Demolitions and evacuations are nonetheless frequent in the same areas, only not of outposts. The Civil Administration, which left these outposts standing, enforces planning law against Palestinian construction in Area C continuously and at scale.[44] For each outpost I measure the distance to the centroid of the nearest community in which a Palestinian structure was demolished in the twelve months after its founding. For 75% of the outposts founded in 2017–2023 that distance is below 5 km (91% within two years) and for 95% below 10 km, with a median of 3.0 km (Figure 10; Appendix Table B.10 adds the cell-level comparison). Over the same years the inventory records at most four demolitions among 107 new outposts, two of them re-established within months; since the inventory captures sites still standing in 2023, this counts removals among surviving outposts, not among all establishment attempts.

The annual series shows the same capacity (Appendix Figure A.20): B'Tselem's data yield 4,527 geocoded demolition records of Palestinian structures built without permits in the West Bank outside East Jerusalem between 2006 and March 2025. After the exceptional campaign of 2016,[45] demolitions continued at 150 to 190 recorded demolitions per year in 2017–2019 and intensified from 2020, exceeding 500 in 2022, while outpost formation rose to its highest levels.

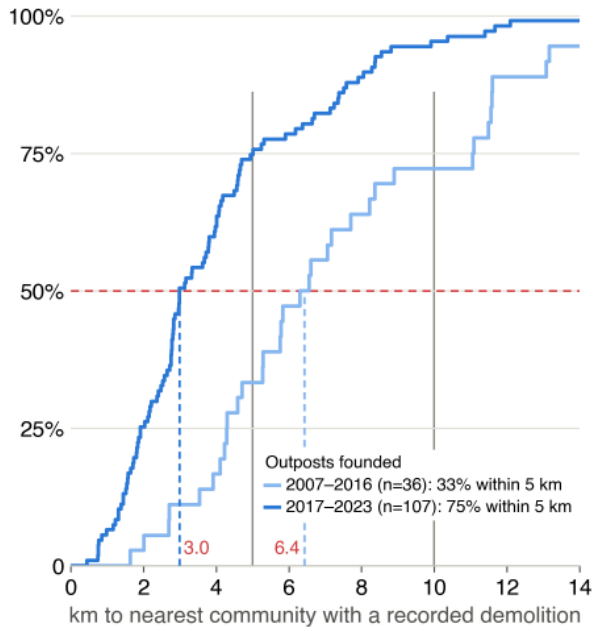
The Civil Administration's own records show the same asymmetry: of the demolition orders it issued in Area C between 1988 and 2014, 19.9% were executed against Palestinian structures and 12.3% against settlement structures, the latter mostly by the settlers themselves under relocation arrangements (United Nations Office for the Co-

[44] Permits are almost never granted: of the 2,550 applications Palestinians filed for construction in Area C in 2016–2020, 24 were approved (Peace Now, 2023).

[45] The 2016 spike is a concentrated campaign: 47% of that year's records fall in February–April and a third inside declared firing zones (13% in 2015). Khirbet Tana, a herding community in a firing zone near Nablus, was razed four times in those months (87 records), and the Bedouin communities slated for relocation around E1 account for much of the rest (United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs, 2017).

ordination of Humanitarian Affairs, 2015); in 2022 it demolished about a third of the Palestinian structures it had identified as illegal and a fifth of the settler ones, probably counting repeat demolitions of the same rebuilt hilltop shacks (Peace Now, 2023). Within Area C, the same administrative authority that demolished Palestinian structures a few kilometres from the outposts left the outposts standing: this asymmetry is a choice. These demolitions document administrative enforcement capacity exercised nearby and support the selective-enforcement reading; the policing and prosecution of settler violence itself is taken up below.

Figure 10: Distance from New Outposts to the Nearest Community with a Demolition



Notes: Cumulative distribution, by founding cohort, of the distance from each outpost to the nearest Palestinian community with a B'Tselem-recorded demolition in the twelve months after the outpost's founding. Dashed vertical lines mark cohort medians. Details in Appendix Table B.10.

The Domestic Accountability Environment In the model, forbearance is cheap when both the external and the domestic constraints on tolerating aligned violence are weak. The previous exhibits speak to the external side. On the domestic side, the first fact is that Right-bloc demands to punish settler violence are generally weak. To show this I consider every fatality of 2016–2023 between settlers and Palestinians, only when either a settler or a Palestinian is a perpetrator. I classify the topic-relevant Knesset speeches of the fifteen days following the event by whether they discuss the event, condemn the perpetrator, demand enforcement, or redirect attention to the other side's violence, and compare blocs responding to the same fatality (Appendix I). When the

perpetrator is Palestinian, Right-bloc speeches are more likely than Center-left speeches to condemn the perpetrator; when the perpetrator is a settler, the Right-bloc condemnation share falls to essentially zero and in some cases redirect attention to Palestinian violence instead (Appendix Table I.2).[46] Because the events pool the whole period, parliamentary speech shows that the domestic constraint was weak on average over the period but not whether it changed.

To see whether it did, I turn to the public responses of governing figures who held office throughout: whether they condemned the killing, backed the investigators, and demanded accountability. The inventory is every Palestinian whom B'Tselem records as killed by Israeli civilians in the West Bank in 2014–2019, cross-checked against ACLED and screened by circumstance and press coverage.[47] Responses are reconstructed for the fifteen days after the attack and after the first arrest or indictment. The central comparison is between the Duma arson of July 2015 and the killing of Aisha Rabi in October 2018. Both fall under the coalition formed in May 2015, with the same prime minister, justice minister, and education minister, so the same actors face comparable attacks on uninvolved civilians before and after the external constraint changed.

Before Trump's election, the government treated attacks on uninvolved civilians as crimes to be punished. Duma, in July 2015, was an arson attack on a Palestinian family's home that killed an infant; both parents later died of their burns. Netanyahu called it "a terror attack in every respect," the defense, justice, and education ministers backed the investigators, and within two days the Security Cabinet authorized administrative detention of Jewish suspects (Newman, 2015b; Oster, 2015). Opposition to enforcement existed inside the coalition even then: a cabinet minister called for closing the Shin Bet's Jewish Division and Smotrich, then a backbench MK, denied that the attack was terrorism, while Shaked, as justice minister, questioned the interrogation methods but affirmed the process (Times of Israel Staff, 2015; Newman, 2015a; Harkov, 2015).

Aisha Rabi, a Palestinian woman, was killed in October 2018 by a stone thrown at the car in which she was travelling with her husband and daughter. The Shin Bet suspected settlers within a day, yet no statement by Netanyahu, Bennett, or Shaked was located in the fifteen-day window; the one ministerial reaction, Yariv Levin's, called it

[46] Right-bloc parties sat in every governing coalition of 2016–2023.

[47] see Appendix H for additional information and Appendix Table B.9 for the list and description of the violent events.

"the scrap of an incident that hasn't even been checked" (Winer and Times of Israel Staff, 2018). After yeshiva students were arrested in late December, Shaked, as justice minister, told a suspect's mother that "it will end in the coming days" and met the families, while Smotrich and other coalition politicians attacked the investigation itself (Cheslow, 2019; Magid, 2019b; Reuters, 2019). Netanyahu defended the Shin Bet in general terms but said nothing about the case (Porat, 2019); prosecutors nonetheless indicted a suspect for manslaughter as a terrorist act on 24 January (Magid, 2019a). The condemnation that Netanyahu and Bennett offered on Duma did not come on Rabi, and Shaked moved from vouching for the process to reassuring the suspects' families; contemporary reporting drew the same contrast (Magid, 2019c).

By 2023, under a different coalition, the position belonged to ministers with direct authority over enforcement. After the Huwara rampage of February 2023, in which hundreds of settlers burned homes and cars in the town after two settlers were shot dead there, Netanyahu asked settlers not to "take the law into your hands" without demanding prosecution; Smotrich, responsible for the Civil Administration, said Huwara "needs to be wiped out... the State of Israel should do it"; and fifty coalition members, including National Security Minister Ben Gvir, demanded the release of riot suspects held in administrative detention, a demand Defense Minister Gallant rejected (Times of Israel Staff, 2023b; Bachner, 2023; Times of Israel Staff, 2023a). No one was indicted for the rampage, nor for the killing of Sameh Aqtash in nearby Za'tara the same night (Shezaf, 2025).

The Enforcement Record Police figures point the same way. The police district for the West Bank served 85 indictments for nationalistic crime by Israelis in 2015, the year of Duma; in 2018–2022 the annual count was 39, 24, 18, 19, and 10 (Yesh Din, 2017, 2021, 2022, 2023).[48] Over the same years, OCHA's count of settler attacks causing Palestinian casualties or property damage rose from 228 in 2015 to 852 in 2022 (OCHA, 2026), and ACLED's count of settler-perpetrated events more than doubled between 2018 and 2022 (Appendix Figure A.19). In Yesh Din's own monitored sample, the share of files closed without indictment rose from 91.6% as of 2015 to over 96% in 2020–2025, and the last killing by an Israeli civilian to lead to an indictment was Aisha Rabi's (Yesh Din, 2015;

[48]Israel Police figures provided to Yesh Din under the Freedom of Information Act, category "Israeli disorderly conduct and Jewish nationalistic crime". The police did not answer the request for 2016, and no figures for 2017 were published. The 2015 count includes files opened earlier; indictments in files opened in 2015 alone numbered 59 by year-end.

Graham-Harrison, 2026). The same figure plots recorded confrontations between the security apparatus and settlers as a share of settler-perpetrated events: the share falls from 3.6 percent in 2016 to 1.2 percent in 2023.[49] Administrative detention of Jewish suspects, the measure the cabinet adopted after Duma, was discontinued in November 2024 (Sokol, 2024). The U.S. reversal relaxed the external constraint; the mechanism requires only that forbearance became cheaper at the margin, not that domestic constraints disappeared.

Robustness Checks

Reverse Causality I estimate whether the probability that a new outpost appears in a cell depends on violence in that cell over the preceding twelve months. Figure C.1 shows that the lag coefficients are individually small and insignificant, and jointly insignificant within each family of lags.

Havat Gilad Killing Excluding the area surrounding Havat Gilad, Nablus and Yitzhar, as discussed in the Timing and Local Triggers subsection, leaves the post-treatment coefficients positive and significant (Appendix Figure C.2).

Reporting ACLED relies on media reports. To account for possible overcounting, I multiply each cell-month count of settler attacks by the ratio of Palestinians killed by settlers in B'Tselem's records to those in ACLED, computed for treated and control cells before and after November 2016. The ratios range from 0.17 to 0.50, and the adjusted estimates remain statistically significant (Appendix Figure C.3).

Matching on Geography and Settlement Presence The suitability measure may capture generic conflict geography, or simply where settlers already live, rather than exposure to the radical frontier. I re-estimate the main specification on a matched sample. Each treated cell is paired with its nearest control cell (Mahalanobis distance, with replacement) on elevation, slope, terrain ruggedness, distance to a major road, distance to a Palestinian village, distance to the nearest settlement, and 2016 Israeli population. Matching substantially improves covariate balance (Table D.1). The estimates are somewhat attenuated but the pattern is unchanged (Table D.2; Figure C.4).

Alternative Suitability Thresholds I vary the percentile cutoff defining high-suitability areas (95th, 97.5th, and 99th). The post-shock increase is consistently positive and

[49] The spike in 2017 reflects the court-ordered evacuation of Amona.

significant across all thresholds (Figure C.5).

Alternative Buffer Sizes I vary the buffer radius from 1 to 4 km in 0.5 km steps. The estimates are stable, with expected attenuation at larger buffers as the suitability signal dilutes spatially (Figures C.6 and C.7).

Donut Design To address potential spillovers from treated to adjacent control cells, I exclude control cells directly bordering the treated area. The estimates are broadly similar to the baseline (Figure C.8; map in Figure C.9).

Spatial Placebo I exclude treated cells and reassign treatment to the adjacent ring. The placebo coefficients are small and insignificant, confirming that the effects are localized to high-suitability cells (Figure C.10; map in Figure C.11).

Geographic Leave-Out To check that the results are not driven by a few influential locations, I iteratively drop each treated cell and its adjacent treated neighbors (clusters of up to five cells)[50] and re-estimate the static TWFE. The results hold (Figures C.12 and C.13).

Conclusion

This paper asks why governments sometimes tolerate violence they have the capacity to stop. The answer developed here is that non-enforcement can itself be politically useful: when violent actors pursue goals political authorities partly share, governments need not organize, direct, or bargain with them—it may be enough to punish them less.

The West Bank provides evidence consistent with this argument. After the Trump-era shift in U.S. policy, settler violence against Palestinians rises sharply along the radical outpost frontier, with the main escalation following the December 2017 Jerusalem Declaration and no reversal through 2023. Where it rises is especially revealing: not simply near Israeli settlements or where radical settlers were already present, but where further territorial expansion was feasible. Palestinian violence against settlers, by contrast, follows existing settler presence rather than territorial opportunity, and new unauthorized outposts later concentrate in the same high-opportunity areas. The pattern is therefore not just one of more violence, but of violence moving toward places where it could change what radical settlers call *facts on the ground*.

The reduced-form estimates establish where and when violence responded to the shift.

[50] More specifically: $\min(5,\ 1 + \text{number of adjacent treated cells})$.

The supporting evidence on forbearance points the same way. The Civil Administration demolished Palestinian structures near the outposts it left standing. Right-wing blocs condemn the killers when Palestinians kill settlers, not when settlers kill Palestinians. Leaders who called the Duma arson terrorism in 2015 did not condemn the killings of 2017–18, and the justice minister intervened for the suspects. Recorded IDF–settler confrontations stay rare as settler violence expands. With domestic pressure weak before the shock and weaker after it, the Trump-era shift relaxed the external constraint that remained.

The broader contribution is to show how little organization may be required for governments to benefit from non-state violence. Where existing accounts rely on delegation or exchange, here private actors act on their own, yet their actions advance goals political authorities share: by deciding how costly those actions will be, the state can restrain them or let them spread without ever issuing an order. The mechanism should matter wherever domestic accountability is weak and private violence can produce durable political gains, and it may become self-reinforcing. By 2023, politicians aligned with the settler movement held ministerial authority over policy areas relevant to policing, planning, land administration, and enforcement (Chacar, 2022; Williams, 2022). At that point the problem is no longer simply that the state looks away, but that the boundary between those who commit violence and those responsible for restraining it begins to narrow.

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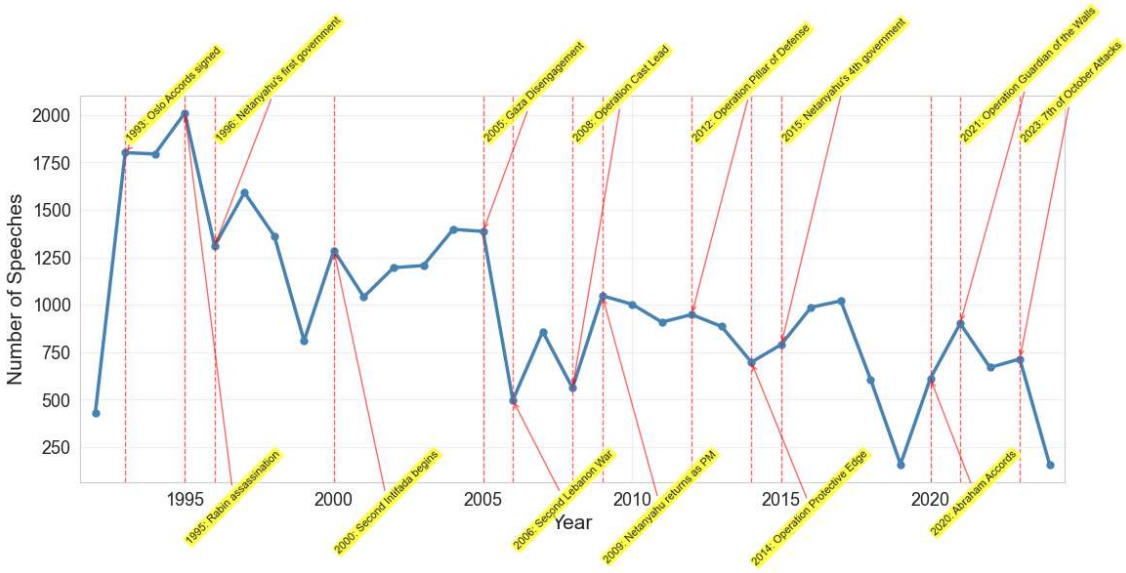
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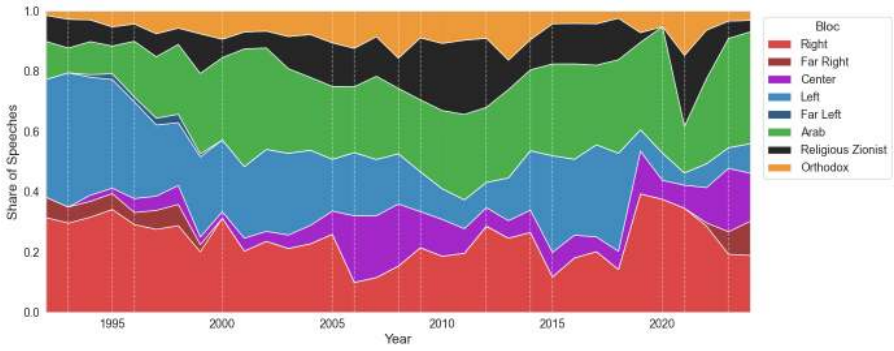
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A. Figures

Figure A.1: Knesset Speech Data



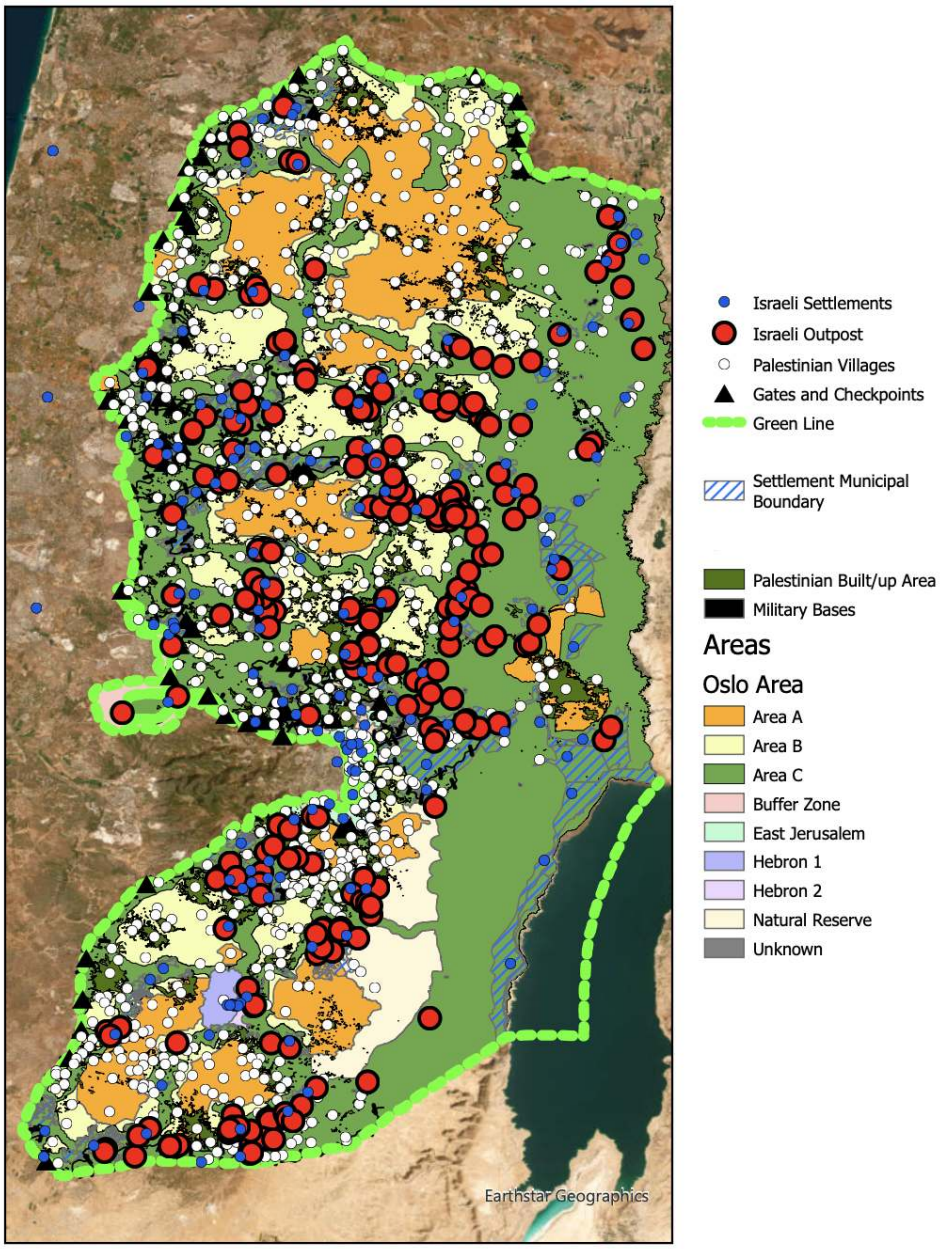
(a) Number of speeches by year



(b) Share of speeches by bloc

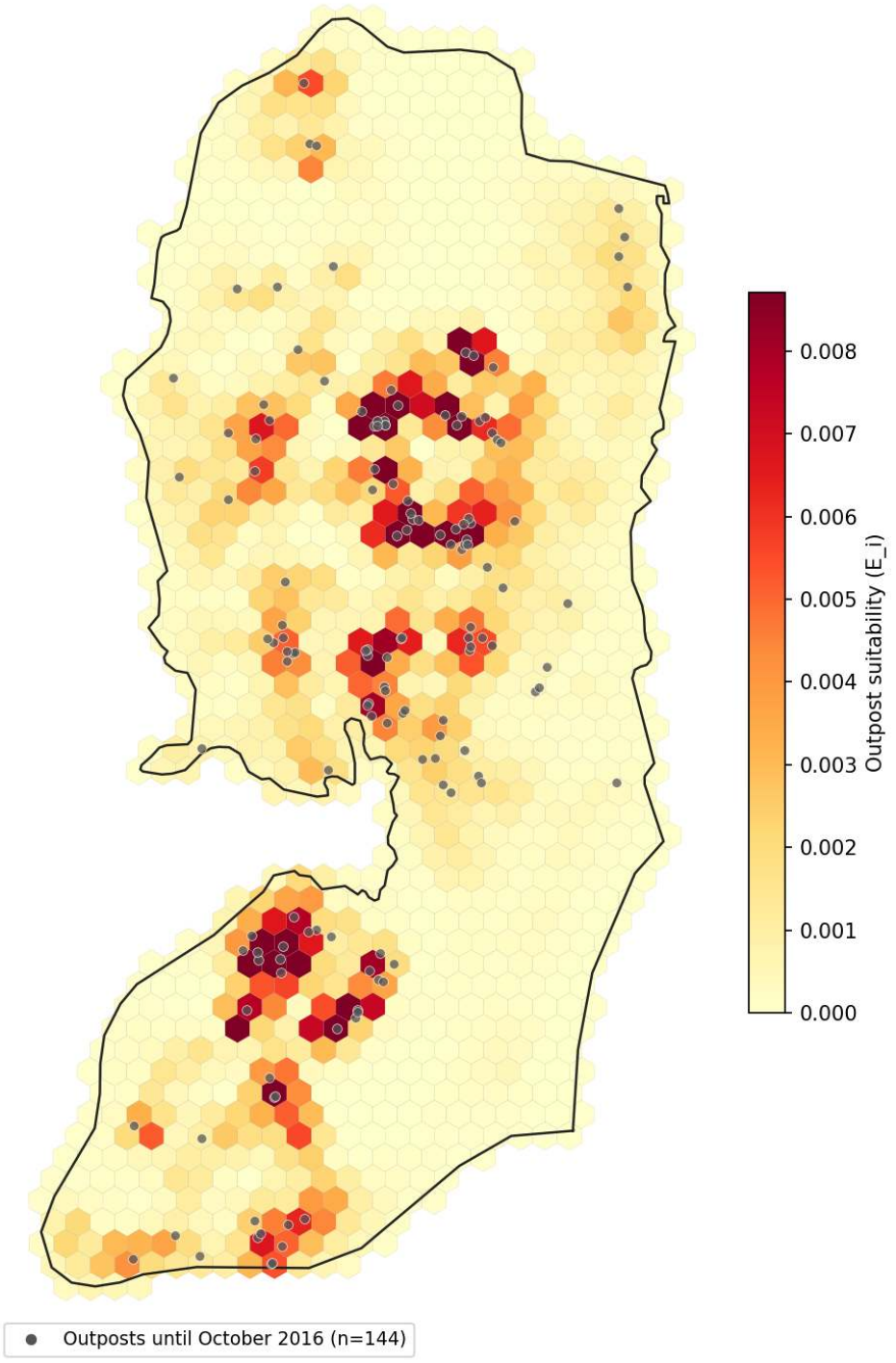
Notes: Knesset speeches on the occupied territories; panel (a) marks major events in the conflict. Source: Goldin et al. (2025), filtered as in the Data section; party blocs in Appendix Table I.4.

Figure A.2: Map of the West Bank



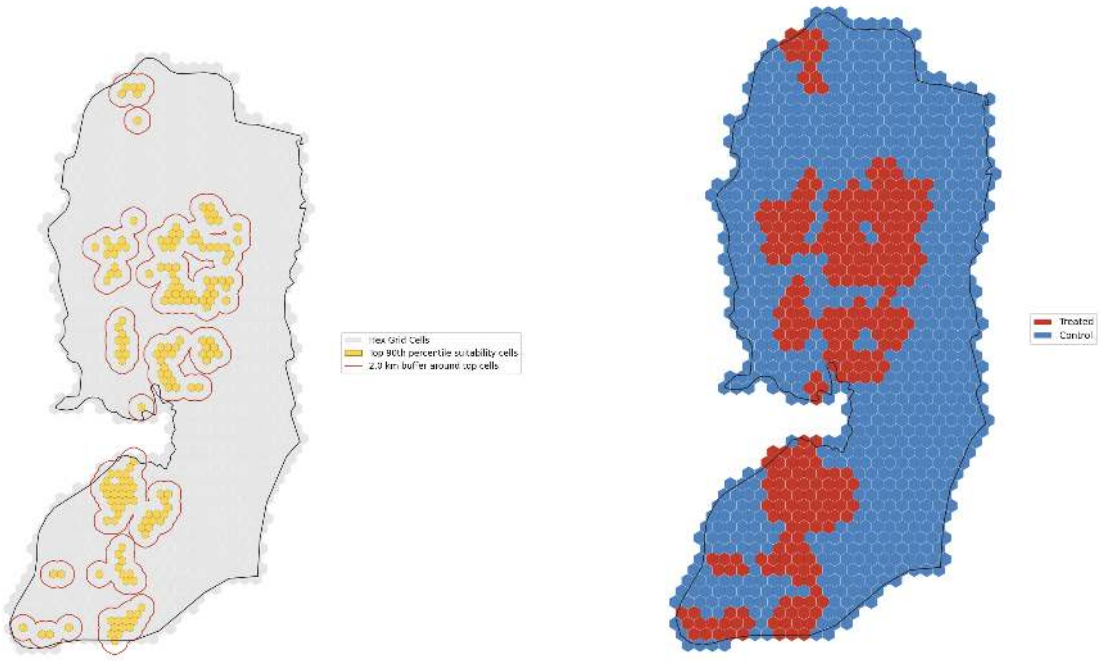
Notes: Map of the West Bank. Point geometries include Palestinian towns and villages (white dots), Israeli settlements (blue dots), Israeli outposts (red dots). Polygon geometries include Oslo Areas partitions, settlement municipality areas, Palestinian built-up areas and military bases. Source: B'Tselem (2025a) and Peace Now (2024).

Figure A.3: Outpost Suitability Map



Notes: Predicted outpost suitability $\hat{E}_i$ for each hex cell, estimated from the PPML model on 1990–2016 outpost expansion data. Darker cells indicate higher predicted suitability.

Figure A.4: Treatment Construction Maps

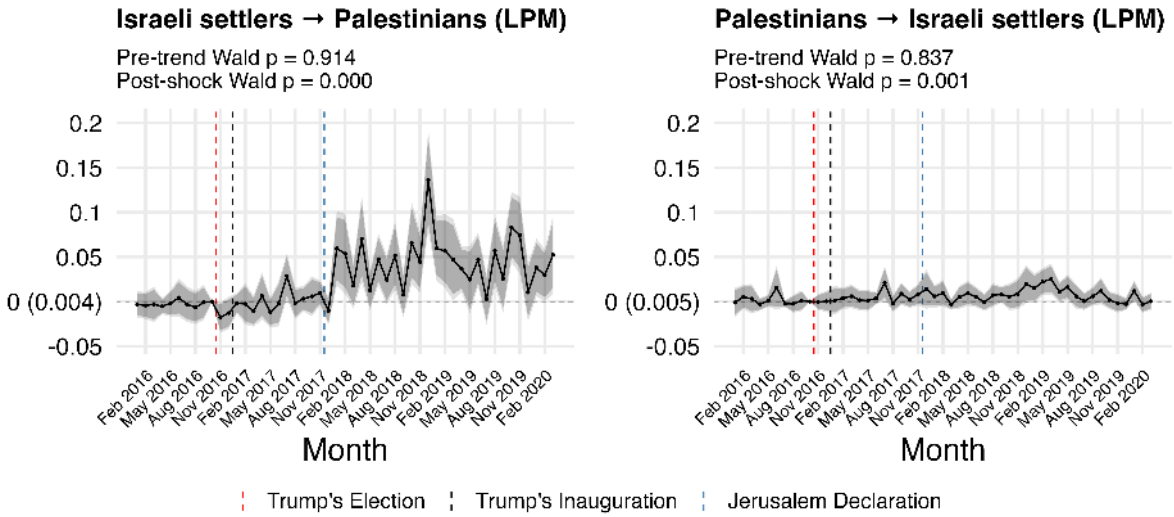


(a) Top 10% Suitability + 2 km Buffer

(b) Treated and Control Cells

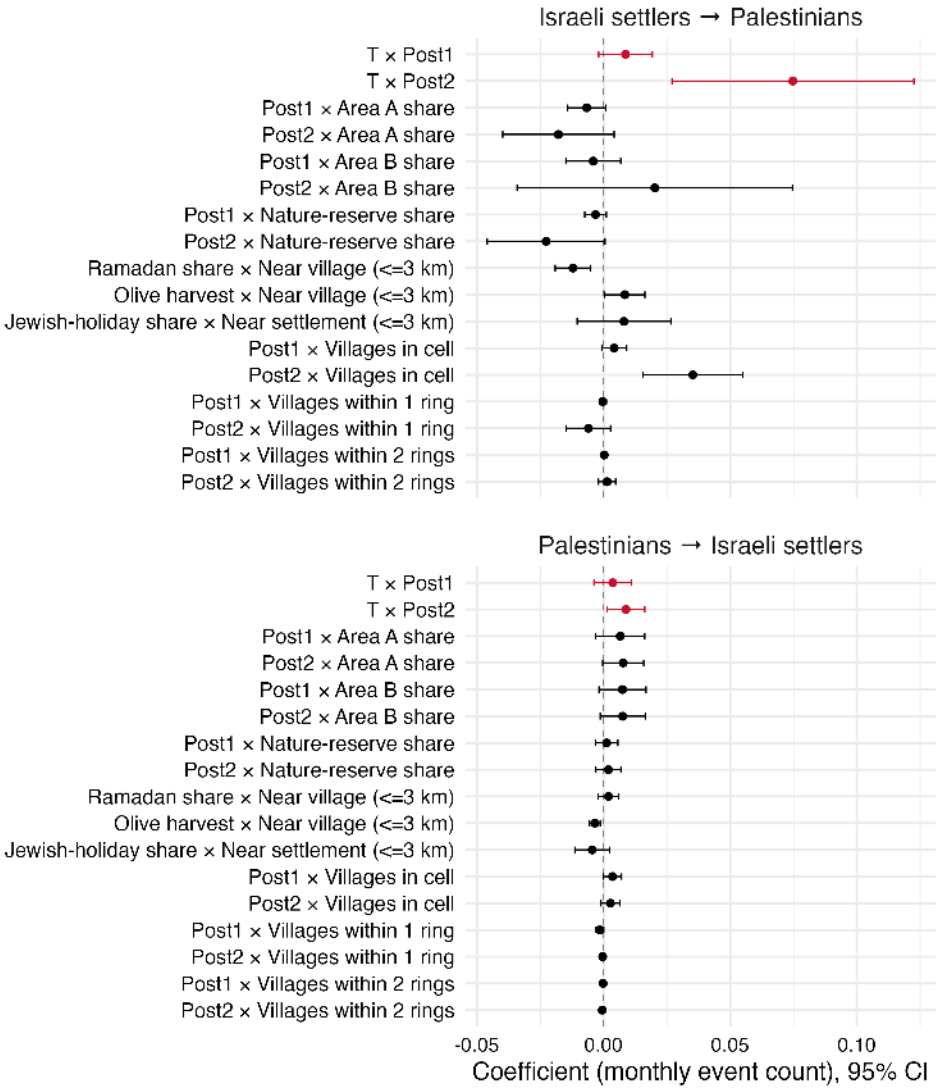
Notes: Panel (a) shows the top-decile suitability cells and the 2 km buffer used to construct the treatment area. Panel (b) shows the resulting treated (red) and control (blue) grid cells.

Figure A.5: Event-Study Estimates: Settler–Palestinian Violence (LPM)



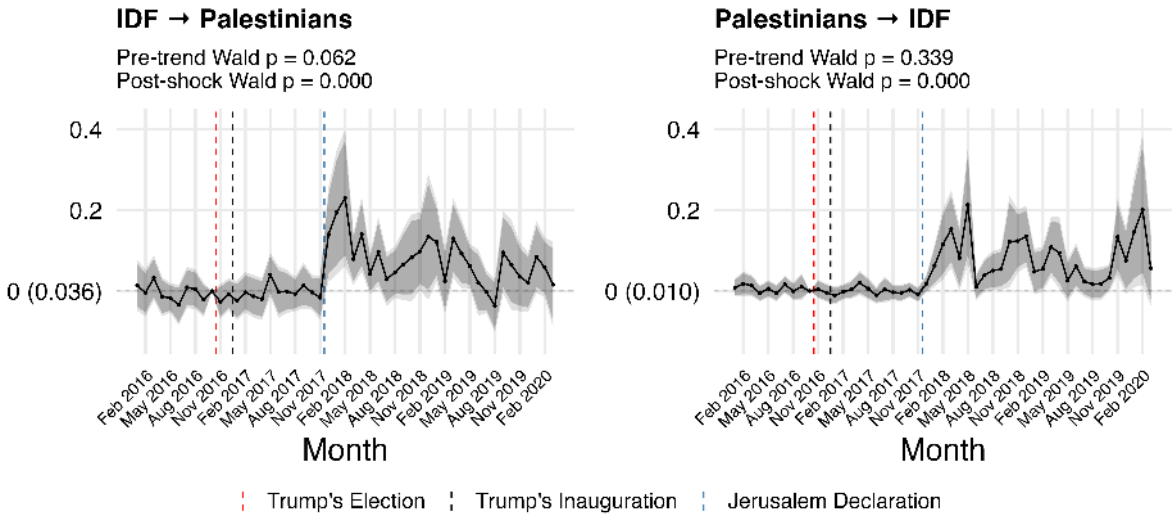
Notes: Event-study coefficients from equation (2), monthly incidence (LPM). Specification, bands, and vertical lines as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean of the outcome.

Figure A.6: Treatment Effects and Control Coefficients: Static Specification



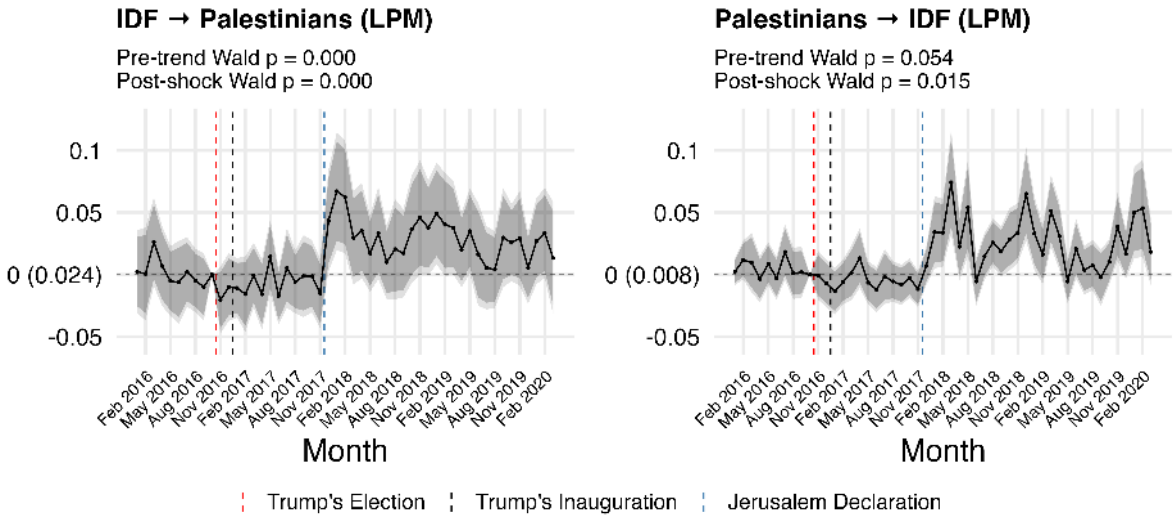
Notes: Coefficients and 95% confidence intervals from Table B.3, columns (3) and (6), monthly event counts. Red: treatment terms $T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (November 2016 to November 2017) and $T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (December 2017 to March 2020). Black: the controls described in the table notes. The panels share the horizontal axis.

Figure A.7: Event-Study Estimates: IDF–Palestinian Violence



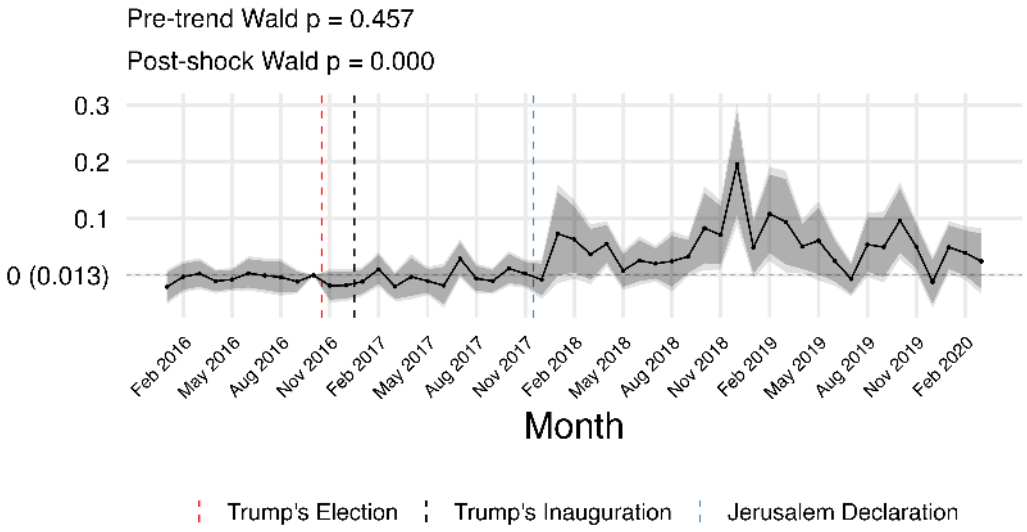
Notes: Event-study coefficients from equation (2), monthly event counts. Specification, bands, and vertical lines as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean of the outcome.

Figure A.8: Event-Study Estimates: IDF–Palestinian Violence (LPM)

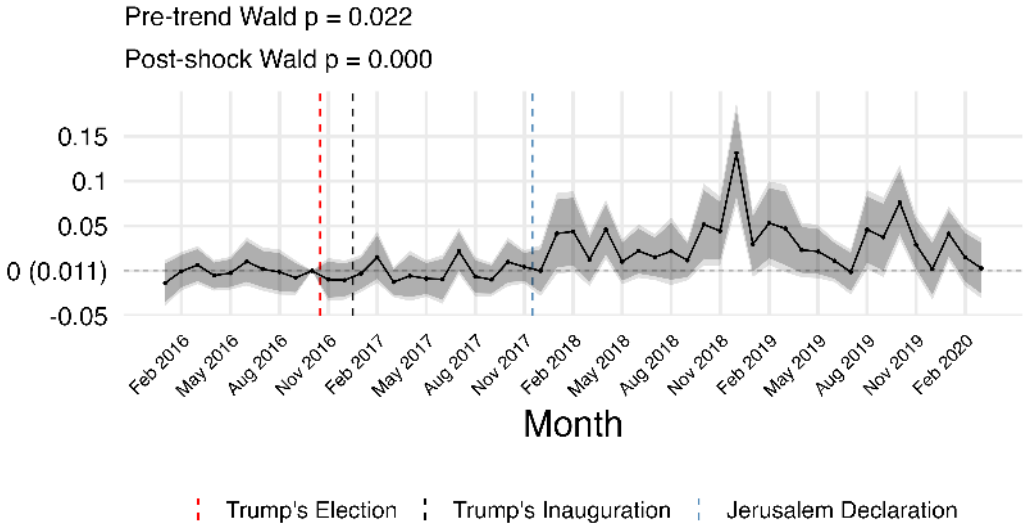


Notes: Event-study coefficients from equation (2), monthly incidence (LPM). Specification, bands, and vertical lines as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean of the outcome.

Figure A.9: Event-Study Estimates: Civilian Targeting



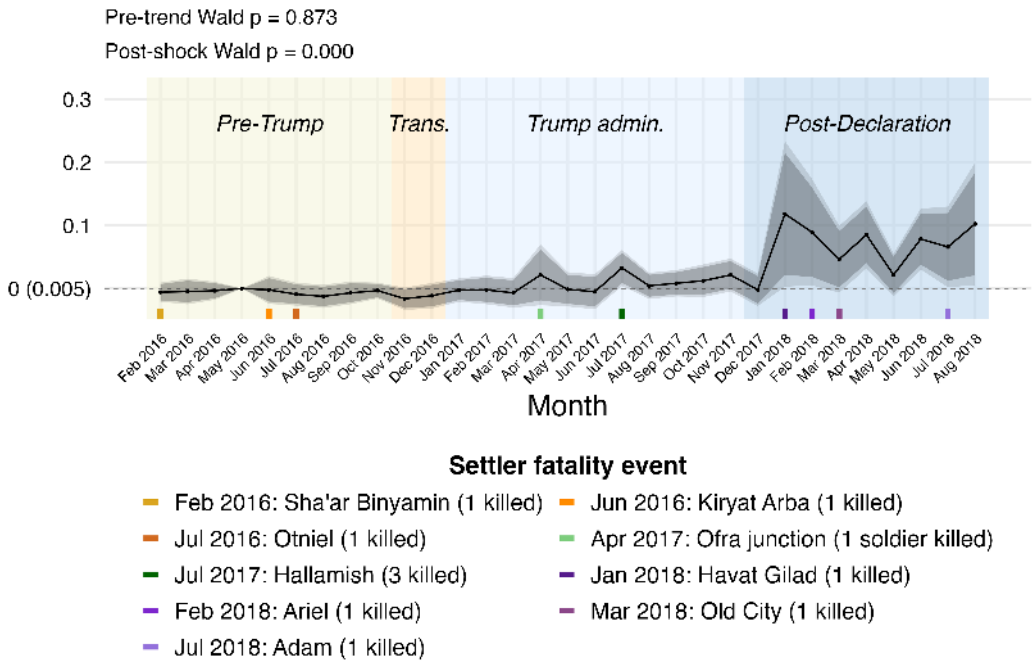
(a) Civilian Targeting: Event counts



(b) Civilian Targeting: LPM

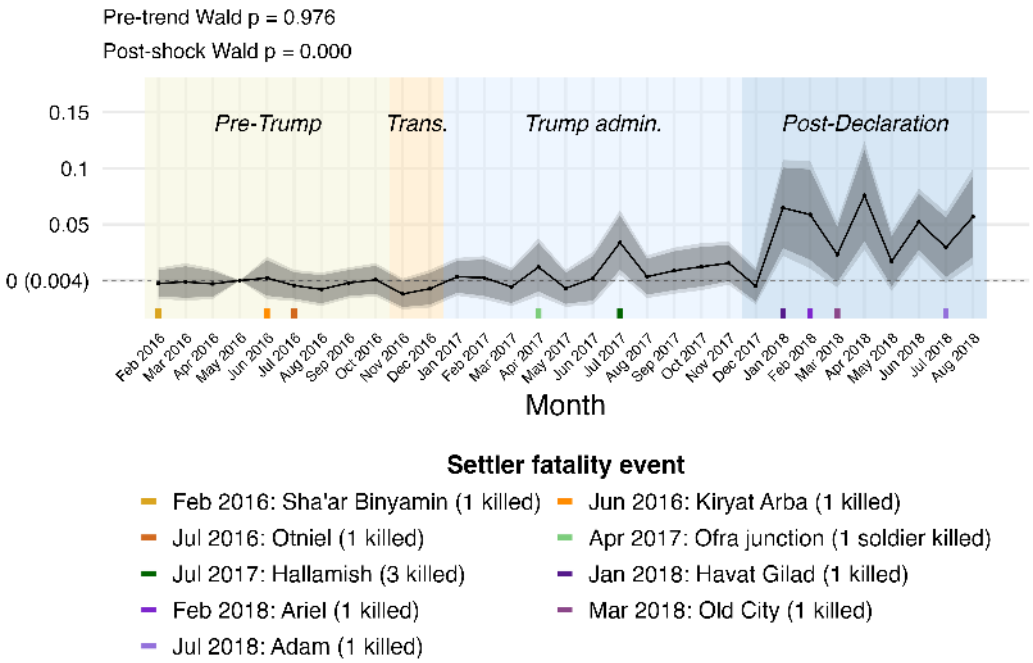
Notes: Event-study coefficients from equation (2): monthly event counts in panel (a), incidence (LPM) in panel (b). Specification, bands, and vertical lines as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean of the outcome.

Figure A.10: Settler Violence after Fatal Attacks on Settlers



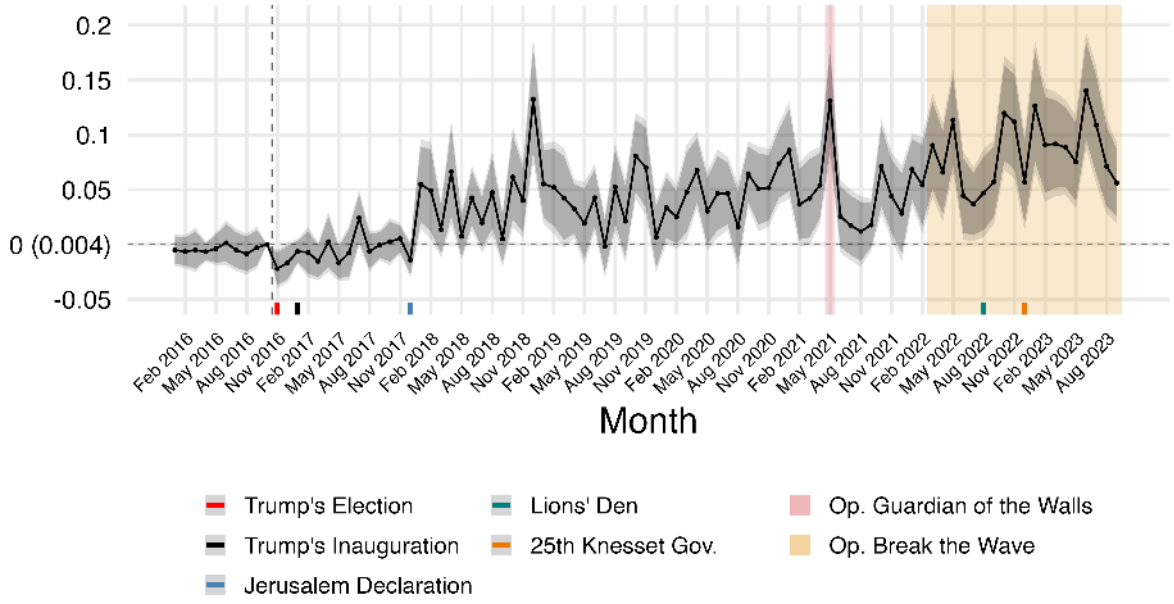
Notes: Event-study coefficients for settler violence against Palestinians, monthly event counts, February 2016 to August 2018; omitted month May 2016, before the first fatal attacks of summer 2016. Shading marks political periods; colored ticks mark fatal attacks on settlers and, in April 2017, a soldier. Specification and bands as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean.

Figure A.11: Settler Violence after Fatal Attacks on Settlers (LPM)

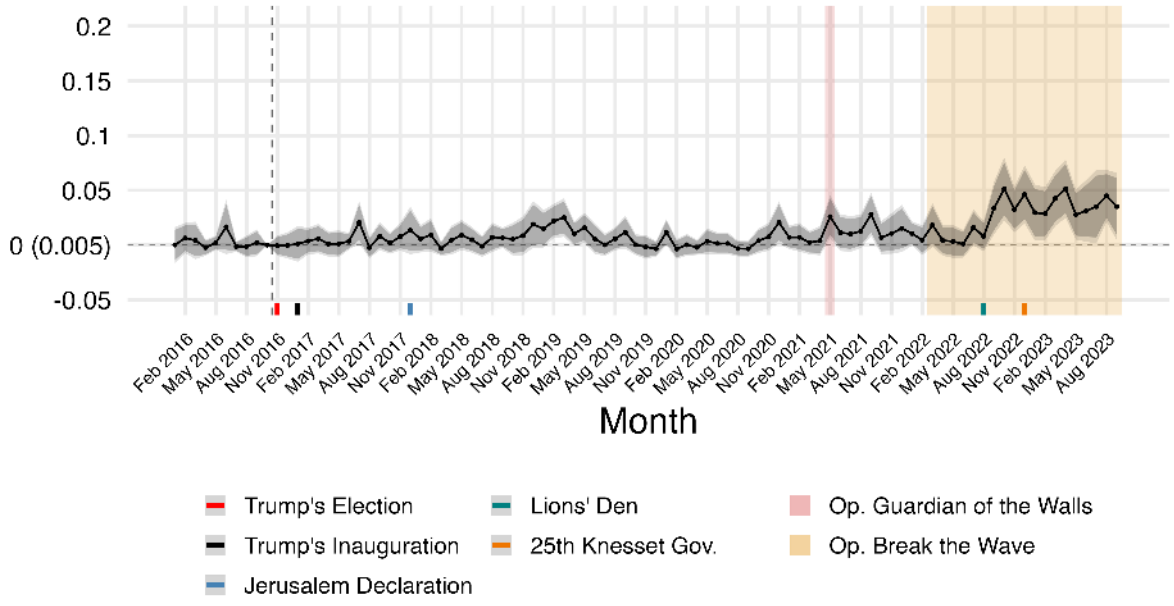


Notes: Linear-probability counterpart of Figure A.10: the outcome equals one if a cell-month has at least one settler attack on Palestinians. Omitted month, shading, ticks, and bands as in that figure. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean.

Figure A.12: Event-Study Estimates: Settler–Palestinian Violence, Extended Sample (LPM)



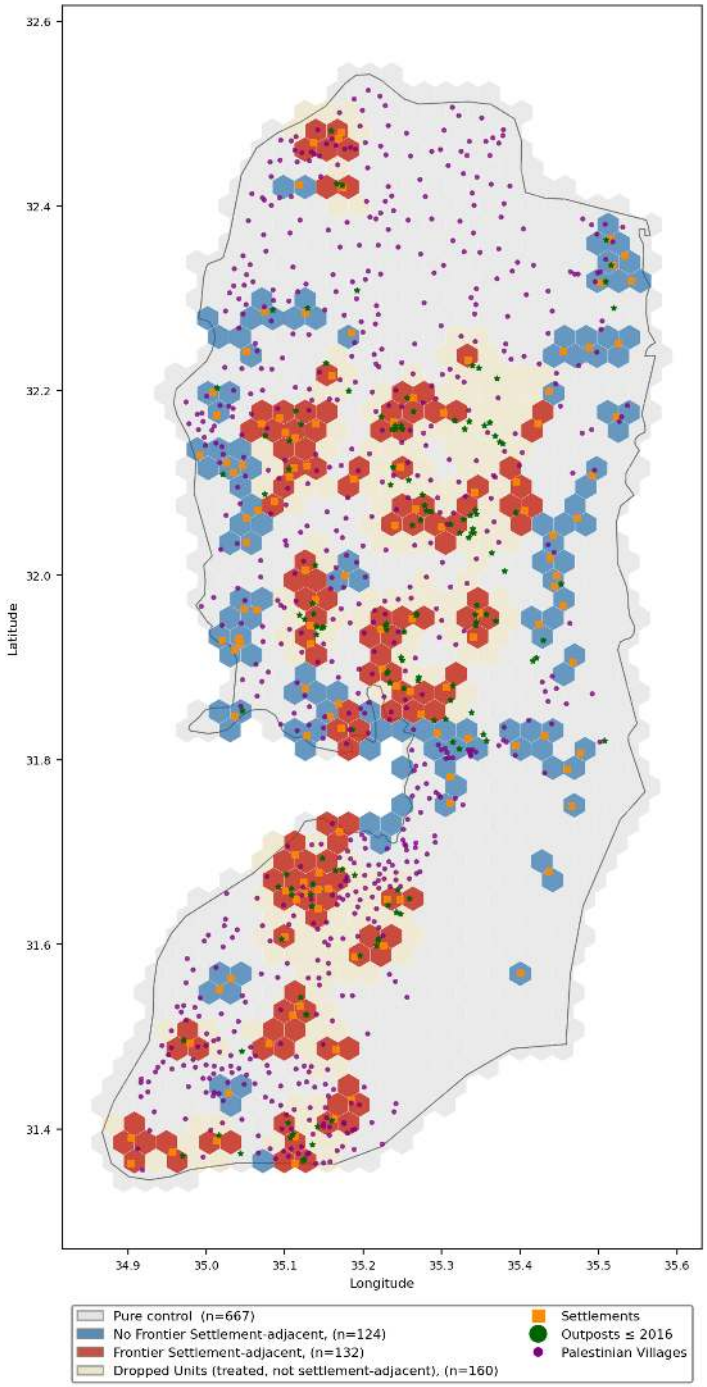
(a) Israeli Settlers → Palestinians



(b) Palestinians → Israeli Settlers

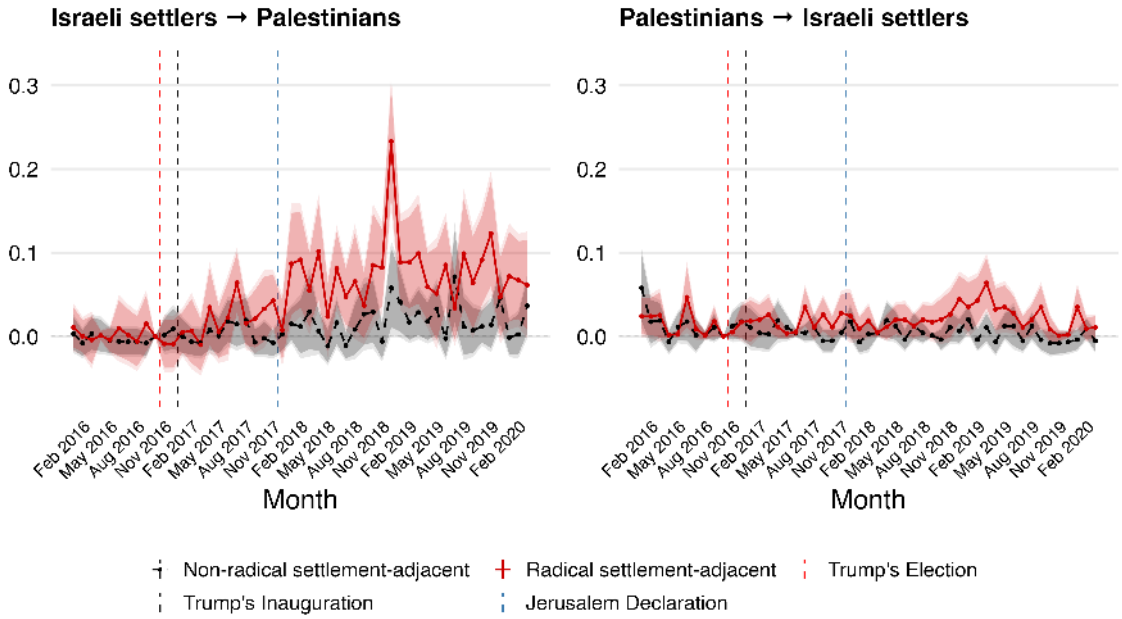
Notes: Linear-probability counterpart of Figure 5, monthly incidence. Markers, shading, and bands as in that figure. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean.

Figure A.13: Settlement Proximity vs. Radical Frontier: Groups across the West Bank



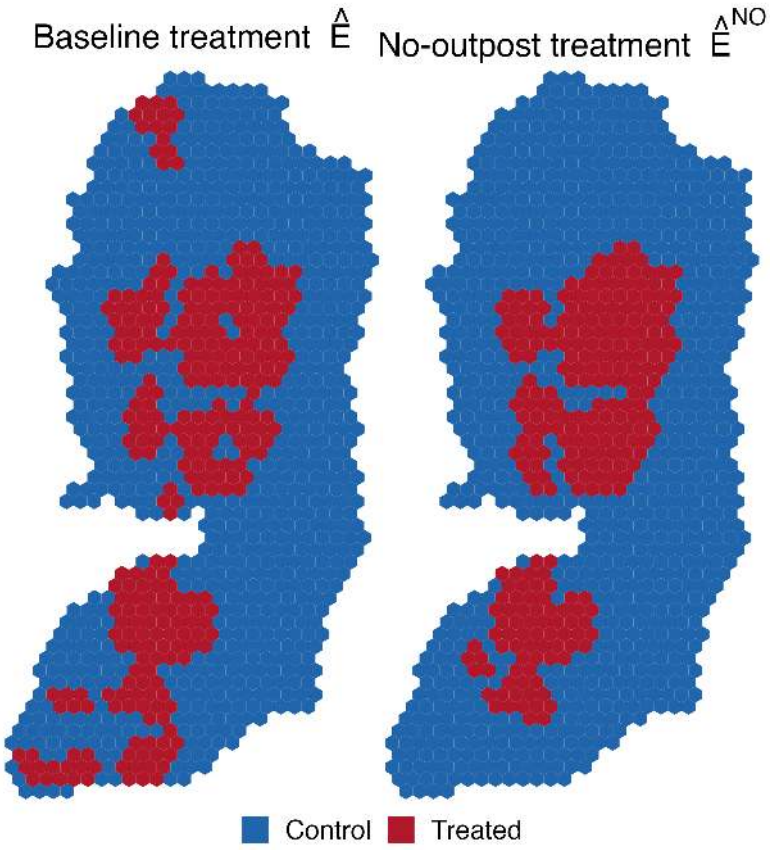
Notes: Spatial distribution of the three sample groups used in the two-arm event study in The Geography of Violence. Grey cells: pure controls (not settlement-adjacent, not in high outpost-suitability zone). Blue cells: non-frontier settlement-adjacent ($N_i = 1$, within 2 km of a settlement, outside high-suitability zone). Red cells: frontier settlement-adjacent ($R_i = 1$, within 2 km of a settlement and in high-suitability zone). Beige cells: high-suitability cells not adjacent to a settlement, dropped. Orange squares: established settlement centroids. Green stars: outposts established by 2016. Purple dots: Palestinian villages.

Figure A.14: Settlement Proximity vs. Radical Frontier: Event-Study Estimates (LPM)



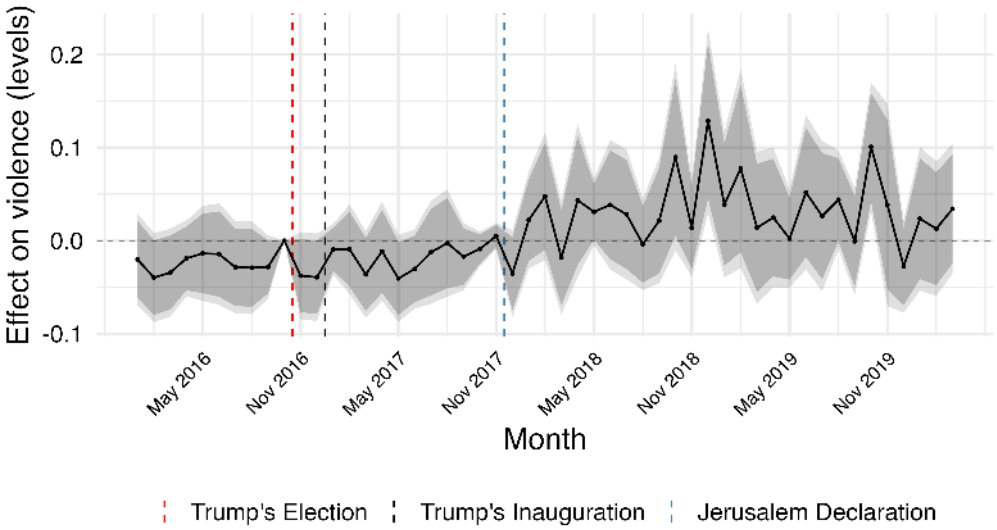
Notes: Linear-probability counterpart of Figure 7, monthly incidence. Arms, control group, bands, and vertical lines as in that figure.

Figure A.15: Treatment Construction Map: Baseline vs. No-outpost Design($\hat{E}^{NO}$)



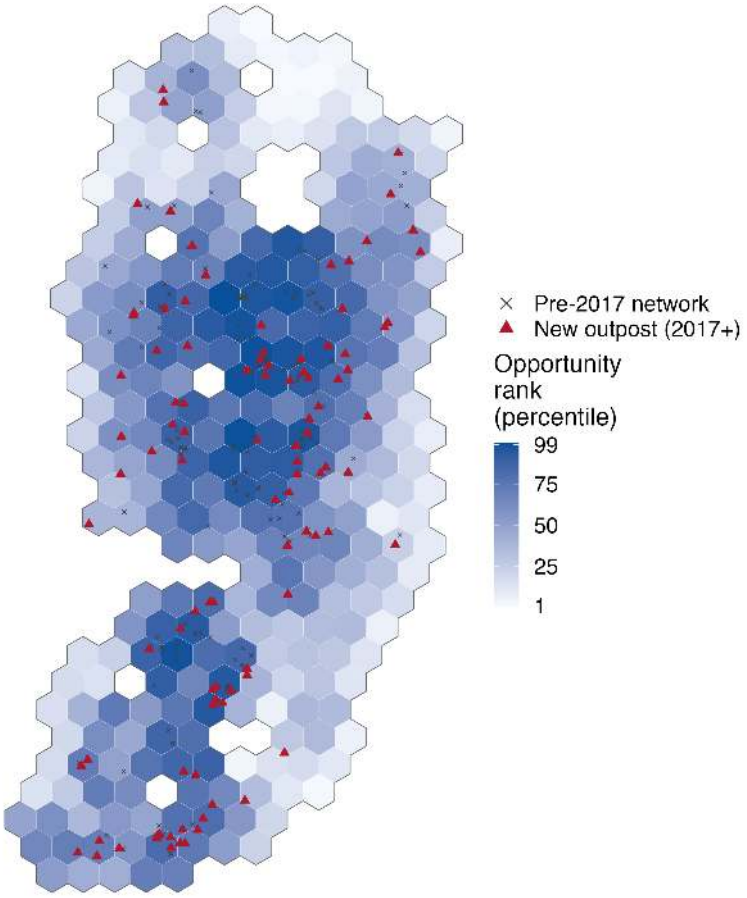
Notes: Treatment map comparing the baseline design (left) with the no-outpost-network design ($\hat{E}^{NO}$). Both apply the top-decile, 2 km buffer, and 50% overlap rule.

Figure A.16: Opportunity Effect in Cells with No Pre-Shock Outpost Within 2 km



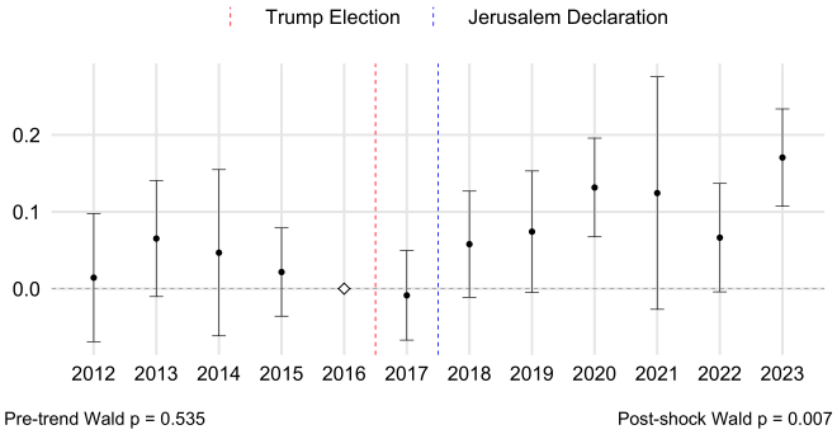
Notes: Event-study estimates of the no-outpost-network opportunity effect (T_i^{NO}) restricted to cells with no pre-November-2016 outpost within 2 km ($O_i = 0$). Outcome: settler violence against Palestinians. Vertical lines and bands as in Figure 4.

Figure A.17: Geographic Opportunity Gradient Across the West Bank



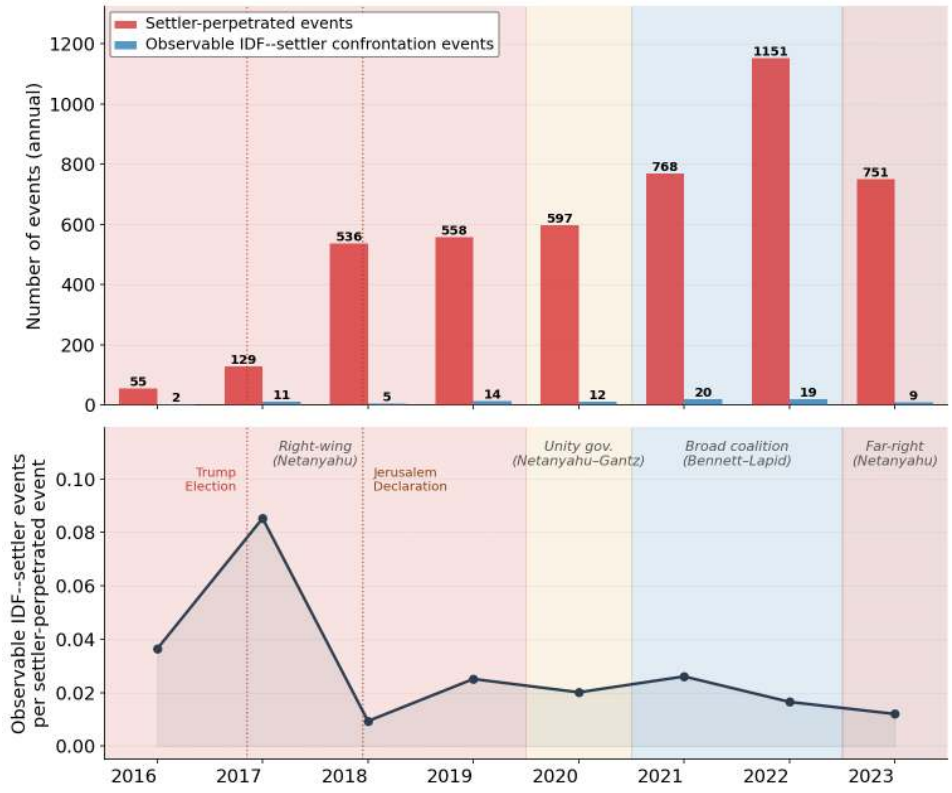
Notes: Percentile rank E_i^{rank} of the geographic-opportunity measure $\hat{E}_i^{NO}$ across 5 km grid hex cells in the West Bank. Darker shading indicates higher opportunity for new outpost formation.

Figure A.18: Event Study: New Outpost Formation and Geographic Opportunity (Reduced Form)



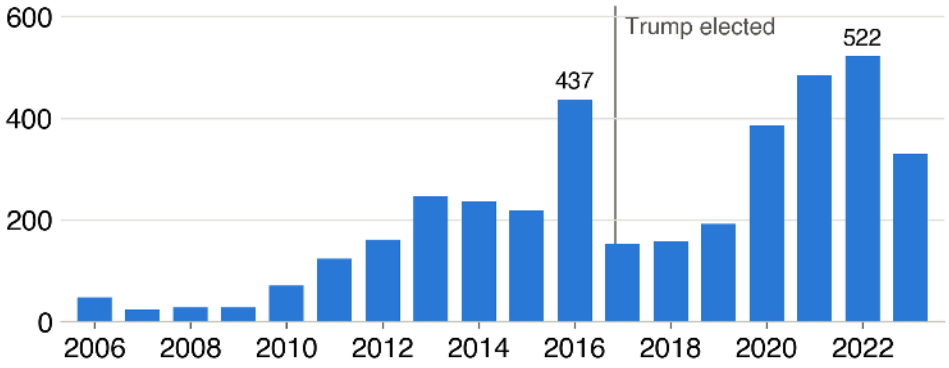
Notes: Reduced-form counterpart to Figure 9, omitting the inherited-network block N_i^0; otherwise as in that figure. Joint Wald tests for pre- and post-shock coefficients appear at the bottom of the panel.

Figure A.19: Institutional Forbearance: Settler Violence and Recorded IDF–Settler Confrontations

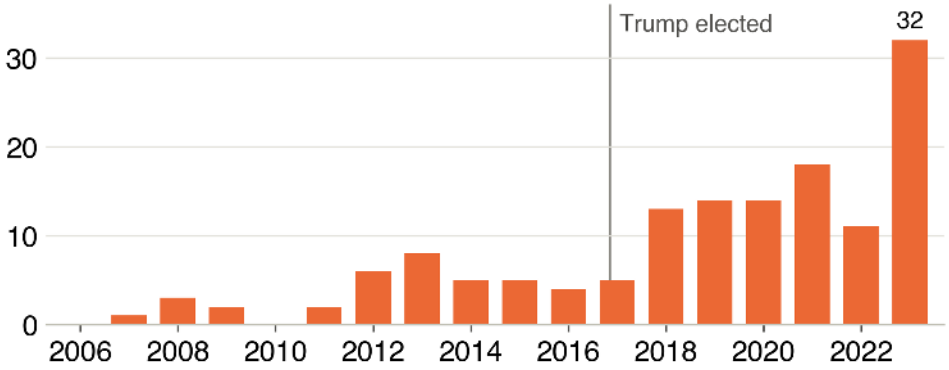


Notes: Top panel: Settler perpetrated events (red bar), confrontation between Israeli authorities and settlers (blue bar). Bottom panel: share of confrontation events over total settler-perpetrated events. The shaded areas track the different governing coalitions from 2016 to 2023. The red-dashed line represents Trump's election.

Figure A.20: Revealed Enforcement Capacity: Palestinian Demolitions and New Outposts, Annual Series



(a) Recorded demolitions of Palestinian structures for lack of a permit, per year



(b) New unauthorized outposts, per year

Notes: Panel (a): B'Tselem records of Palestinian structures demolished for lack of a building permit, West Bank excluding East Jerusalem; a record may cover several structures. Panel (b): new unauthorized outposts per year in the inventory used in the Encroachment and Forbearance section. Both panels cover 2006–2023; the vertical line marks November 2016.

B. Tables

Table B.1: Validation of the Outpost Suitability Index (PPML)

Panel A: PPML Model Fit		
Estimation observations	47,088	
Total new outposts	144	
Log-likelihood	-767.57	
AIC	1599.14	
Panel B: Predictive Performance (Post-Election Outposts)		
	PPML	Naive intensity
AUC-ROC (2017 outposts)	0.835	0.863
AUC-ROC (2018 outposts)	0.769	0.650
AUC-ROC (2017–2018 outposts)	0.791	0.718
Panel C: Institutional Geography by Suitability Quartile		
Area C share (lowest quartile)	49.5%	
Area C share (second quartile)	72.6%	
Area C share (third quartile)	81.0%	
Area C share (highest quartile)	90.2%	

Notes: The suitability index E_i is constructed from a PPML model of unauthorized outpost-expansion intensity estimated on pre-election data (1990 through October 2016). The dependent variable is the number of new outposts appearing in cell i during year t. Unlike a first-emergence hazard model, this specification does not remove cells from the risk set once an outpost appears, capturing the local intensity of the radical outpost frontier. After estimation, the outpost network is frozen at its pre-election configuration and E_i is defined as the fitted terminal pre-shock intensity. Panel A reports in-sample model fit statistics. Panel B evaluates out-of-sample predictive performance for outposts established after the election using the area under the ROC curve (AUC). The naive intensity benchmark is the raw count of pre-election outposts per cell, included to assess the value added by the model's geographic and frontier covariates over simple historical clustering. Panel C reports the average share of hex-cell area located in Oslo Area C across quartiles of the suitability index.

Table B.2: Pre-treatment Balance: Treated vs. Control Hex Cells

	Control Mean	Treated Mean	Difference (Trt − Ctrl)	SMD	p-value
Panel A: Hex-cell geography (pre-period mean)					
Elevation (mean, m)	215.227	600.990	385.764***	1.289	0.000
Slope (mean, deg)	9.996	11.703	1.706***	0.400	0.000
Terrain ruggedness	13.565	15.483	1.918***	0.327	0.000
Distance to road (km)	2.653	1.379	-1.275***	-0.619	0.000
Distance to village (km)	3.148	1.387	-1.761***	-0.545	0.000
Municipal area share	0.017	0.060	0.043***	0.576	0.000
Panel B: Pre-treatment violence (mean per cell)					
All Violent Events *(mean)*	0.0387	0.1068	0.0682***	0.245	0.002
Israeli settlers → Palestinian *(mean)*	0.0019	0.0123	0.0104***	0.339	0.001
Palestinian → Israeli settlers *(mean)*	0.0048	0.0096	0.0048	0.098	0.123
Panel C: Pre-trend Wald tests					
All Violent Events			$\chi^2(9) = 11.185$		0.263
Israeli settlers → Palestinian			$\chi^2(9) = 2.376$		0.984
Palestinian → Israeli settlers			$\chi^2(9) = 4.677$		0.862
Hex cells (control / treated)	791	292			

Notes: Pre-treatment sample Panel A: pre-period cell means. Panel B: pre-treatment outcome averages. Panel C: Wald joint test that all pre-treatment event-study leads ($k < -1$) are zero, from a TWFE regression with hex-cell and time FE, SEs clustered by hex cell, no covariates. SMD = standardized mean difference. p-values in Panels A–B from Welch t-tests. $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table B.3: TWFE: Treatment Effect on Settler–Palestinian Violence, Two Post-Shock Windows

	Israeli settlers → Palestinians			Palestinians → Israeli settlers		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Panel A: Event counts						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	0.0116***	0.0087**	0.0087	0.0009	0.0037	0.0037
	(0.0041)	(0.0041)	(0.0054)	(0.0027)	(0.0033)	(0.0038)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0874***	0.0748***	0.0748***	0.0062**	0.0089**	0.0089**
	(0.0167)	(0.0165)	(0.0244)	(0.0030)	(0.0037)	(0.0038)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0047	0.0047	0.0047	0.0061	0.0061	0.0061
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0123	0.0123	0.0123	0.0096	0.0096	0.0096
Panel B: Event counts $\log(Y+1)$						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	0.0069***	0.0052**	0.0052	0.0006	0.0021	0.0021
	(0.0025)	(0.0025)	(0.0032)	(0.0017)	(0.0020)	(0.0024)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0482***	0.0409***	0.0409***	0.0037**	0.0052**	0.0052**
	(0.0078)	(0.0077)	(0.0120)	(0.0018)	(0.0022)	(0.0023)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0032	0.0032	0.0032	0.0039	0.0039	0.0039
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0083	0.0083	0.0083	0.0064	0.0064	0.0064
Panel C: Incidence (LPM)						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	0.0082**	0.0061*	0.0061	0.0009	0.0025	0.0025
	(0.0033)	(0.0033)	(0.0038)	(0.0023)	(0.0025)	(0.0030)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0526***	0.0442***	0.0442***	0.0043**	0.0060**	0.0060**
	(0.0074)	(0.0074)	(0.0117)	(0.0022)	(0.0025)	(0.0027)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0043	0.0043	0.0043	0.0050	0.0050	0.0050
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0116	0.0116	0.0116	0.0086	0.0086	0.0086
Hex FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Period FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Controls		✓	✓		✓	✓
Std. errors	Clustered (hex)	Clustered (hex)	Conley (5 km)	Clustered (hex)	Clustered (hex)	Conley (5 km)
N	55,233	55,233	55,233	55,233	55,233	55,233

Notes: monthly hex-cell panel, Jan 2016–Mar 2020. The single Post indicator is split into $\text{Post}_1 = \mathbf{1}[\text{Nov 2016} \le t \le \text{Nov 2017}]$ and $\text{Post}_2 = \mathbf{1}[t \ge \text{Dec 2017}]$; the omitted period is Jan–Oct 2016. Panel A: raw event counts per hex-month. Panel B: $\log(1+Y)$ transformation of the same counts. Panel C: linear probability model (LPM) incidence outcomes. Panel C coefficients are in probability points. Panel B coefficients are not percentage effects when outcomes include zeros (Chen and Roth, 2024). $T_i = 1$ if at least 50% of cell area intersects the 2 km buffer around the top-decile suitability cells. Specifications with controls interact Post_1 and Post_2 with the shares of the cell in Oslo Areas A and B and in nature reserves and with the number of Palestinian villages in the cell and within one and two rings of neighbouring cells, and add seasonal-proximity interactions (Ramadan and Jewish-holiday month shares and an olive-harvest indicator interacted with proximity to Palestinian villages or Israeli settlements). All models include hex and period fixed effects. Conley spatial SEs use a 5 km cutoff. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table B.4: TWFE: Treatment Effect on IDF–Palestinian Violence, Two Post-Shock Windows

	IDF → Palestinians			Palestinians → IDF		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Panel A: Event counts						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	-0.0022	0.0021	0.0021	-0.0065	-0.0063	-0.0063
	(0.0097)	(0.0107)	(0.0089)	(0.0048)	(0.0050)	(0.0065)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0806***	0.0550	0.0550	0.0751***	0.0540**	0.0540*
	(0.0276)	(0.0338)	(0.0483)	(0.0242)	(0.0256)	(0.0298)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0362	0.0362	0.0362	0.0101	0.0101	0.0101
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0634	0.0634	0.0634	0.0216	0.0216	0.0216
Panel B: Event counts $\log(Y+1)$						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	-0.0025	0.0006	0.0006	-0.0036	-0.0033	-0.0033
	(0.0048)	(0.0051)	(0.0046)	(0.0028)	(0.0029)	(0.0038)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0367***	0.0269**	0.0269	0.0327***	0.0234**	0.0234*
	(0.0106)	(0.0122)	(0.0173)	(0.0094)	(0.0101)	(0.0125)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0210	0.0210	0.0210	0.0064	0.0064	0.0064
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0371	0.0371	0.0371	0.0135	0.0135	0.0135
Panel C: Incidence (LPM)						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	-0.0050	-0.0005	-0.0005	-0.0042	-0.0038	-0.0038
	(0.0048)	(0.0050)	(0.0048)	(0.0035)	(0.0037)	(0.0047)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0320***	0.0247***	0.0247**	0.0273***	0.0194**	0.0194**
	(0.0085)	(0.0093)	(0.0124)	(0.0075)	(0.0080)	(0.0098)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0244	0.0244	0.0244	0.0084	0.0084	0.0084
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0435	0.0435	0.0435	0.0175	0.0175	0.0175
Hex FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Period FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Controls		✓	✓		✓	✓
Std. errors	Clustered (hex)	Clustered (hex)	Conley (5 km)	Clustered (hex)	Clustered (hex)	Conley (5 km)
N	55,233	55,233	55,233	55,233	55,233	55,233

Notes: monthly hex-cell panel, Jan 2016–Mar 2020. The single Post indicator is split into $\text{Post}_1 = \mathbf{1}[\text{Nov 2016} \le t \le \text{Nov 2017}]$ and $\text{Post}_2 = \mathbf{1}[t \ge \text{Dec 2017}]$; the omitted period is Jan–Oct 2016. Panel A: raw event counts per hex-month. Panel B: $\log(1+Y)$ transformation of the same counts. Panel C: linear probability model (LPM) incidence outcomes. Panel C coefficients are in probability points. Panel B coefficients are not percentage effects when outcomes include zeros (Chen and Roth, 2024). $T_i = 1$ if at least 50% of cell area intersects the 2 km buffer around the top-decile suitability cells. Specifications with controls interact Post_1 and Post_2 with the shares of the cell in Oslo Areas A and B and in nature reserves and with the number of Palestinian villages in the cell and within one and two rings of neighbouring cells, and add seasonal-proximity interactions (Ramadan and Jewish-holiday month shares and an olive-harvest indicator interacted with proximity to Palestinian villages or Israeli settlements). All models include hex and period fixed effects. Conley spatial SEs use a 5 km cutoff. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table B.5: TWFE: Treatment Effect on Civilian Targeting, Two Post-Shock Windows

	(1)	(2)	(3)
Panel A: Event counts			
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	0.0057	0.0078*	0.0078*
	(0.0045)	(0.0045)	(0.0047)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0609***	0.0521***	0.0521***
	(0.0147)	(0.0149)	(0.0186)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0128	0.0128	0.0128
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0260	0.0260	0.0260
Panel B: Event counts $\log(Y+1)$			
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	0.0028	0.0043	0.0043
	(0.0028)	(0.0028)	(0.0029)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0327***	0.0280***	0.0280***
	(0.0063)	(0.0064)	(0.0092)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0084	0.0084	0.0084
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0173	0.0173	0.0173
Panel C: Incidence (LPM)			
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	0.0020	0.0041	0.0041
	(0.0037)	(0.0038)	(0.0037)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0355***	0.0306***	0.0306***
	(0.0061)	(0.0063)	(0.0096)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0113	0.0113	0.0113
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0233	0.0233	0.0233
Hex FE	✓	✓	✓
Period FE	✓	✓	✓
Controls		✓	✓
Std. errors	Clustered (hex)	Clustered (hex)	Conley (5 km)
N	55,233	55,233	55,233

Notes: monthly hex-cell panel, Jan 2016–Mar 2020. The single Post indicator is split into $\text{Post}_1 = \mathbf{1}[\text{Nov 2016} \le t \le \text{Nov 2017}]$ and $\text{Post}_2 = \mathbf{1}[t \ge \text{Dec 2017}]$; the omitted period is Jan–Oct 2016. Panel A: raw event counts per hex-month. Panel B: $\log(1+Y)$ transformation of the same counts. Panel C: linear probability model (LPM) incidence outcomes. Panel C coefficients are in probability points. Panel B coefficients are not percentage effects when outcomes include zeros (Chen and Roth, 2024). $T_i = 1$ if at least 50% of cell area intersects the 2 km buffer around the top-decile suitability cells. Specifications with controls interact Post_1 and Post_2 with the shares of the cell in Oslo Areas A and B and in nature reserves and with the number of Palestinian villages in the cell and within one and two rings of neighbouring cells, and add seasonal-proximity interactions (Ramadan and Jewish-holiday month shares and an olive-harvest indicator interacted with proximity to Palestinian villages or Israeli settlements). All models include hex and period fixed effects. Conley spatial SEs use a 5 km cutoff. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table B.6: Territorial opportunity and radical presence: settler violence after the shock, with Palestinian violence as benchmark

	(1)	(2)	(3)
	Settlers → Palestinian		Benchmark: Pal. → Settlers
Suitability measure	Top-dec. $\hat{E}^{NO}$	Top-dec. $\hat{E}$ (full)	Top-dec. $\hat{E}^{NO}$
Opportunity margin			
Suitability × Post	0.0379**	0.0321**	0.0002
	(0.0161)	(0.0156)	(0.0035)
Pre-2016 radical presence (mutually exclusive bins)			
$\mathbf{1}[O_i{=}1]\times$ Post	0.0471**	0.0424*	0.0075**
	(0.0222)	(0.0229)	(0.0032)
$\mathbf{1}[O_i{\geq}2]\times$ Post	0.0665	0.0681	−0.0004
	(0.0417)	(0.0431)	(0.0053)
Dist. to nearest outpost × Post	−0.0002	−0.0003	−0.0001
	(0.0005)	(0.0005)	(0.0001)
Joint Wald, presence block	p=0.125	p=0.183	p=0.001
Hex FE	✓	✓	✓
Month-year FE	✓	✓	✓
Controls	✓	✓	✓
Observations	55,233	55,233	55,233

Notes: Monthly hex-cell panel, 2016m1–2020m3. Conley (1999) standard errors (5 km cutoff, uniform kernel) in parentheses. All columns include hex and month-year fixed effects and the baseline controls (Oslo-area and nature-reserve shares and Palestinian-village counts in the cell and its two neighbouring rings × *Post*; Ramadan and olive-harvest × near-village; Jewish-holiday × near-settlement). Dependent variable: monthly settler-on-Palestinian event counts in columns (1)–(2) and Palestinian-on-settler counts in column (3). The opportunity regressor is a top-decile indicator of the no-outpost suitability index $\hat{E}^{NO}$ (cols. 1, 3) or a top-decile indicator of the full suitability index $\hat{E}$ (col. 2), each interacted with *Post* (from 2016m11). O_i is the count of pre-November-2016 outposts within 2 km of the cell; presence enters as mutually exclusive bins $\mathbf{1}[O_i{=}1]$ and $\mathbf{1}[O_i{\geq}2]$ ($O_i{=}0$ omitted), so each bin coefficient is that cell type's post-period shift relative to zero-outpost cells. Because zero-outpost cells necessarily lie more than 2 km from the nearest outpost, bin coefficients are conditional presence gradients, not causal effects of outpost placement. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table B.7: Opportunity coefficient across presence parameterizations

Presence parameterization	Top-decile $\hat{E}^{NO}\times$ Post
Indicator only	0.0403**
	(0.0175)
Linear count	0.0322**
	(0.0156)
Log count	0.0340**
	(0.0162)
Indicator + linear	0.0323**
	(0.0154)
Bins (0 / 1 / 2+)	0.0379**
	(0.0161)
Observations	55,233

Notes: Each row re-estimates the static horse race (settler-on-Palestinian counts) varying only the functional form of the pre-2016 outpost count O_i in the presence block. Every specification includes the opportunity regressor (the top-decile no-outpost index $\hat{E}^{NO}$), distance to the nearest outpost $\times$ *Post*, hex and month-year fixed effects, and the baseline controls. Only the coefficient on $\hat{E}^{NO} \times$ *Post* is reported. Bins use dummies for O_i=1 and $O_i \geq 2$ (O_i=0 omitted). Conley (1999) standard errors (5 km cutoff, uniform kernel). $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table B.8: New-outpost formation and geographic opportunity, before vs after Trump

	Any new outpost			Number
	Reduced form	Conditional (main)	Conditional (2017 dropped)	Conditional (count)
Opportunity rank $\times$ Post	0.0584**	0.0805***	0.0892***	0.0878***
	(0.0253)	(0.0255)	(0.0297)	(0.0294)
Post period	2017–2023	2017–2023	2018–2023	2017–2023
Inherited network $\times$ Post		✓	✓	✓
Cell FE, Year FE	✓	✓	✓	✓
Pre-2017 mean of outcome	0.0182	0.0182	0.0182	0.0189
Observations	3,552	3,552	3,256	3,552

Notes: Coarse 5 km cell $\times$ year panel, 2012–2023, all cells retained after occupation; *Post* turns on in 2017; the third column drops the 2017 transition year and turns *Post* on in 2018. *Opportunity rank* is the percentile rank of the geography-only suitability index $\hat{E}^{NO}$ re-estimated on the shorter panel through 2011, which contains no new outposts after 2011 (out-of-sample for 2012+). The inherited-network control is a single January-2017 snapshot — in-cell outpost stock (bins 0/1/2+), *external* outpost count within 5 km ($\log(1+\cdot)$), and distance to the nearest *external* outpost (bins) — interacted with *Post* (levels absorbed by cell FE). Conley (1999) 15 km (uniform kernel) SEs. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

Table B.9: Incidents Used in the Comparison of Political Responses

Date	Place	Victim(s)	What happened	Cat.	Investigation and outcome
Panel A: Before Trump's election (November 2016)					
2 Jul 2014	Shuafat, East Jerusalem	Muhammad Abu Khdeir, 16	Abducted outside a mosque and burned alive in the Jerusalem Forest by three Israelis, two days after three kidnapped Israeli teenagers were found dead	1	Six arrested 6 Jul; three indicted 17 Jul 2014; life sentences 2016
25 Jul 2014	Huwara, Nablus	Khaled 'Odeh, 19	Shot from a settler's car during a march against the Gaza war; the army said the settler fired in the air after his car was stoned; four others wounded	2	Shooter questioned; no further record located
31 Jul 2015	Duma, Nablus	Ali (18 months), Sa'ed and Riham Dawabsheh	Family home firebombed at night, Hebrew graffiti "Revenge" left on the wall; the four-year-old son survived with severe burns	1	Administrative detentions Aug 2015; arrests Dec 2015; Ben-Uliel indicted 3 Jan 2016, convicted May 2020 (three life terms)
Panel B: After Trump's election, 2017–2019					
18 May 2017	Huwara, Nablus	Mu'taz Bani Shamsah, 21	An Itamar resident whose car was surrounded and stoned during a demonstration drove into protesters and fired; an AP photographer was wounded	2	Shooter questioned as complainant; no charges located; five demonstrators convicted
30 Nov 2017	Qusra, Nablus	Mahmoud 'Odeh, 46	An armed escort of an uncoordinated settler youth hike shot a farmer on his land; whether stones preceded the shot is disputed; the hikers were then besieged in a cave until extracted by the army	2	Escorts questioned under caution; case closed as self-defense 26 Mar 2018; one villager indicted for attempted murder
12 Oct 2018	Route 60 near Rehelim, Nablus	Aisha Rabi, 47	Killed by a stone thrown through the windshield of the car in which she was travelling with her husband and daughter, from the direction of the settlement	1	Three yeshiva students arrested 30 Dec 2018, two more 5 Jan 2019; one minor indicted for manslaughter as a terror act 24 Jan 2019; convicted Mar 2026, sentenced to 13 years Sep 2026
Panel C: Later illustrations, 2023					
26 Feb 2023	Huwara, Za'tara, Burin, Nablus	Sameh Aqtash, 37; c. 100 injured	After two settlers were shot dead in Huwara, hundreds of settlers burned homes, shops and cars in Huwara and nearby villages; Aqtash was shot in Za'tara by an unidentified Israeli	1 / 4	Eight detained and released; two administrative detentions 2 Mar; no indictment located for the rampage or the killing
21–24 Jun 2023	Turmus Ayya, Urif, Umm Safa	Omar Qattin, 27 (Border Police fire); dozens injured	After the Eli attack, hundreds of settlers burned about 30 homes and 60 cars in Turmus Ayya; attacks on nearby villages continued for five days	1	No Turmus Ayya arrests reported; indictments for Urif and Umm Safa; eight administrative detentions
4 Aug 2023	Burqa, Ramallah	Qusai Mu'tan, 19	Settlers from the Oz Zion outpost grazed on village land; stones and fireworks were exchanged and one settler was badly injured by a rock; a settler shot Mu'tan in the neck	2	Shooter arrested 5 Aug; racist motive dropped 13 Aug; released to house arrest 15 Aug; no indictment located

Notes: Scope: the West Bank incidents in Panels A and B belong to the 2014–2019 fatal inventory of Appendix H; Abu Khdeir, killed in Jerusalem, is added as the principal pre-period benchmark, and the Panel C episodes fall outside the inventory period and illustrate the later environment. Both 2017 killings preceded the Jerusalem Declaration of 6 December 2017. Circumstances follow B'Tselem, OCHA, and the Israeli police and army accounts as reported in the fixed outlet set; where accounts conflict, the conflict is stated. Categories: 1 = attack on uninvolved civilians; 2 = killing during a demonstration, confrontation, or under a disputed self-defense claim; 4 = uncertain civilian versus security-force attribution. The full inventory, including the cases excluded as killings of Palestinians carrying out attacks, is in Appendix H (Table H.1).

Table B.10: Demolitions of Palestinian Structures in the Vicinity of Unauthorized Outposts

Panel A: Palestinian demolitions around the founding of each outpost

	Outposts	Share with ≥ 1 demolition			Median km to	Median demolitions
	(N)	≤5 km, 12 m after	≤5 km, 24 m after	≤10 km, 12 m after	nearest (12 m after)	≤5 km, 12 m after
Founded 2007–2016	36	0.33	0.58	0.72	6.4	0
Founded 2017–2023	107	0.75	0.91	0.95	3.0	3
of which 2018–2023	102	0.76	0.91	0.96	3.0	3

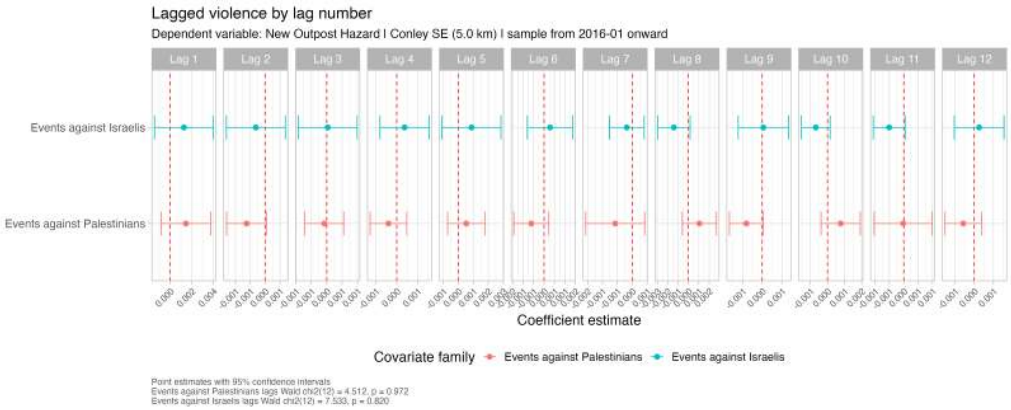
Panel B: Palestinian demolitions within 5 km of grid-cell centroids

	Cells	Share of cells with ≥ 1 demolition			Demolitions per month	
	(N)	Jan 2011–Oct 2016	Nov 2016–Mar 2020	Nov 2016–Dec 2023	Jan 2011–Oct 2016	Nov 2016–Dec 2023
Control cells (low suitability)	791	0.64	0.60	0.76	0.23	0.28
Treated cells (high suitability)	292	0.90	0.88	0.98	0.26	0.40
Cells receiving a new outpost, 2017–2023	88	0.90	0.88	0.97	0.35	0.44

Notes: Demolitions are B'Tselem records of Palestinian structures demolished for lack of a building permit in the West Bank outside East Jerusalem (January 2006–March 2025; 4,527 of 4,693 records geocoded to the OCHA/PCBS community gazetteer within the stated governorate and outside the Jerusalem municipal boundary, 88% in communities wholly or partly in Area C). Locations are community centroids, so distances are measured to the community, not the structure. Panel A: for each outpost in the inventory, demolitions within the stated radius of the outpost in the 12 or 24 months after its founding date (satellite date where available, otherwise 1 July of the founding year). Panel B: 1.5-km hexagonal cells of the main regression sample; treated cells are those in the top suitability group used in the event studies; the last row is the subset of cells in which at least one outpost was founded in 2017–2023. Demolitions per month divide counts by 70 and 86 months.

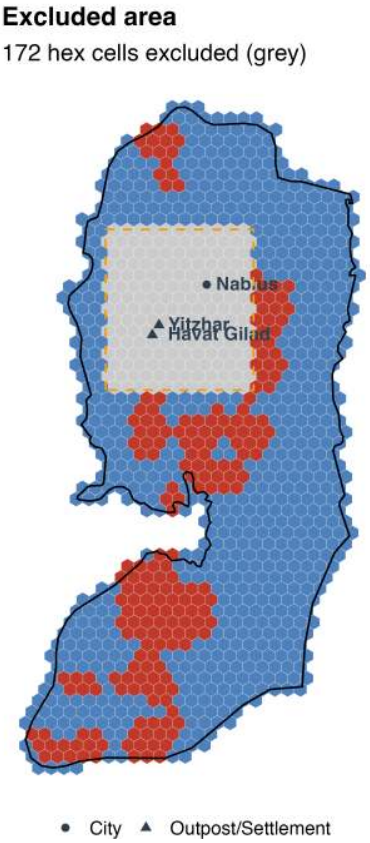
C. Robustness Checks: Figures

Figure C.1: Robustness: Reverse Causality

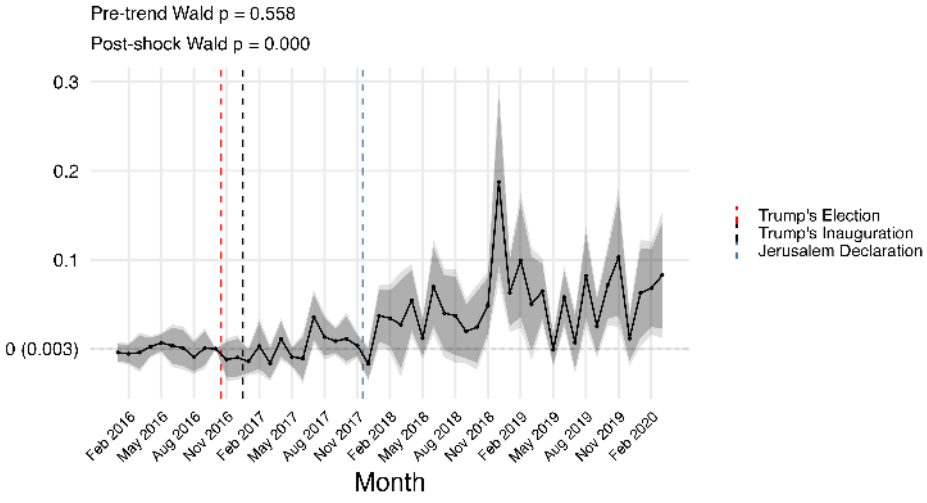


Notes: Coefficients from regressions of new outpost formation on lagged violence measures, estimated separately for treated and control cells; joint Wald tests at the bottom right.

Figure C.2: Robustness: Excluding Havat Gilad Area



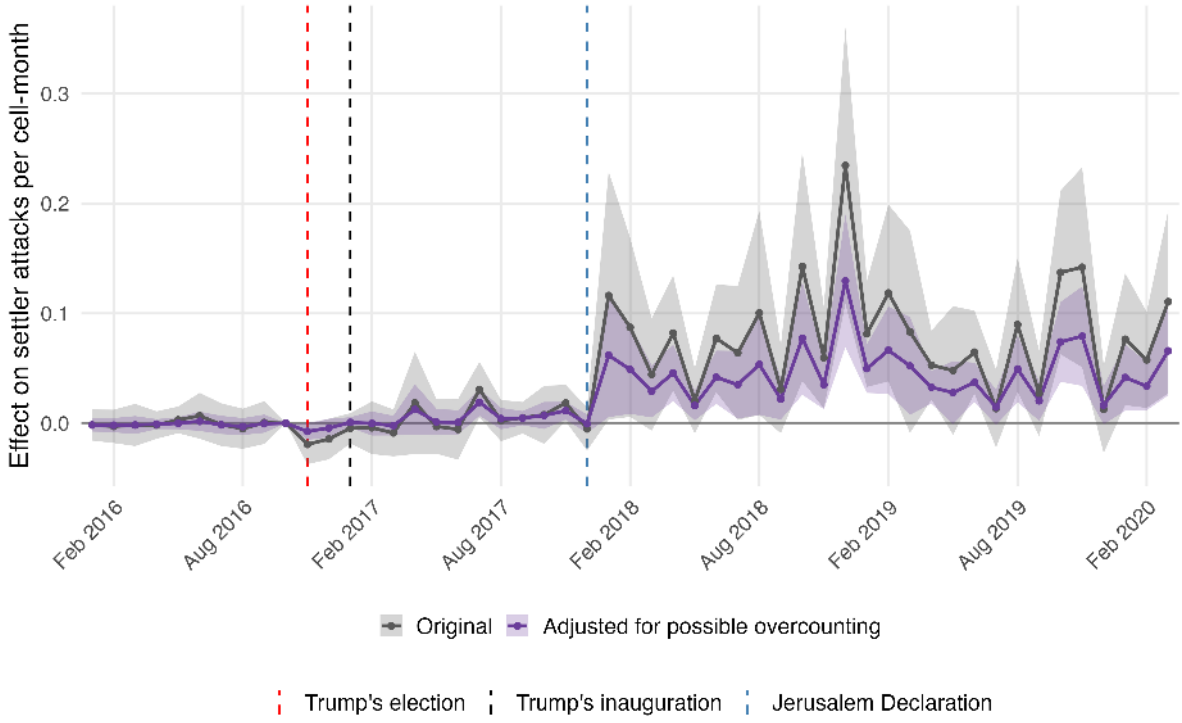
(a) Excluded area



(b) Event study: settler violence → Palestinians

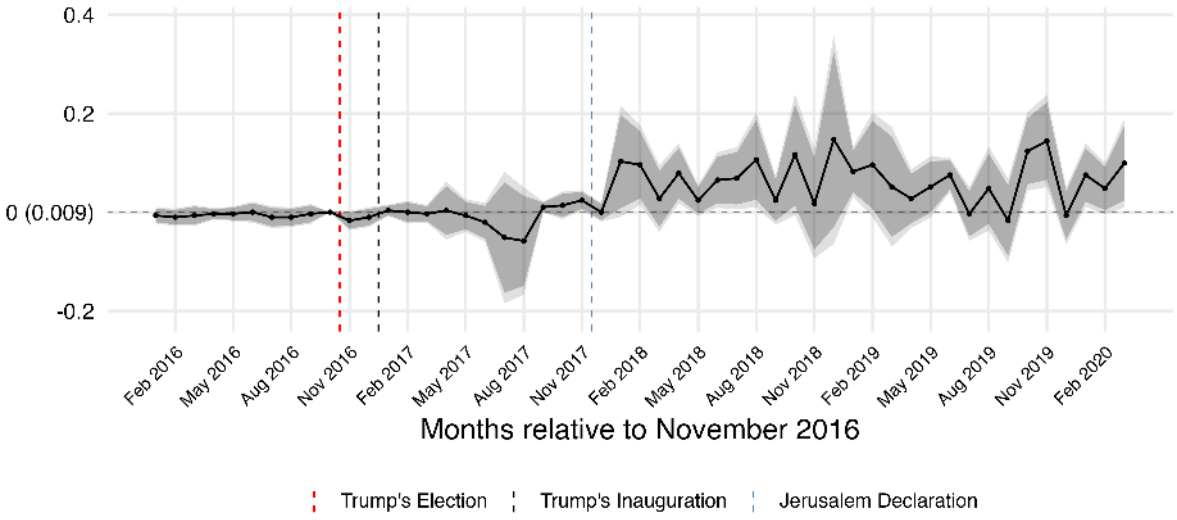
Notes: (a) Excluded hex cells (grey): a box around Nablus, Havat Gilad, and Yitzhar, padded by 0.1 degrees. (b) Event-study estimates for settler violence against Palestinians on the restricted sample; specification and bands as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean.

Figure C.3: Robustness: Adjusting for Possible Overcounting in ACLED

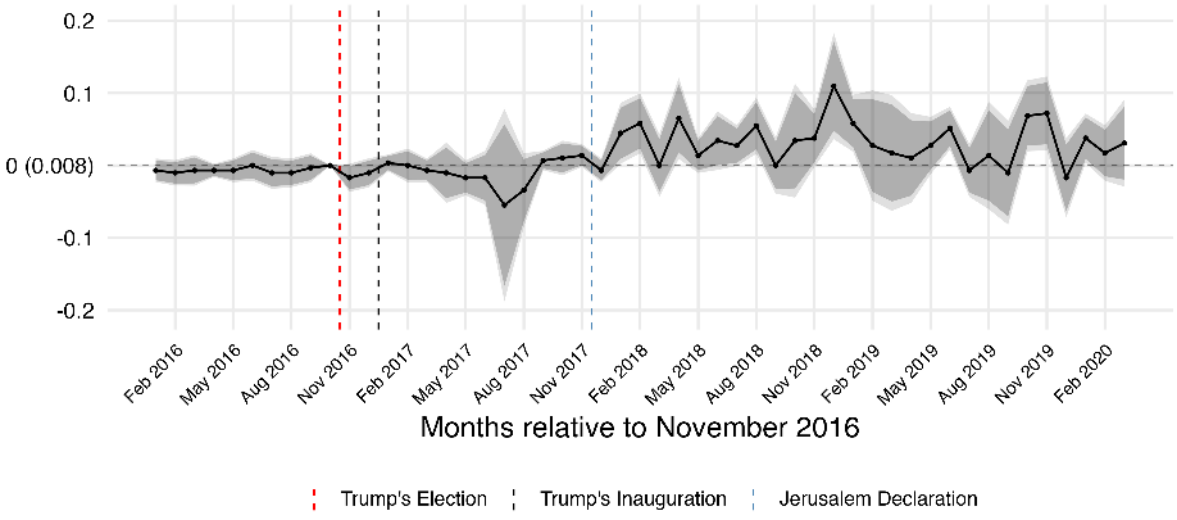


Notes: Sensitivity check that uses fatality discrepancies to calibrate possible overcounting of settler attacks in ACLED. Each cell-month count of settler attacks is multiplied by the ratio of Palestinians killed by settlers recorded by B'Tselem to those recorded by ACLED in the same group of cells (treated or control) and period (before or after November 2016); the ratios range from 0.17 to 0.50. Estimates of equation (2) with 95% Conley confidence intervals. The December 2017–March 2020 estimate falls from 0.075 (s.e. 0.024) to 0.045 (s.e. 0.012).

Figure C.4: Robustness: Matched Sample, Settler Violence Against Palestinians



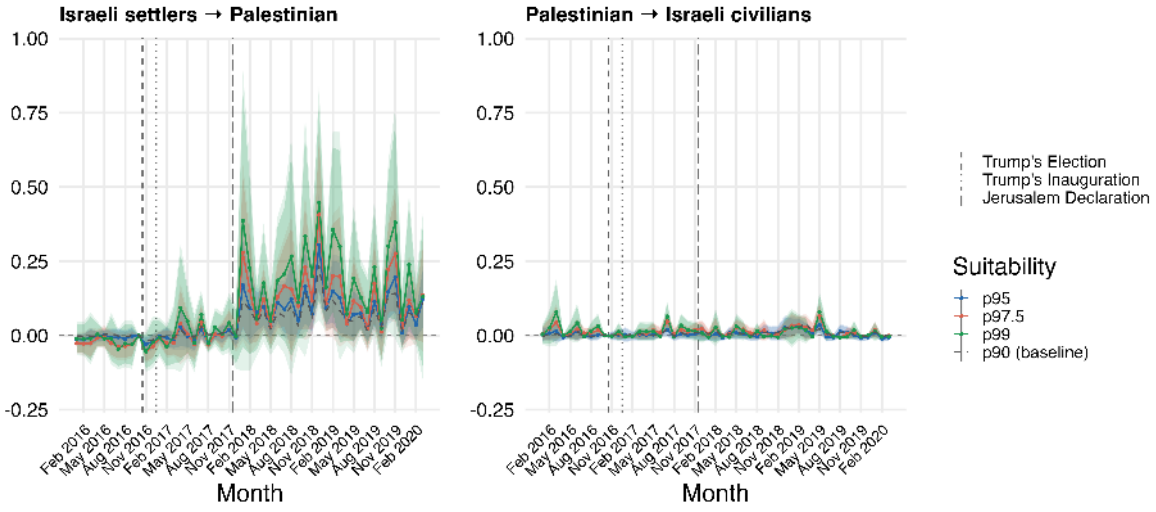
(a) Event counts



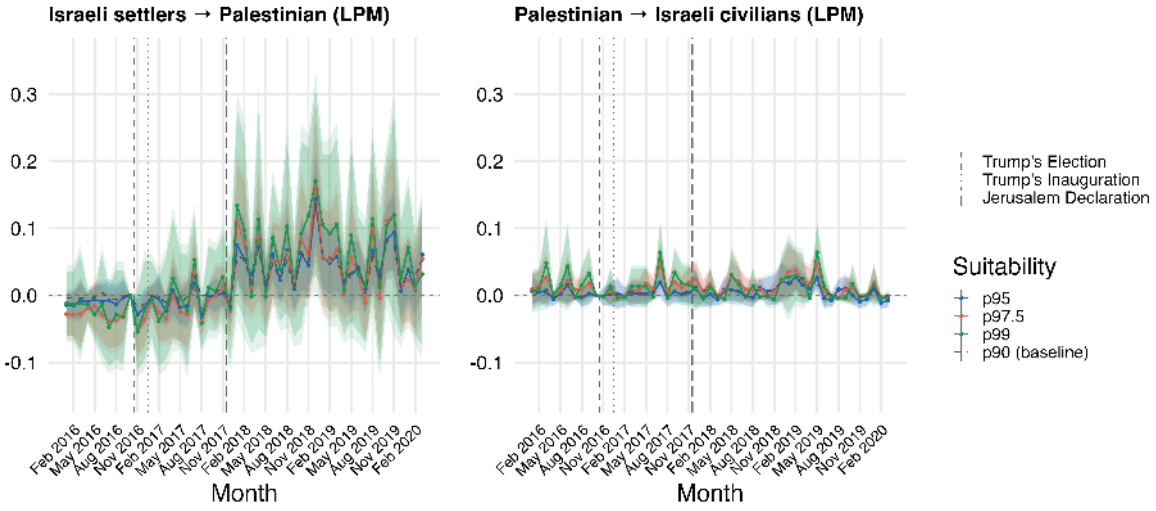
(b) Incidence (LPM)

Notes: Event-study estimates on the matched sample of Table D.1, weighted by the matching weights and without controls. Bands and vertical lines as in Figure 4. Value in parentheses at zero: pre-treatment mean in the matched sample.

Figure C.5: Robustness: Suitability Threshold, Settler–Palestinian Violence



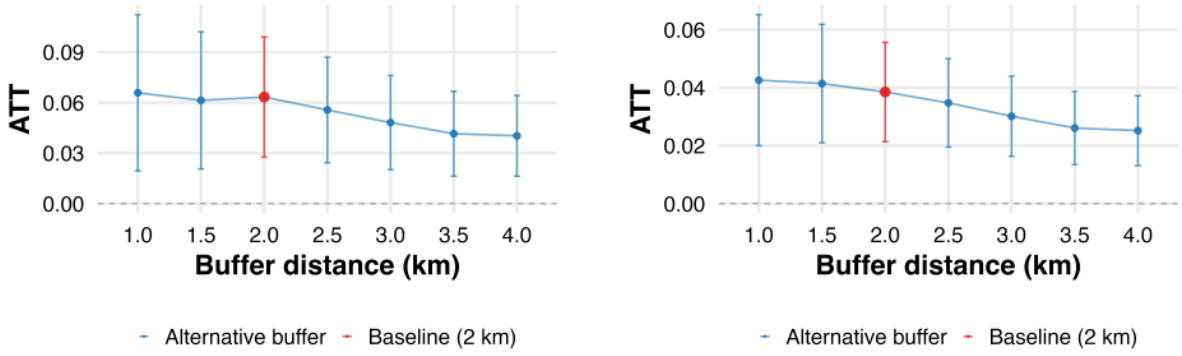
(a) Event counts



(b) Incidence (LPM)

Notes: Robustness checks with alternative suitability thresholds for settler–Palestinian violence outcomes. The baseline (90th percentile) is the dashed gray line; the 95th, 97.5th, and 99th percentiles are in blue, red, and green.

Figure C.6: Robustness: Buffer Size, Israeli Settler Violence on Palestinians

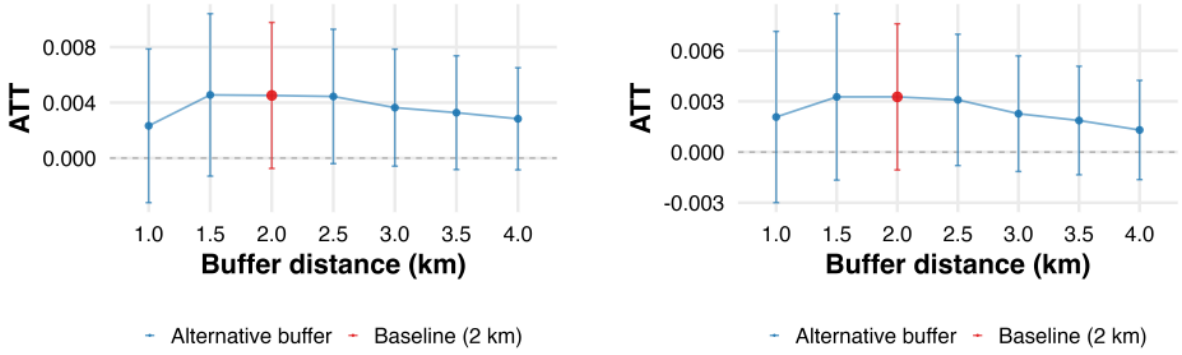


(a) Event counts

(b) Incidence (LPM)

Notes: Static estimates of $T_i \times$ Post (November 2016–March 2020) with buffer sizes from 1 km to 4 km in steps of 0.5 km, without controls; 95% Conley confidence intervals. The baseline (2 km) is depicted in red; all other buffer sizes are in blue.

Figure C.7: Robustness: Buffer Size, Palestinian Violence on Israeli Settlers

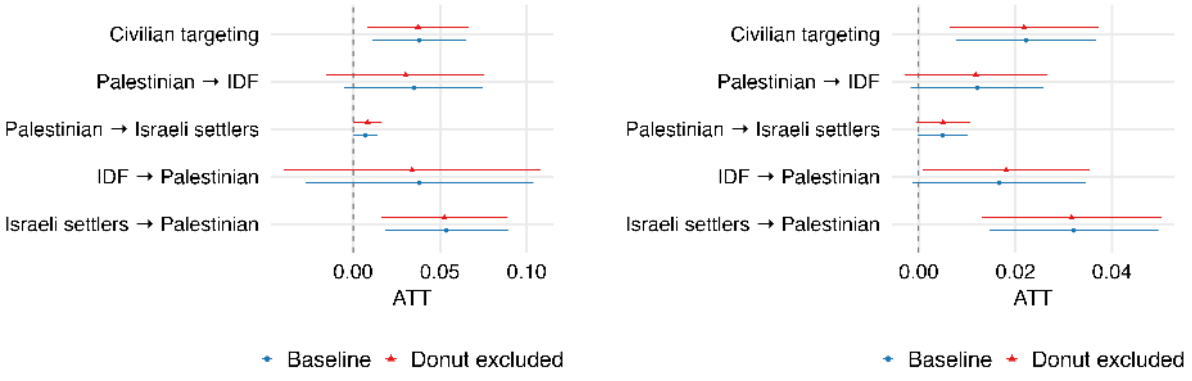


(a) Event counts

(b) Incidence (LPM)

Notes: As in Figure C.6.

Figure C.8: Robustness: Donut Design

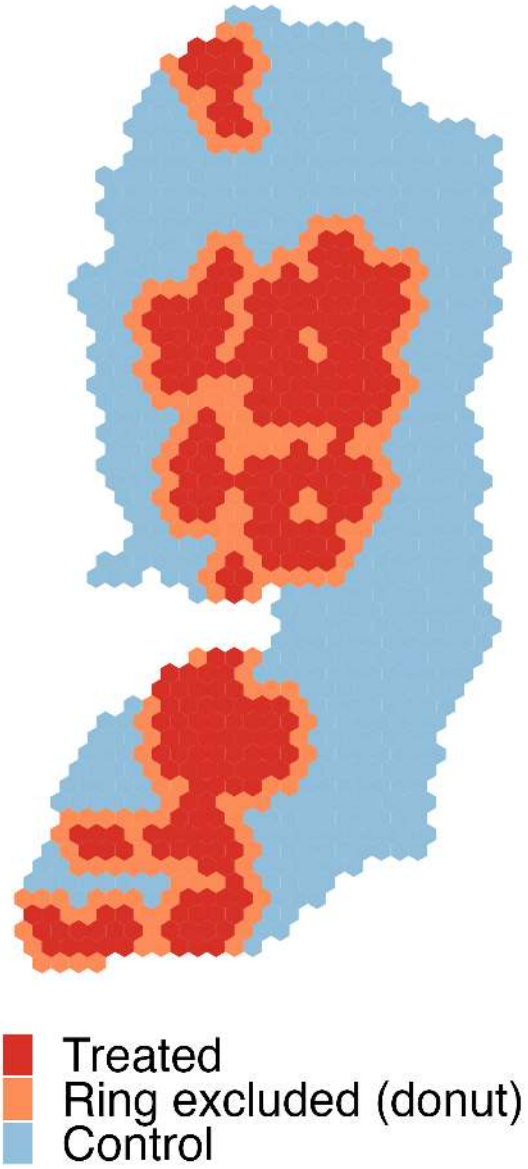


(a) Event counts

(b) Incidence (LPM)

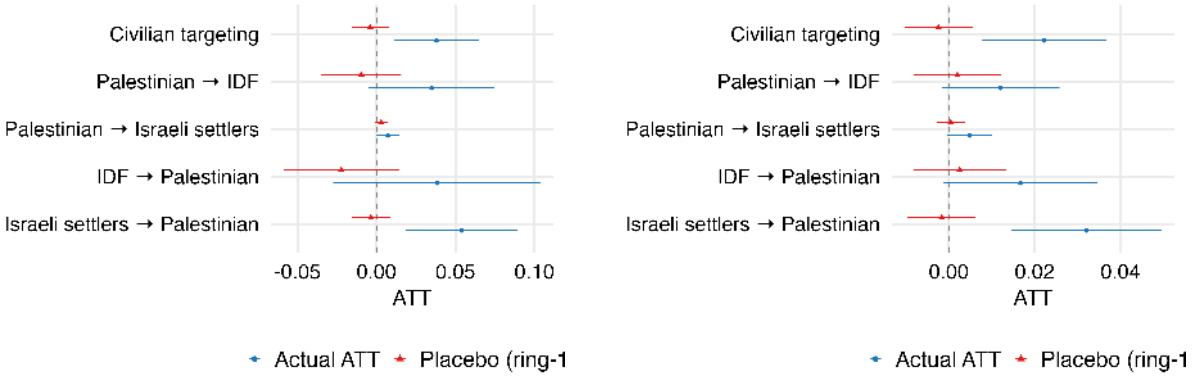
Notes: Static estimates of $T_i \times$ Post (November 2016–March 2020): baseline in blue; in red, excluding the ring of control cells that share an edge with a treated cell (map in Figure C.9). Controls and 95% Conley confidence intervals (5 km cutoff).

Figure C.9: Robustness: Donut Design, Treatment Assignment Map



Notes: Map of treatment assignment under Donut design. Treated in red, control in blue, and in orange the excluded ring of control cells sharing an edge with a treated cell.

Figure C.10: Robustness: Placebo Ring

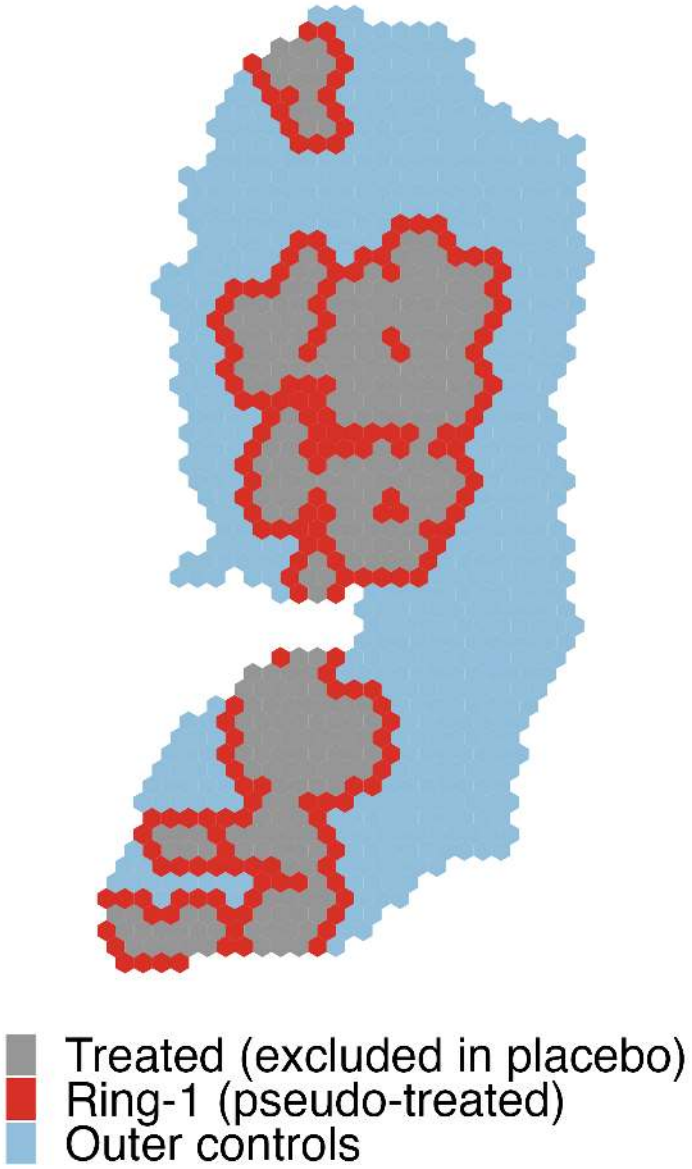


(a) Event counts

(b) Incidence (LPM)

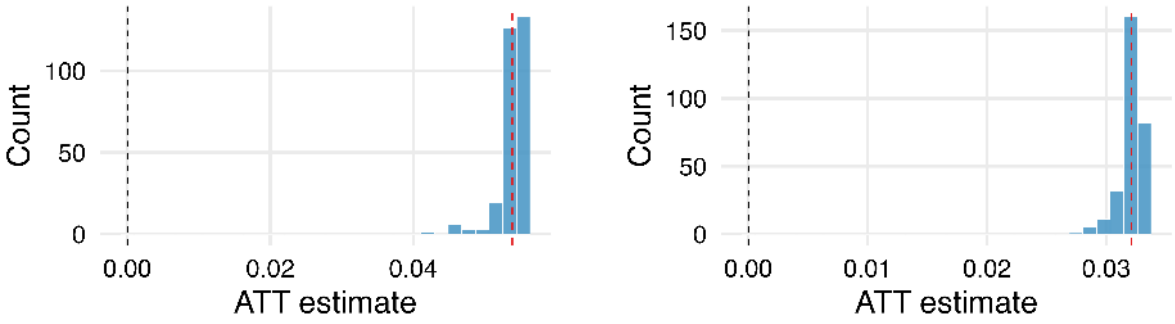
Notes: Static estimates of $T_i \times$ Post (November 2016–March 2020) with controls and 95% Conley confidence intervals. In blue the baseline estimates; in red the placebo estimates, which drop the treated cells and assign treatment to the ring of control cells sharing an edge with them.

Figure C.11: Robustness: Placebo Ring, Treatment Assignment Map



Notes: Map of treatment assignment under the placebo ring design. In red the pseudo-treated units (control cells sharing an edge with a treated cell), in gray the excluded treated units and in blue the control units.

Figure C.12: Robustness: Leave-out-Regression, Israeli Settler Violence on Palestinians

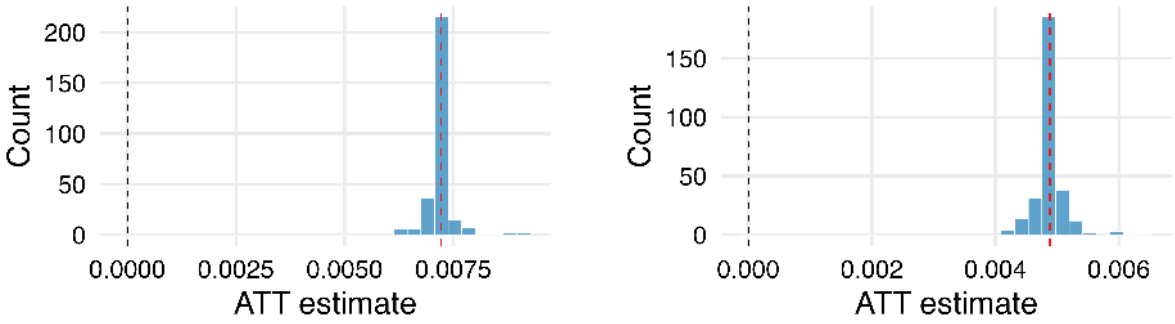


(a) Event counts

(b) Incidence (LPM)

Notes: Static estimates of $T_i \times$ Post (November 2016–March 2020) with controls, re-estimated after dropping each treated cell together with up to four adjacent treated cells. Distribution of estimated coefficients in blue; the dashed red line is the full-sample estimate of the same specification and the dashed black line indicates zero.

Figure C.13: Robustness: Leave-out-Regression, Palestinian Violence on Israeli Settlers



(a) Event counts

(b) Incidence (LPM)

Notes: As in Figure C.12.

D. Robustness Checks: Tables

Table D.1: Pre/Post-Matching Balance: Settlement-presence matching ($K = 1$, with replacement)

	Pre-matching				Post-matching			
	Control Mean	Treated Mean	Diff	SMD	Control Mean	Treated Mean	Diff	SMD
Matching variables								
Elevation (mean, m)	234.460	600.990	366.530***	1.277	568.834	600.990	32.156	0.161
Slope (mean, deg)	9.996	11.703	1.706***	0.400	11.560	11.703	0.143	0.046
Terrain ruggedness	13.565	15.483	1.918***	0.327	15.305	15.483	0.178	0.042
Distance to road (km)	2.593	1.379	-1.214***	-0.592	1.317	1.379	0.062	0.055
Distance to village (km)	2.752	1.387	-1.365***	-0.536	1.250	1.387	0.137	0.164
Distance to settlement (km)	4.979	2.257	-2.723***	-0.963	2.410	2.257	-0.153	-0.134
log(1 + Israeli population, 2016)	0.763	2.736	1.973***	0.849	2.705	2.736	0.031	0.010
Hex cells	768	292			136†	292		

Notes: Nearest-neighbour Mahalanobis matching (Settlement-presence matching), $K = 1$, with replacement. Control cells with missing matching covariates (23 cells on the Dead Sea shore, without slope and ruggedness) are excluded. Post-matching means computed using match weights (consistent with TWFE). †Unique matched control cells. $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$ (Welch t-test).

Table D.2: Match-Weighted TWFE: Settler–Palestinian Violence, Two Post-Shock Windows

	Israeli settlers → Palestinians			Palestinians → Israeli settlers		
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)
Panel A: Event counts						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	-0.0032	-0.0021	-0.0021	0.0245	0.0199	0.0199
	(0.0081)	(0.0067)	(0.0072)	(0.0224)	(0.0153)	(0.0130)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0686***	0.0626***	0.0626**	0.0306	0.0272*	0.0272**
	(0.0204)	(0.0191)	(0.0255)	(0.0220)	(0.0150)	(0.0126)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0086	0.0086	0.0086	0.0164	0.0164	0.0164
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0123	0.0123	0.0123	0.0096	0.0096	0.0096
Panel B: Event counts $\log(Y+1)$						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	-0.0026	-0.0018	-0.0018	0.0147	0.0119	0.0119
	(0.0051)	(0.0042)	(0.0043)	(0.0135)	(0.0093)	(0.0080)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0365***	0.0342***	0.0342***	0.0184	0.0163*	0.0163**
	(0.0102)	(0.0099)	(0.0129)	(0.0132)	(0.0090)	(0.0076)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0058	0.0058	0.0058	0.0104	0.0104	0.0104
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0083	0.0083	0.0083	0.0064	0.0064	0.0064
Panel C: Incidence (LPM)						
$T_i \times \text{Post}_1$ (Nov 2016–Nov 2017)	-0.0041	-0.0030	-0.0030	0.0166	0.0134	0.0134
	(0.0068)	(0.0055)	(0.0053)	(0.0153)	(0.0108)	(0.0095)
$T_i \times \text{Post}_2$ (Dec 2017–Mar 2020)	0.0372***	0.0354***	0.0354***	0.0210	0.0187*	0.0187**
	(0.0108)	(0.0108)	(0.0128)	(0.0147)	(0.0101)	(0.0085)
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, all cells	0.0082	0.0082	0.0082	0.0129	0.0129	0.0129
Pre-treat. mean $\bar{Y}$, treated cells	0.0116	0.0116	0.0116	0.0086	0.0086	0.0086
Hex FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Period FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Controls		✓	✓		✓	✓
Std. errors	Clustered (hex)	Clustered (hex)	Conley (5 km)	Clustered (hex)	Clustered (hex)	Conley (5 km)
N	21,828	21,828	21,828	21,828	21,828	21,828

Notes: match-weighted monthly hex-cell panel, Jan 2016–Mar 2020. Nearest-neighbour Mahalanobis matching (K=1, with replacement). The single Post indicator is split into $\text{Post}_1 = \mathbf{1}[\text{Nov 2016} \le t \le \text{Nov 2017}]$ and $\text{Post}_2 = \mathbf{1}[t \ge \text{Dec 2017}]$; the omitted period is Jan–Oct 2016. Panel A: raw event counts per hex-month. Panel B: $\log(1+Y)$. Panel C: LPM incidence. Pre-treatment means are match-weighted. Specifications with controls interact Post_1 and Post_2 with the shares of the cell in Oslo Areas A and B and in nature reserves and with the number of Palestinian villages in the cell and within one and two rings of neighbouring cells, and add seasonal-proximity interactions. All models include hex and period fixed effects. Conley spatial SEs use a 5 km cutoff. $^{*}p < 0.1$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

E. Additional Materials

Structural Breaks: Test Statistics and the 2022 Breaks Figure 6 in the Timing and Local Triggers subsection estimates unknown break dates in the raw monthly treated–control gap, with Newey–West long-run variances (four lags). Breaks are added sequentially, up to three, when the sup-Wald statistic of a segment of at least 24 months (15% trimming) exceeds its simulated 5 percent critical value; confidence intervals follow Bai (1997). For settler violence against Palestinians, the April 2017 break has sup-Wald = 94.2 against a 5 percent critical value of 11.01, and the January 2018 break has sup-Wald = 88.6 against 10.19. A further break occurs in February 2022, with a 95% confidence interval from September 2021 to July 2022 (sup-Wald = 34.9; critical value 8.66), coinciding with the March 2022 attacks in Beersheba, Hadera, and Bnei Brak and the start of Operation Break the Wave (Israel Defense Forces, 2023). Palestinian violence against settlers breaks in August 2022, with a 95% confidence interval from July to September 2022 (sup-Wald = 156.2; critical value 8.66), aligning with the emergence of Lions' Den in Nablus and the reorganization of armed Palestinian activity in the northern West Bank (ACLED, 2023).

Figure E.1: Outposts, Settlements and Palestinian Communities in the West Bank



(a) Ahiya Outpost, 1997



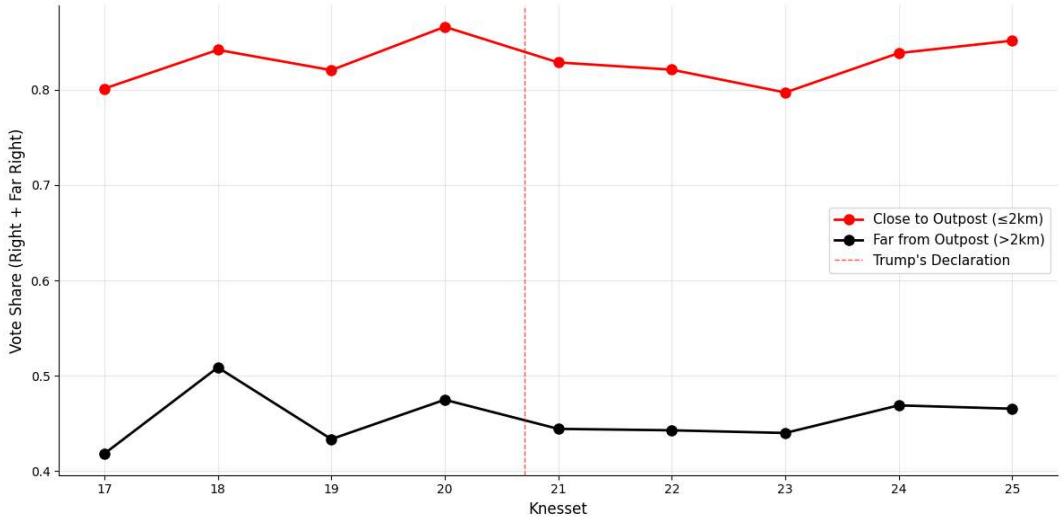
(b) Nahal Tirza Farm Outpost, 2020



(c) Outposts (red), Settlement (blue) and Palestinian Towns (white)

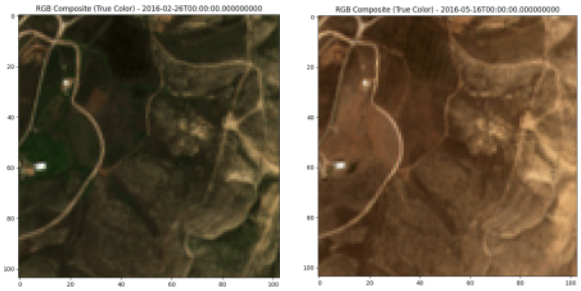
Notes: Satellite images of different outposts in the West Bank. Resolution: 0.5m. Source: Maxar Technologies (2023).

Figure E.2: West Bank Voting in National Elections



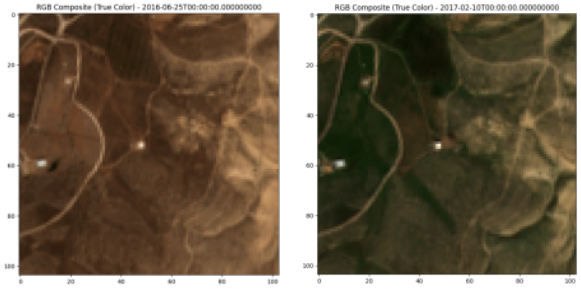
Notes: The figure plots the average vote share of right-wing and far-right parties across Knesset elections for polling stations located within 2 km of an outpost and for polling stations located farther away. Data are obtained from Central Elections Committee (2025).

Figure E.3: Outpost Timing Example – Bentayim Farm Outpost



(a) 2016-02-26

(b) 2016-05-16



(c) 2016-06-25

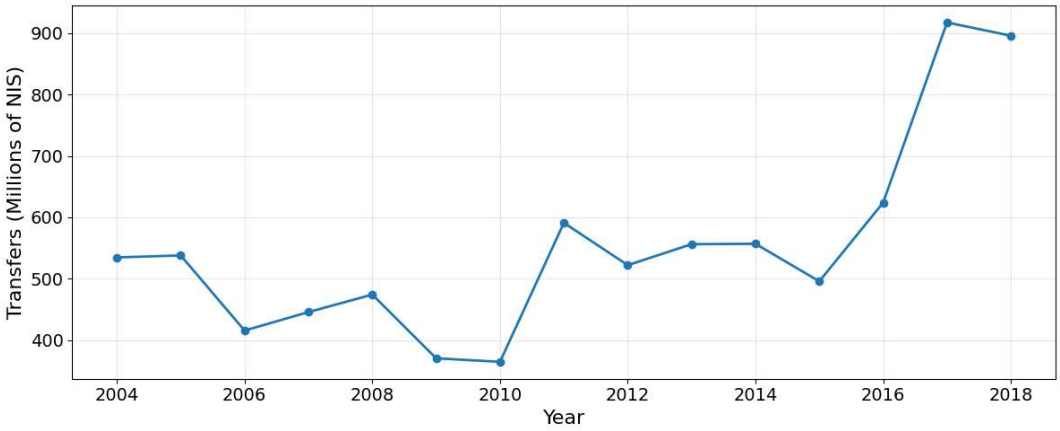
(d) 2017-02-10



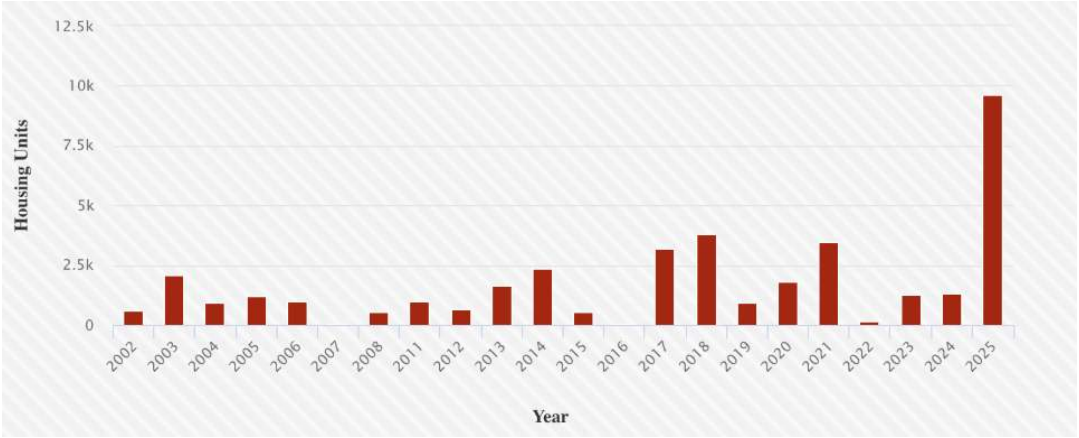
(e) High Resolution Image

Notes: Panels E.3a–E.3d show the evolution of the Bentayim Farm outpost from February 2016 to February 2017. Panel E.3e shows the same outpost in 2023. Sources: Copernicus Sentinel-2 Level 2A and Maxar Technologies.

Figure E.4: Settlement Expansion Indicators



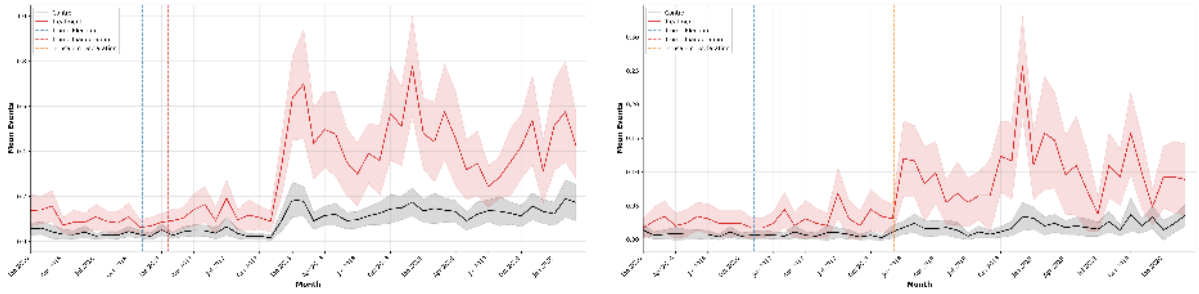
(a) Fiscal Transfers to Settlements



(b) Tenders for Settlement Construction

Notes: Panel (a) reports fiscal transfers to settlements from 2004 to 2018. Since the last data point is from the second quarter of 2018, for each year only the first two quarters are shown. Data are obtained from Israeli Settlement Division reports disclosed through the Movement for Freedom of Information. Panel (b) reports tenders for settlement construction from 2002 to 2025. Data are obtained from Peace Now (2024).

Figure E.5: Descriptive Monthly Trends: Total Violence and Civilian Targeting

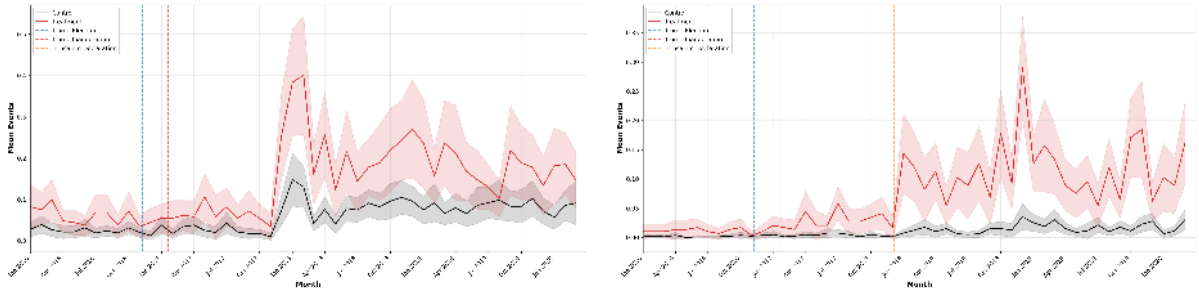


(a) Total violence

(b) Civilian targeting

Notes: Raw monthly mean violence in treated and control cells, with 95% confidence intervals: (a) all violent events, (b) events targeting civilians. Vertical lines: Trump's election, inauguration, and the Jerusalem Declaration. Descriptive only; treated and control cells differ in baseline levels.

Figure E.6: Descriptive Monthly Trends: Israeli Violence against Palestinians

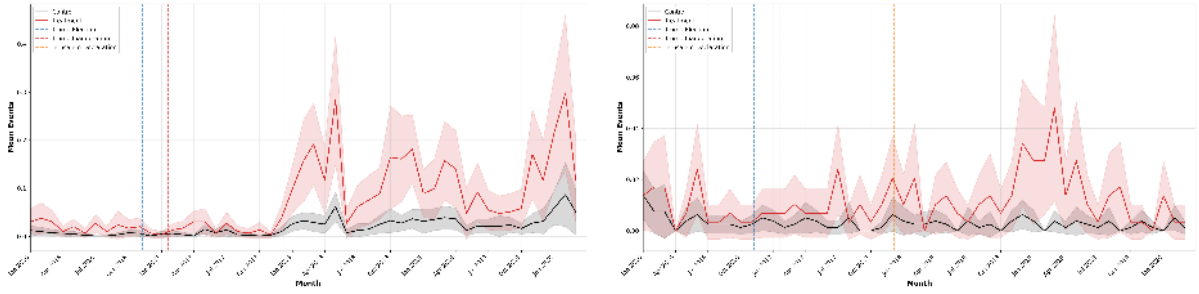


(a) IDF → Palestinian

(b) Israeli settlers → Palestinian

Notes: Raw monthly mean violence in treated and control cells, with 95% confidence intervals: (a) IDF violence against Palestinians, (b) settler violence against Palestinians. Vertical lines as in Figure E.5b. Descriptive only.

Figure E.7: Descriptive Monthly Trends: Palestinian Violence



(a) Palestinian → IDF

(b) Palestinian → Israeli civilians

Notes: Raw monthly mean violence in treated and control cells, with 95% confidence intervals: (a) Palestinian violence against the IDF, (b) Palestinian violence against Israeli civilians. Vertical lines as in Figure E.5b. Descriptive only.

F. Theoretical Model

The model is reduced form: it does not microfound the government's ideology, coalition incentives, or enforcement capacity.

Model Setup

Primitives, payoffs, and timing are as in the Theoretical Framework section. In addition, $K_i(0) = 0$, $K_i'(v_i) \geq 0$, $K_i''(v_i) > 0$, and $\lim_{v_i \to \infty} K_i'(v_i) = \infty$, which guarantees a finite interior solution when the marginal benefit of violence is high. The cost functions are continuous and sufficiently smooth for the derivatives used below, and $C_i^{fS} < 0$ for $f_i > 0$ in the relevant interior region.[51]

Radical Actor's Problem

Given f_i, the actor's net marginal payoff from violence is

$$M_i(f_i) = r_i - L + f_i \left[\pi(E_i) + L\right], \tag{F.1}$$

so the best response is

$$v_i^*(f_i) = \begin{cases} 0, & \text{if } M_i(f_i) \leq K_i'(0), \\ (K_i')^{-1}\left(M_i(f_i)\right), & \text{if } M_i(f_i) > K_i'(0), \end{cases} \tag{F.2}$$

which is continuous and nondecreasing in f_i on the whole unit interval. An interior activation threshold, when it exists, is

$$\bar{f}_i = \frac{K_i'(0) + L - r_i}{\pi(E_i) + L}. \tag{F.3}$$

When this threshold lies in $(0, 1)$, violence is zero below $\bar{f}_i$ and positive above it. Forbearance raises the net marginal payoff by $\pi(E_i) + L$, more so where opportunity is higher.

[51] Allowing λ to increase with S would reinforce the same comparative static. I keep λ fixed to isolate the cost-of-forbearance channel.

Government's Problem

The government's problem is the one in the Theoretical Framework section. An optimum exists because the payoff is continuous and the choice set is compact; if several choices maximize the government's payoff, I select the largest.

At an interior optimum on the active branch, the first-order condition is

$$\lambda\pi(E_i)\left[v_i^*(f_i) + f_i\frac{\partial v_i^*(f_i)}{\partial f_i}\right] = C_i^f\big(f_i, v_i^*(f_i); S\big) + C_i^v\big(f_i, v_i^*(f_i); S\big)\frac{\partial v_i^*(f_i)}{\partial f_i}. \tag{F.4}$$

Corner solutions and discontinuous switches between the dormant and active branches need not satisfy this condition.

Comparative Statics

Throughout this section, let

$$W_i(f_i; S) = \lambda f_i \pi(E_i) v_i^*(f_i) - C_i\big(f_i, v_i^*(f_i); S\big)$$

denote the government's reduced objective after substituting the radical actor's best response, and let $f_i^*(S)$ denote its largest maximizer on $[0, 1]$. Derivative results characterize regular interior equilibria on the active branch. Corner solutions allow zero responses below the activation threshold or saturation at $f_i = 1$.

Lemma 1 (Monotonicity). *The government's optimal forbearance $f_i^*(S)$ and equilibrium violence $v_i^*(f_i^*(S))$ are nondecreasing in S, including at corners and across jumps.*

Proof. Greater permissiveness reduces the additional cost of tolerating more radical action: the reduced payoff $W_i(f_i; S)$ has increasing differences in (f_i, S), so its largest maximizer is nondecreasing in S (Milgrom and Shannon, 1994). Since the radical actor's best response is nondecreasing in forbearance, equilibrium violence is also nondecreasing. ■

The local derivative calculation sharpens this to a strict increase at a regular active

interior optimum. Write the first-order condition (F.4) as $H_i(f_i, S) = 0$, where

$$\begin{aligned} H_i(f_i, S) &= \lambda\pi(E_i)\left[v_i^*(f_i) + f_i\frac{\partial v_i^*(f_i)}{\partial f_i}\right] \\ &\quad - C_i^f\big(f_i, v_i^*(f_i); S\big) - C_i^v\big(f_i, v_i^*(f_i); S\big)\frac{\partial v_i^*(f_i)}{\partial f_i} \\ &= W_i^f(f_i; S). \end{aligned}$$

Because λ, E_i, and the radical actor's best response are fixed with respect to S,

$$H_i^S = -C_i^{fS} - C_i^{vS}\frac{\partial v_i^*}{\partial f_i} \geq 0,$$

since $C_i^{fS} \leq 0$, $C_i^{vS} \leq 0$, and $\partial v_i^*/\partial f_i > 0$ on the active branch. The inequality is strict whenever greater permissiveness strictly lowers at least one marginal cost, that is, whenever $C_i^{fS} < 0$ or $C_i^{vS} < 0$. At a regular interior optimum, the second-order condition gives $H_i^f = W_i^{ff} < 0$, and the implicit function theorem yields

$$\frac{\partial f_i^*}{\partial S} = -\frac{H_i^S}{H_i^f} \geq 0, \tag{F.5}$$

with strict inequality whenever $H_i^S > 0$. Since the radical actor's best response is increasing in forbearance on the active branch, the effect of S on violence is

$$\frac{\partial v_i^*}{\partial S} = \frac{\partial v_i^*}{\partial f_i}\frac{\partial f_i^*}{\partial S} \geq 0, \tag{F.6}$$

which is strictly positive whenever $H_i^S > 0$.

Opportunity. To characterize how the response varies with opportunity, consider quadratic private costs, $K_i(v_i) = \chi v_i^2/2$, with $\chi > 0$, holding all other primitives fixed. In an active location,

$$v_i^*(S, E_i) = \frac{r_i - L + [\pi(E_i) + L]f_i^*(S, E_i)}{\chi}.$$

Along a smooth interior equilibrium,

$$\frac{\partial^2 v_i^*}{\partial S\,\partial E_i} = \frac{\pi_E(E_i)}{\chi}\frac{\partial f_i^*}{\partial S} + \frac{\pi(E_i) + L}{\chi}\frac{\partial^2 f_i^*}{\partial S\,\partial E_i}.$$

Higher opportunity therefore amplifies the response of violence if it does not reduce the

government's response to permissiveness:

$$\frac{\partial^2 f_i^*}{\partial S \, \partial E_i} \geq 0. \tag{F.7}$$

This is an additional sufficient condition, rather than a consequence of the baseline assumptions. The amplification is strict where forbearance responds strictly to permissiveness. The comparison concerns active locations with $0 < f_i^* < 1$. Where full tolerance already prevails, no enforcement margin remains to relax.[52]

Activation. Higher opportunity lowers the actor's activation threshold (F.3), holding other primitives fixed. As permissiveness rises, different locations may become active at different points. Within a dormant location, however, positive forbearance is strictly dominated: it imposes additional costs without producing violent output. Equilibrium forbearance therefore remains zero until inducing positive violence becomes worthwhile. In such a location enforcement operates off the equilibrium path: the actor would become active at any forbearance above $\bar{f}_i$, so neither violence nor punishment is observed. Observed punishment, $(1 - f_i^*)L\, v_i^*$, is therefore zero both where enforcement deters and where tolerance is full ($f_i^* = 1$).

Prediction 1: Political permissiveness weakly increases violence. A more permissive environment weakly increases government forbearance and equilibrium violence. Violence rises when greater tolerance activates a previously dormant actor or increases violence by an already active actor.

Prediction 2: Opportunity can amplify the response to permissiveness. Holding other primitives fixed, violence responds more strongly where territorial gains are more feasible, under quadratic private costs and the stated complementarity condition. This comparison applies to active locations where enforcement can still relax.

A Parametric Illustration

Consider

$$\pi(E_i) = \theta E_i, \qquad K_i(v_i) = \frac{\chi}{2} v_i^2, \qquad C_i(f_i, v_i; S) = \frac{1}{2} c_0 e^{-\phi S} f_i^2 + \frac{\gamma}{2} v_i^2,$$

[52] The ranking is local; finite-shock comparisons require the conditions throughout the relevant range.

with $\theta, \chi, c_0, \phi > 0$ and $\gamma \geq 0$. A higher S lowers the direct cost of forbearance, consistent with $C_i^{fS} < 0$. The radical actor's best response is

$$v_i^*(f_i) = \max\left\{0,\ \frac{r_i - L + f_i(L + \theta E_i)}{\chi}\right\},$$

and the activation threshold, when it lies in the unit interval, is $\bar{f}_i = (L - r_i)/(L + \theta E_i)$, which is decreasing in E_i. Substituting the best response into the government's payoff gives the reduced objective

$$W_i(f_i; S) = \lambda f_i \theta E_i v_i^*(f_i) - \frac{1}{2} c_0 e^{-\phi S} f_i^2 - \frac{\gamma}{2}\left(v_i^*(f_i)\right)^2, \qquad f_i^* \in \arg\max_{f_i \in [0,1]} W_i(f_i; S).$$

The reduced objective is piecewise quadratic in f_i, so f_i^* is computed by exact comparison of the two endpoints, the activation kink $\bar{f}_i$, and the interior stationary point of the active branch when it is admissible, selecting the largest maximizer in case of ties. For the parameterization of Figure F.1 (Table F.1), the complementarity condition (F.7) holds numerically: on a grid of $E_i \in [0.3, 1.5]$ and $S \in [0, 0.8]$, the discrete cross-partial $\partial^2 f_i^* / \partial S\, \partial E_i$ is strictly positive wherever the finite-difference stencil stays in the interior-active region ($0 < f_i^* < 1$, interior stationary point selected). This is a property of the parameterization, not a proof of the general condition.

Dynamic Extension: Endogenous Institutional Leverage and Persistence

Setup

Time is discrete, $t = 0, 1, 2, \ldots$. Let $b_t \in [0, 1]$ denote the institutional leverage of the radical settler constituency, and define effective permissiveness as

$$\widetilde{S}_t = S_t + \kappa b_t, \qquad \kappa > 0,$$

where S_t is the external component. In each period the static game is played exactly as above with $\widetilde{S}_t$ in place of S. Leverage, like S_t, enters only the government's cost of tolerating radical action, so λ remains fixed and the static results carry over: by Lemma 1, f_{it}^* and v_{it}^* are nondecreasing in $\widetilde{S}_t$, and strictly increasing on an active interior branch

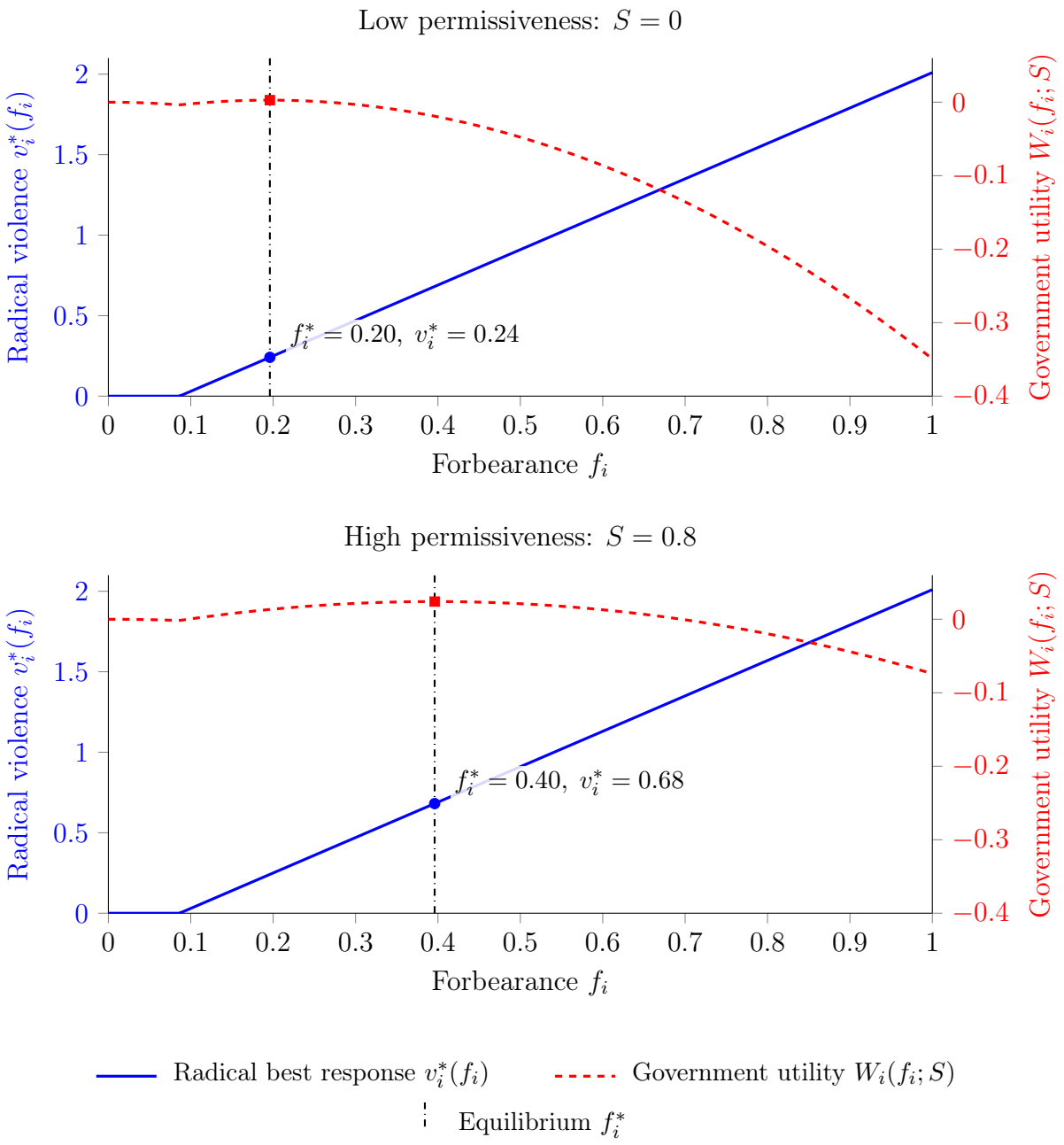


Figure F.1: Equilibrium forbearance and violence under low and high political permissiveness (parameters in Table F.1). Moving from $S = 0$ to $S = 0.8$ lowers the cost of forbearance, shifts the government's utility-maximizing choice from $f_i^* = 0.20$ to $f_i^* = 0.40$, and increases equilibrium violence from $v_i^* = 0.24$ to $v_i^* = 0.68$.

with $C_i^{fS} < 0$. Let

$$A_t = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^{N} f_{it}^* \, \pi(E_i) \, v_{it}^*$$

denote the aggregate politically productive output of tolerated radical action, the same object the government internalizes location by location. Leverage evolves according to

$$b_{t+1} = (1 - \delta) b_t + \eta (1 - b_t) A_t, \qquad \eta > 0, \quad \delta \in (0, 1). \tag{F.8}$$

The extension therefore adds one state and three parameters: κ governs how strongly institutional leverage relaxes future constraints on forbearance, η how strongly politically productive tolerated action builds leverage, and δ the rate at which leverage depreciates. The factor $(1 - b_t)$ captures diminishing room for further institutional penetration. The period-t government takes the future evolution of b_t as outside its current objective. This is a natural simplification in the setting: Israel held five elections between 2019 and 2022, so governments were short-lived relative to the pace at which leverage accumulates.

Transition Map, Steady States, and Stability

For a fixed external environment S, write

$$A^*(b; S) = \frac{1}{N} \sum_{i=1}^{N} f_i^*(S + \kappa b) \, \pi(E_i) \, v_i^*(S + \kappa b)$$

for aggregate output at the static equilibrium. The dynamics reduce to the one-dimensional map

$$T_S(b) = (1 - \delta) b + \eta (1 - b) A^*(b; S), \qquad b_{t+1} = T_S(b_t), \tag{F.9}$$

with drift

$$D_S(b) \equiv T_S(b) - b = \eta (1 - b) A^*(b; S) - \delta b. \tag{F.10}$$

A steady state satisfies $D_S(b^*) = 0$. The transition map may jump when locations become active.

Lemma 1 implies that aggregate output is nonnegative and nondecreasing in both institutional leverage and external permissiveness. Let $\bar{A}$ bound aggregate output over the full range of leverage and external environments considered. Assume

$$\eta \bar{A} + \delta \leq 1. \tag{F.11}$$

This restriction keeps leverage within $[0,1]$ and ensures that higher current leverage cannot produce lower leverage next period. It permits kinks and branch switching as locations move between dormant, interior, and corner regimes; no differentiability is required.

Lemma 2 (Existence). *Under these conditions, for every fixed S the transition map T_S is an order-preserving self-map of $[0,1]$ and therefore admits at least one steady state.*

Proof. Nonnegativity of A^* gives $T_S(b) \geq 0$, and $A^* \leq \bar{A}$ gives $T_S(b) \leq \eta\bar{A} + b(1 - \delta - \eta\bar{A}) \leq 1 - \delta < 1$ by (F.11). For $b' > b$, monotonicity of A^* in b gives

$$T_S(b') - T_S(b) \geq (b' - b)\big[1 - \delta - \eta A^*(b; S)\big] \geq (b' - b)\big[1 - \delta - \eta\bar{A}\big] \geq 0,$$

so T_S is order preserving. Since $[0,1]$ is a complete lattice, Tarski's fixed-point theorem implies that T_S has at least one fixed point. ■

Persistence

Proposition 3 (Persistence). *Let b_0 be a steady state under S_0. Suppose $S_t = S_H > S_0$ for $t = 1, \ldots, T$, after which $S_t = S_0$, and suppose*

$$A^*(b_0; S_H) > A^*(b_0; S_0). \tag{F.12}$$

Then $b_{T+1} > b_0$. Hence, immediately after the external environment reverts,

$$\widetilde{S}_{T+1} = S_0 + \kappa b_{T+1} > S_0 + \kappa b_0 = \widetilde{S}_0,$$

so forbearance and violence remain weakly above their pre-shock equilibrium levels. A sufficient condition for (F.12) is that at least one location with $\pi(E_i) > 0$ is on an active interior branch at b_0 and permissiveness strictly lowers at least one relevant marginal cost there, so that $\partial f_i^*/\partial S > 0$.

Proof. The shock arrives at $t = 1$ with $b_1 = b_0$ predetermined. Since $T_{S_0}(b_0) = b_0$, condition (F.12) gives

$$b_2 = T_{S_H}(b_0) = (1 - \delta)b_0 + \eta(1 - b_0)A^*(b_0; S_H) > T_{S_0}(b_0) = b_0.$$

If $b_t \geq b_0$ for some $t \leq T$, then because T_{S_H} is nondecreasing, $b_{t+1} = T_{S_H}(b_t) \geq T_{S_H}(b_0) = b_2 > b_0$. Induction gives $b_{T+1} > b_0$. At $t = T + 1$ the external environment has returned to S_0 but b_{T+1} is predetermined, so $\widetilde{S}_{T+1} > \widetilde{S}_0$; the final claim follows from Lemma 1. For the sufficient condition, Lemma 1 combined with the strict local increase at b_0 implies

that f_i^*, and hence v_i^* and $f_i^*\pi(E_i)v_i^*$, are strictly higher at S_H than at S_0 in that location, while no other location's output falls. ■

Threshold Dynamics

Remark 4 (Threshold dynamics). *Suppose that, for the baseline environment S_0, the drift has three zeros $b_L < b_U < b_H$ with $D_{S_0}(b) > 0$ on $[0, b_L)$, $D_{S_0}(b) < 0$ on (b_L, b_U), $D_{S_0}(b) > 0$ on (b_U, b_H), and $D_{S_0}(b) < 0$ on $(b_H, 1]$. Suppose the system starts at b_L before the positive shock. If $b_{T+1} \in [b_L, b_U)$, leverage subsequently weakly decreases and remains in that interval. If $b_{T+1} > b_U$, leverage never returns below b_U. If aggregate output is also continuous in leverage, these paths converge to b_L and b_H, respectively.*[53]

Proof. If $b_{T+1} \in (b_U, b_H)$, then $D_{S_0}(b_{T+1}) > 0$ gives $T_{S_0}(b_{T+1}) > b_{T+1} > b_U$, while monotonicity of T_{S_0} and $T_{S_0}(b_H) = b_H$ give $T_{S_0}(b_{T+1}) \leq b_H$. If $b_{T+1} \geq b_H$, monotonicity gives $T_{S_0}(b_{T+1}) \geq b_H > b_U$, and $D_{S_0} \leq 0$ on $[b_H, 1]$ gives $T_{S_0}(b_{T+1}) \leq b_{T+1}$. By induction, $b_t > b_U$ for all $t \geq T + 1$; the path is nondecreasing and bounded above by b_H in the first case, and nonincreasing and bounded below by b_H in the second. If instead $b_{T+1} \in [b_L, b_U)$, then $D_{S_0}(b_{T+1}) \leq 0$ and $T_{S_0}(b_{T+1}) \geq T_{S_0}(b_L) = b_L$, so the path weakly decreases and remains in $[b_L, b_U)$. The paths are monotone and bounded. Under continuity, their limits are fixed points, and the drift signs identify the corresponding limits: b_L is the only zero of the drift in $[b_L, b_U)$, and b_H is the only zero in $(b_U, 1]$. ■

Numerical Illustration

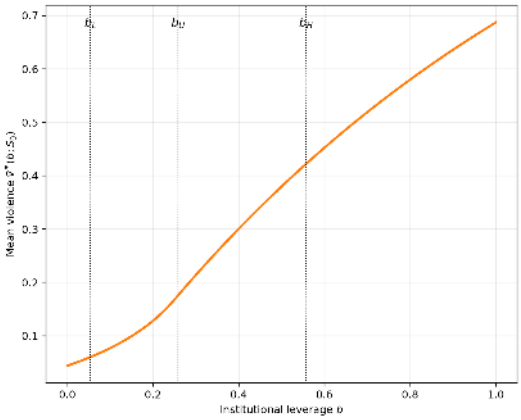
Within-period behavior is the parametric static model above, solved as in the static illustration, with the parameters of Table F.1, chosen to display a low steady state, a threshold, and a high steady state.

The extension is descriptive and does not identify the feedback channel empirically.[54]

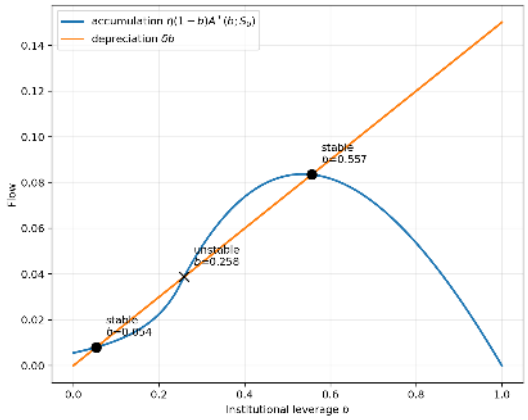
[53] Heterogeneity does not eliminate activation jumps in a finite set of locations.

[54] The feedback is related to models of endogenous institutional change (Acemoglu et al., 2015) and of delegation of violence to aligned actors (Bisin et al., 2026), but differs in that leverage changes the cost of forbearance rather than the government's objective and requires no initial delegation of decision rights.

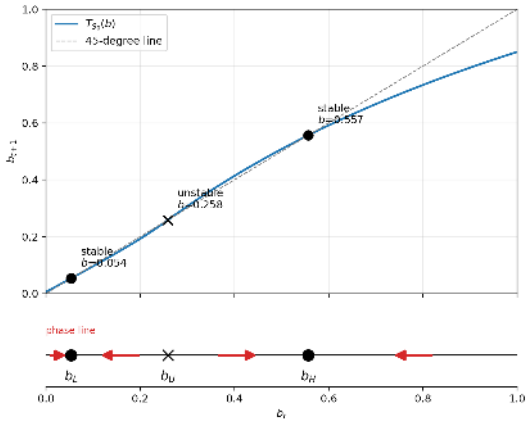
Figure F.2: Dynamic Extension: Feedback, Multiple Steady States, and Temporary Shocks



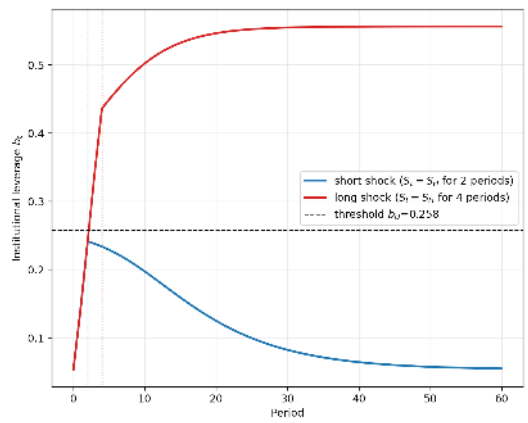
(a) Feedback: violence rises with leverage b



(b) Steady states: accumulation vs. depreciation



(c) Transition map and phase line



(d) Short shock returns toward b_L; long shock tips to b_H

Notes: Stylized illustration of the dynamic extension, not fitted to data. Locations differ only in opportunity E_i, evenly spaced on $[0, 1]$ ($N = 400$). The parameterization (Table F.1) yields steady states $b_L \approx 0.054$ and $b_H \approx 0.557$ separated by a threshold $b_U \approx 0.258$. In Panel (d), a two-period shock returns toward b_L; a four-period shock crosses the threshold and converges to b_H.

Table F.1: Illustrative Parameterizations of the Static and Dynamic Examples

	Static illustration (Figure F.1)	Dynamic illustration (Figure F.2)
Static primitives		
Government internalization λ	0.90	0.90
Return to opportunity θ in $\pi(E_i) = \theta E_i$	1.20	2.00
Enforcement cost L	1	1
Intrinsic payoff r_i	0.81	0.81
Private cost χ in $K_i(v_i) = \chi v_i^2/2$	1	1
Backlash cost γ	1.00	1.00
Forbearance cost c_0 in $c(S) = c_0 e^{-\phi S}$	1.00	2.60
Cost sensitivity ϕ	1	1
Opportunity E_i	1	$(i - \frac{1}{2})/N$
Number of locations N	1	400
Dynamic feedback		
Leverage-to-permissiveness κ	–	1.00
Accumulation η	–	0.30
Depreciation δ	–	0.15
External environment and shocks		
Baseline S_0	0	0
High permissiveness S_H	0.8	0.3
Shock durations T (periods)	–	2 (short), 4 (long)
Bound $\bar{A} = A^*(1; S_H)$	–	≈ 1.252
$\eta\bar{A} + \delta$	–	≈ 0.526
Solution and selection rule		
Government choice	exact comparison of $\{0, \bar{f}_i, \tilde{f}_i, 1\}$	
Tie-breaking	largest maximizer	
Baseline steady states (b_L, b_U, b_H)	–	$\approx (0.054, 0.258, 0.557)$

Notes: $\bar{f}_i$ is the activation threshold (F.3) and $\tilde{f}_i$ the interior stationary point of the active-branch objective when admissible.

G. Methodology for LLM-Assisted Classification

The following prompt was fed to GPT-5-mini and used to classify the violent events in the ACLED dataset:

You are coding violent events in the West Bank for academic research.

Your task is to classify the event described below according to strict definitions. Follow the rules carefully. When information is unclear, apply conservative coding.

EVENT DESCRIPTION:
{event_text}

DEFINITIONS

1) PERPETRATOR

Identify the actor who INITIATED the violent action.

Use ONLY the following categories:

- Palestinian Civilians: individual Palestinians acting without explicit organizational affiliation.
- Palestinian Militias: organized armed groups (e.g., Hamas, Islamic Jihad, Al-Aqsa Martyrs Brigades, etc.). Use ONLY if explicit organizational affiliation is mentioned in the description.
- Israeli Settlers/Civilians: Israeli civilians or settlers acting outside official military structures.
- Israeli Military: IDF soldiers, Israeli security forces, border police, or other officially deployed Israeli forces.
- Palestinian National Authority: official Palestinian Authority security forces.
- Other: actors that clearly do not fall into any of the categories above.

Rules:

- Identify the actor who FIRST initiated the violent action. Initiating actions include, but are not limited to: military raids, arrest operations, airstrikes, shootings, stabbings, stone-throwing, arson, use of explosive devices, physical assault, and destruction of property.

- A military or police raid into an area counts as the initiating action. If the opposing side responds with violence during or immediately after a raid, code the raiding force as the perpetrator.
- If one actor initiates violence and another actor retaliates, ONLY the initiating actor is the perpetrator.
- If affiliation is NOT explicitly stated, assume civilian (not militia).
- Do NOT infer militia status from weapons, organization, tactics, or coordination.

Ambiguous initiation rule:

- If the description clearly involves multiple actors but it is NOT possible to determine who initiated the violence (e.g., "clashes erupted", "both sides exchanged fire"), classify the perpetrator as a COMBINATION of actors involved.
- In that case, include all actor categories mentioned in the description as a list.

Example:
["Israeli Settlers/Civilians", "Palestinian Civilians"]

2) TARGET

Identify the PRIMARY intended target of the attack.

Use the same actor categories listed above.

Rules:

- The target is the group being attacked, NOT actors who retaliate later.
- If multiple actors participate in violence, but the primary target is clear, code the intended target.
- If the target cannot be determined, assign "Other".

3) CASUALTIES

Casualties include BOTH killed and injured individuals.

Rules:

- Count ONLY individuals explicitly reported as killed or injured.
- If no casualties are reported for a group, assign 0.
- Do NOT infer or estimate numbers.

- Do NOT count arrests, detentions, or property damage as casualties.

- If an attacker is killed or injured, count them as a casualty within their own actor category.

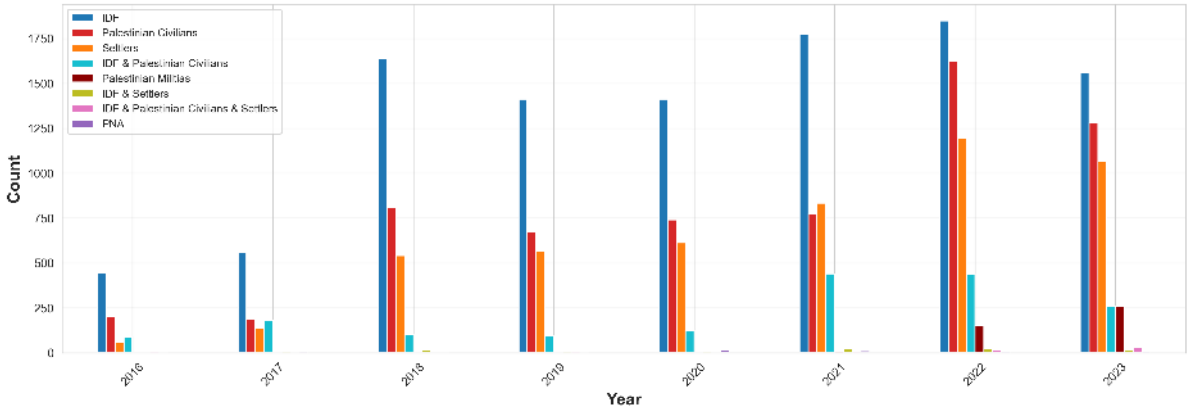
OUTPUT FORMAT

Return ONLY a JSON object that matches the required schema.
Do NOT include explanations or additional text.

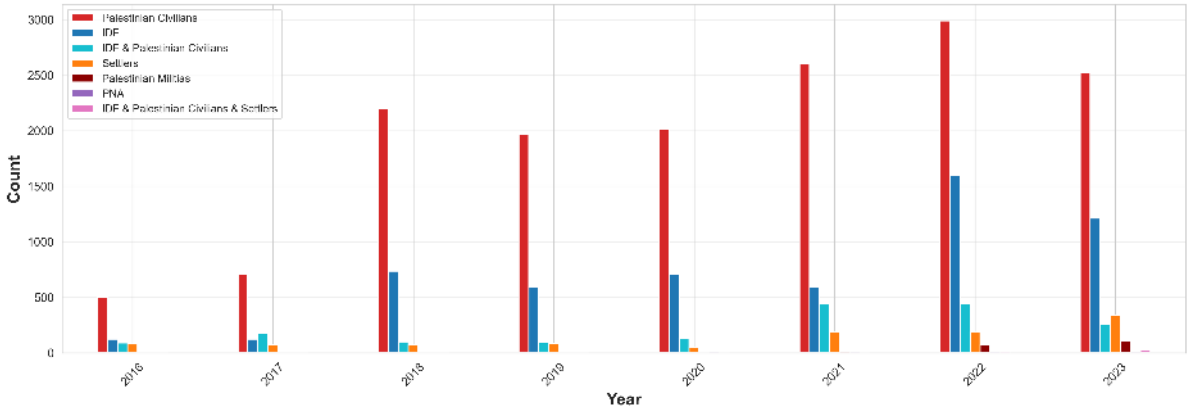
Prior to the main analysis, I perform a deduplication exercise on the ACLED dataset to remove redundant records that correspond to the same real-world incident. The procedure computes sentence-transformer embeddings for all event descriptions and flags same-day pairs that occur within 500 meters of each other and have a cosine similarity above 0.5. Each flagged pair is then verified by GPT-4o-mini, which is asked to judge whether the two records describe the same incident. This yields 147 confirmed duplicate event IDs across the full dataset, which are excluded before constructing the analysis panel.

To validate the classification, I hand-coded a random sample of 200 events, stratified by ACLED sub-event type. Perpetrator accuracy is 98.0% and target accuracy 98.5% (Figures G.3 and G.4). Combination labels, hard to assign even for a human coder, are rare (seven of the 200 events) and kept as their own category.

Figure G.1: Main Actors of Violence in the West Bank



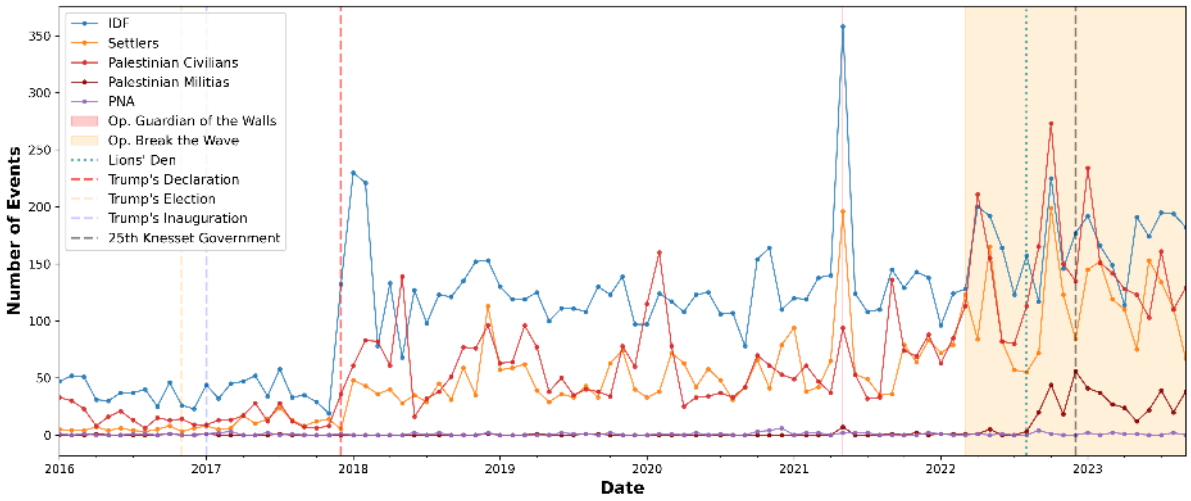
(a) Perpetrators of Violence



(b) Targets of Violence

Notes: Bar charts showing the distribution of violent events by perpetrator and target over time as classified by GPT-5-mini. The graph excludes peaceful protests and actor categories with fewer than 50 events. Source: ACLED (2024b).

Figure G.2: Violence Time Series: Perpetrators and Targets



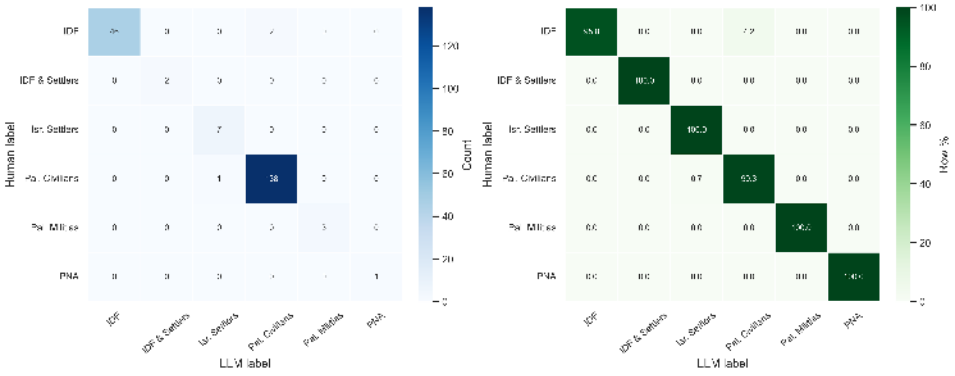
(a) Perpetrators



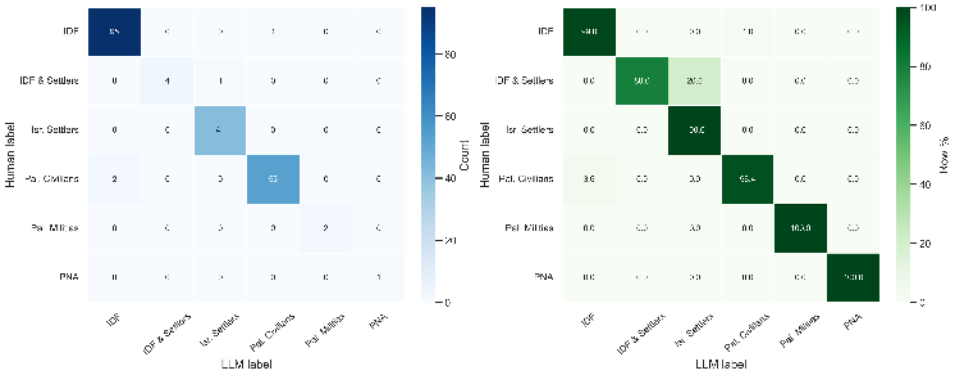
(b) Targets

Notes: Monthly violent events by perpetrator (a) and target (b), as classified by GPT-5-mini (Data section). Dashed lines and shaded areas as in Figure 2.

Figure G.3: Confusion Matrices for Perpetrators and Targets



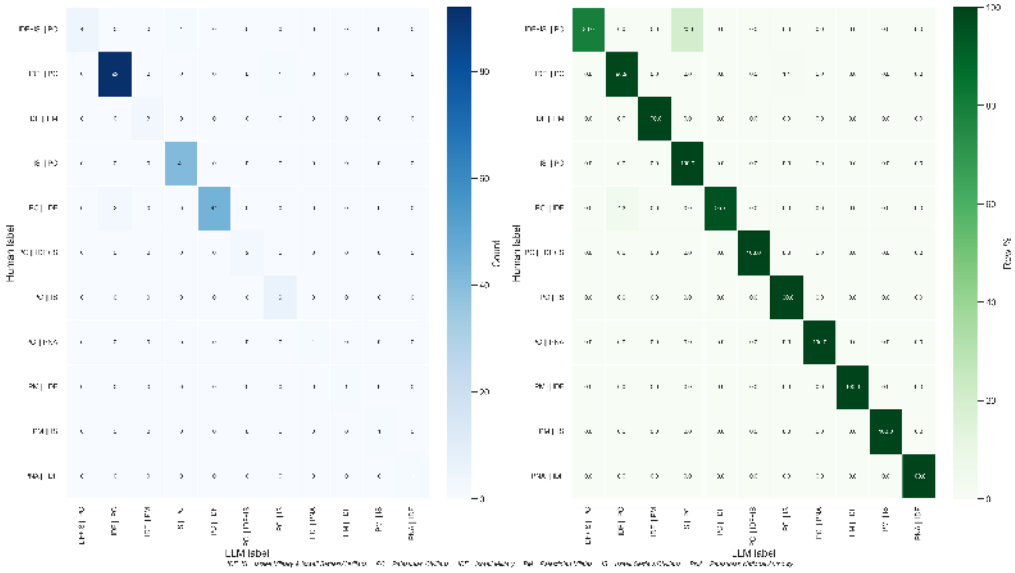
(a) Target



(b) Perpetrator

Notes: Confusion matrices for the classification of targets and perpetrators. Combination labels are shown as their own category.

Figure G.4: Confusion Matrix for Perpetrator–Target Pairs



Notes: Confusion matrix for the joint classification of perpetrator–target pairs. Combination labels are shown as their own category.

H. Political Responses to Settler Violence: Inventory and Coding

Table B.9 gives the nine cases discussed in the Encroachment and Forbearance section and Table H.1 the researched 2014–2019 cases; the full 2014–2019 and 2023 inventories, the ACLED tiers, the evidence matrix (129 rows, one per incident × speaker × stage, with wording and source), and the classification prompt of Appendix I are in a supplementary appendix.

Inventory Fatal incidents are every Palestinian whom B'Tselem records as killed by Israeli civilians or by an unknown Israeli party in the West Bank in 2014–2019 and January–September 2023, plus Abu Khdeir, killed in Jerusalem, in four categories: (1) attacks on uninvolved civilians; (2) killings during demonstrations, confrontations, or under a disputed self-defense claim; (3) killings of Palestinians carrying out, or officially alleged to be carrying out, an attack; (4) uncertain civilian versus security-force attribution. Categories 1 and 2 are researched (Table H.1); 3 and 4 are listed in the supplementary appendix with the reason for exclusion. ACLED covers the West Bank only from 2016, so the fatal cases form the core sample; its settler-perpetrated casualty events are tiered by a keyword rule (supplementary appendix) and the lethal-weapon tier screened event by event: of 25 such events in 2016–2019, five were covered as discrete incidents, none drew a statement from a governing politician, and none led to an arrest.

Sources and coding An incident is publicly visible if covered within 15 days by at least one of a fixed set of Israeli and international outlets, applied identically in both periods. Statements by Netanyahu, Bennett, Shaked, Smotrich, and Ben Gvir and by the prime, defense, justice, and public-security ministers were collected for the first 15 days after the attack, for 15 days after the first arrest or indictment, and as dated follow-up, from the same outlets, official archives, and social media, in English and Hebrew; other actors are recorded separately. Statements are coded as condemnation, demand for investigation or punishment, appeal for restraint only, minimization, redirection to Palestinian violence, justification, or opposition to enforcement, with institutional action recorded separately. "No statement located in the specified sources and window" is not treated as proof that none was made.

Table H.1: Inventory of Palestinians Killed by Israeli Civilians, 2014–2019, Researched Cases

Date	Victim	Place	Circumstances (B'Tselem description, abridged)
2014-07-02	Muhammad Abu Khdeir	Shuafat	Abducted in Shuafat and burned alive in the Jerusalem Forest by Yosef Haim Ben-David (Adam/Geva Binyamin) and two minors; convicted [. . .]
2014-07-25	Khaled 'Azmi Khaled 'Odeh	Huwarah	Shot by a settler driving along the Huwarah road where a protest march against the military's actions in Operation Protective Edge was [. . .]
2015-07-31	Riham Hussein Hassan Dawabsheh	Duma	Fatally wounded when her house was torched. Her 18-month-old son was burnt to death.
2015-07-31	Sa'ed Muhammad Hassan Dawabsheh	Duma	Fatally wounded when his house was torched. His 18-month-old son was burnt to death and his wife and young son seriously wounded.
2015-07-31	'Ali Sa'ed Muhammad Dawabsheh	Duma	Killed when his house was torched. His parents and brother were seriously wounded in the fire.
2017-05-18	Mu'taz Hussein Hilal Bani Shamsah	Huwarah	Shot to death by a settler who drove into the town of Huwara and found himself in the middle of a demonstration.
2017-11-30	Mahmoud Ahmad Zaa'l 'Odeh	Qusrah	Shot in the torso by a settler while on his own farmland in the village.
2018-10-12	'Aishah Muhammad Talal Rabi	Rehelim	Killed by a stone thrown from the direction of the settlement Rechelim at the car she was riding in with her husband and daughter on [. . .]
2019-01-26	Hamdi Taleb Sa'adah Na'asan	al-Mughayir	Hit in the back by settlers' gunfire.
2019-04-03	Muhammad 'Abd al-Mun'im Muhammad 'Abd al-Fatah	Huwarah	Critically injured by shots that two Israeli settlers fired as he crouched between dumpsters by Route 60, after he threw stones at [. . .]

Notes: Entries in B'Tselem's fatality database with "killed by: Israeli civilians" or "unknown Israeli party" and event location in the West Bank (including East Jerusalem), plus Muhammad Abu Khdeir, whose killing B'Tselem records under Jerusalem, restricted to the two researched categories: attacks on uninvolved civilians, and killings during a demonstration, confrontation, or under a disputed self-defense claim. The remaining entries, Palestinians killed while carrying out, or officially alleged to be carrying out, an attack, or with uncertain civilian versus security-force attribution, are listed in the supplementary appendix; they are excluded because the state's enforcement decision is not at issue or the perpetrator's identity is unknown. ACLED-only fatal events, almost all vehicle run-overs of unverified intent, are counted in the supplementary appendix.

I. Knesset Speeches Annotation and Classification

Figures I.1–I.3 show the events and speech counts, the relationship categories, and the raw bloc-level shares.

Input data and event windows Each fatality event (date, perpetrator and target group, short summary) is matched to the speeches delivered within the following 15 days, $t_e < t_s \leq t_e + 15$. A speech can fall in several windows, so classification is at the speech–event level.

Pass 1: topic-relevance filtering Before focal-event classification, I first pass each speech to GPT-4o-mini, asking it to assess whether the speech discusses physical violence between Israelis and Palestinians. If the speech is not relevant to the topic, it is excluded from further analysis.

Pass 2: focal-event classification The second pass applies GPT-5-mini to the English translation of each topic-relevant speech–event pair. The system prompt, with its calibration rules and worked examples, is reproduced verbatim in the supplementary appendix.

Coded outcomes The model answers yes or no to four questions for each pair. *Focal or same-pair*: the speech is substantively about the focal killing or another concrete killing of the same type (settler-on-Palestinian or Palestinian-on-settler). *Condemnation*: the speech is focal or same-pair and explicitly condemns, in moral terms, those who carried out the killing. After a settler-perpetrated killing these are settlers, Israeli civilians, or the state, not the army or police; criticizing the state's negligence or double standards does not count. *Enforcement*: the speech is focal or same-pair and demands action against the same perpetrators, such as investigation, arrest, prosecution, or punishment. *Opposite-side attention*: the speech refers to concrete violent events by the other side, that is, Palestinian attacks on Israelis after a settler-perpetrated killing, and settler, civilian, or state violence against Palestinians after a Palestinian-perpetrated killing; it need not be focal.

Aggregation The outcomes are event–bloc shares $Y_{eg}^k = C_{eg}^k / N_{eg}$, where C_{eg}^k counts the speeches with feature k and N_{eg} the topic-relevant speeches of bloc g in the window of event e. Cells with $N_{eg} = 0$ are dropped.

Human validation A validation sample of 241 speech–event pairs was coded by hand from the English translations, blind to the model's labels. Table I.1 reports the agreement: the two codings coincide on 79–96 percent of pairs, and the F1 score is 0.63–

0.77 for focal mention, condemnation, enforcement, and opposite-side attention. The key cell, Right-bloc condemnation after a Palestinian is killed by a settler, is zero in both codings.

Event–bloc regressions I aggregate to the event × bloc level and estimate

$$\begin{aligned} Y_{eg} = \alpha_e + \delta_R Right_g + \delta_A Arab_g \\ + \beta_R \left(Right_g \times SettlerPerp_e\right) + \beta_A \left(Arab_g \times SettlerPerp_e\right) + \nu_{eg}, \end{aligned} \tag{I.1}$$

where Y_{eg} is the share of topic-relevant speeches with a given feature in event e and bloc g and $SettlerPerp_e$ equals one when the perpetrator is a settler. Event fixed effects compare blocs responding to the same fatality; the omitted bloc is Center-left, so β_R and β_A test whether the Right and Arab gaps change when the perpetrator is a settler. Standard errors are clustered by event; Panel B of each table reports the implied gaps at settler-perpetrator events, and even columns let bloc differences vary across Knesset terms. Right-bloc speeches condemn the perpetrator less and redirect attention more when the perpetrator is a settler (Table I.2): the Right × settler-perpetrator interaction is −0.19 for condemnation and +0.23 for opposite-side attention. For enforcement it is −0.04 and not statistically significant. The pattern survives bloc-by-Knesset-term controls and non-overlapping event samples (Table I.3).

Table I.1: Human Validation of the Speech Classification

	N	Human = 1	Model = 1	Agreement	F1
Focal or same-pair	241	39	49	0.92	0.77
Condemnation	241	15	28	0.94	0.65
Enforcement	241	13	14	0.96	0.67
Opposite-side attention	241	54	82	0.79	0.63

Notes: The table compares the model labels with the human coding of the 241 speech–event pairs coded in the stratified validation sample; *Human = 1* and *Model = 1* are the numbers of positive codes, *Agreement* the share of pairs with the same code, and *F1* the harmonic mean of precision and recall, taking the human code as the reference.

Table I.2: Fatalities and Knesset Speeches

	Focal/Same-Pair		Condemnation		Enforcement		Opp. Side Attention	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
Panel A: Main effects and interactions								
Right	0.093*		0.113***		0.039		−0.113**	
	(0.047)		(0.035)		(0.027)		(0.048)	
Arab	−0.175***		−0.102***		−0.054***		0.467***	
	(0.035)		(0.024)		(0.015)		(0.045)	
Right × Settler perp.	−0.160**	−0.139	−0.188***	−0.164**	−0.043	−0.045	0.232***	0.237***
	(0.079)	(0.088)	(0.069)	(0.071)	(0.027)	(0.027)	(0.075)	(0.071)
Arab × Settler perp.	0.233***	0.259***	0.115	0.148**	0.076***	0.074***	−0.944***	−0.940***
	(0.081)	(0.069)	(0.072)	(0.058)	(0.019)	(0.017)	(0.078)	(0.068)
Panel B: Implied bloc gaps at settler-perpetrator events								
Right gap	−0.067	−0.078	−0.076	−0.087*	−0.004	−0.002	0.119**	0.125**
(Implied gap, settler perp.)	(0.063)	(0.058)	(0.059)	(0.051)	(0.004)	(0.008)	(0.057)	(0.057)
Arab gap	0.058	0.047	0.013	0.002	0.021*	0.023**	−0.477***	−0.471***
(Implied gap, settler perp.)	(0.073)	(0.063)	(0.068)	(0.052)	(0.012)	(0.011)	(0.064)	(0.061)
Observations	169	169	169	169	169	169	169	169
Events	58	58	58	58	58	58	58	58
R^2	0.526	0.627	0.483	0.654	0.611	0.688	0.850	0.874
Event FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Knesset × Bloc		✓		✓		✓		✓

Notes: The unit of observation is an event × bloc-group cell. Outcomes are shares of topic-relevant speeches in the 15-day post-event window; coefficients are proportions, so 0.10 corresponds to 10 percentage points. The omitted bloc is Center-left. *Right* includes Right, Far Right, Religious Zionist, and Orthodox blocs; *Arab* includes Arab party lists. Unknown bloc affiliation is dropped. Odd columns report the baseline specification with event fixed effects. Even columns add bloc-by-Knesset-term controls, allowing baseline gaps to vary across parliamentary terms. *Settler perp.* equals one when the perpetrator is a settler (i.e. a Palestinian was killed by a settler) and zero when the perpetrator is Palestinian (i.e. a settler was killed by a Palestinian). Main effects in odd columns therefore report bloc gaps at Palestinian-perpetrator events, and the interaction terms report how these gaps change at settler-perpetrator events. Panel B reports the implied bloc gaps at settler-perpetrator events; in even columns these are averaged over settler-perpetrator events using the event's Knesset-specific baseline gap. Standard errors are clustered by fatality event; Panel B standard errors use the delta method. $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

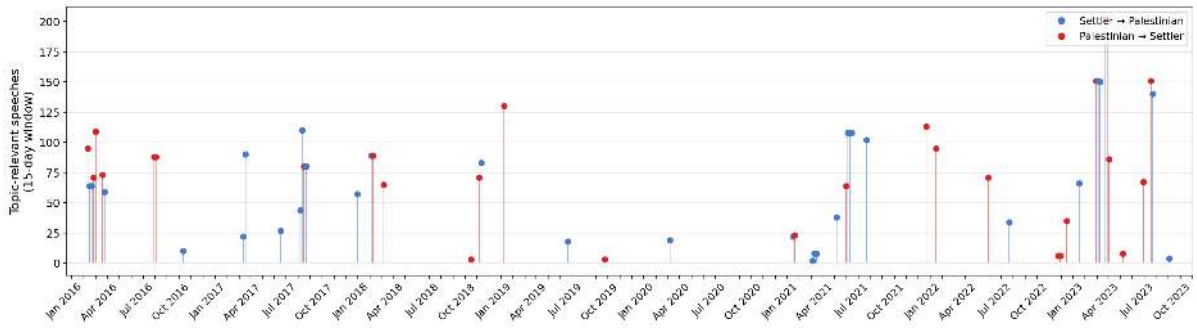
Table I.3: Fatalities and Knesset Speeches — Non-Overlapping Events

	Focal/Same-Pair		Condemnation		Enforcement		Opp. Side Attention	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)	(7)	(8)
Panel A: Non-overlapping events (>15-day gap, 34 events)								
Right	0.053		0.087**		0.019		−0.099*	
	(0.053)		(0.041)		(0.032)		(0.057)	
Arab	−0.179***		−0.092***		−0.051**		0.461***	
	(0.049)		(0.029)		(0.021)		(0.061)	
Right × Settler perp.	−0.036	−0.030	−0.088**	−0.083*	−0.018	−0.012	0.205*	0.273**
	(0.068)	(0.074)	(0.042)	(0.043)	(0.033)	(0.034)	(0.108)	(0.107)
Arab × Settler perp.	0.308***	0.280***	0.185***	0.184***	0.069**	0.065**	−0.953***	−0.854***
	(0.066)	(0.067)	(0.044)	(0.034)	(0.030)	(0.026)	(0.122)	(0.113)
Right gap, settler perp.	0.017	0.015	−0.000	−0.005	0.001	0.001	0.106	0.091
	(0.044)	(0.040)	(0.010)	(0.010)	(0.005)	(0.010)	(0.091)	(0.071)
Arab gap, settler perp.	0.128***	0.127***	0.093**	0.088***	0.017	0.017	−0.491***	−0.506***
	(0.045)	(0.041)	(0.034)	(0.021)	(0.021)	(0.017)	(0.106)	(0.085)
Observations	97	97	97	97	97	97	97	97
Events	34	34	34	34	34	34	34	34
R^2	0.681	0.731	0.678	0.763	0.584	0.649	0.831	0.883
Event FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Knesset × Bloc		✓		✓		✓		✓
Panel B: Non-overlapping events (>30-day gap, 30 events)								
Right	0.119**		0.127**		0.049		−0.105	
	(0.058)		(0.051)		(0.034)		(0.073)	
Arab	−0.121***		−0.073**		−0.039**		0.418***	
	(0.039)		(0.028)		(0.017)		(0.064)	
Right × Settler perp.	−0.105	−0.096	−0.125**	−0.110*	−0.050	−0.032	0.229*	0.307**
	(0.073)	(0.089)	(0.051)	(0.058)	(0.035)	(0.034)	(0.120)	(0.124)
Arab × Settler perp.	0.248***	0.210***	0.158***	0.156***	0.058**	0.057**	−0.896***	−0.797***
	(0.060)	(0.054)	(0.044)	(0.034)	(0.028)	(0.026)	(0.126)	(0.110)
Right gap, settler perp.	0.015	0.014	0.003	0.001	−0.001	0.000	0.124	0.110
	(0.044)	(0.042)	(0.007)	(0.013)	(0.006)	(0.013)	(0.096)	(0.072)
Arab gap, settler perp.	0.127***	0.126***	0.085**	0.083***	0.018	0.020	−0.477***	−0.492***
	(0.045)	(0.034)	(0.034)	(0.022)	(0.022)	(0.019)	(0.108)	(0.085)
Observations	85	85	85	85	85	85	85	85
Events	30	30	30	30	30	30	30	30
R^2	0.676	0.760	0.678	0.786	0.598	0.704	0.824	0.884
Event FE	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Knesset × Bloc		✓		✓		✓		✓

Notes: Same specification as Table I.2, estimated on non-overlapping event samples. Events are sorted chronologically; an event is retained only if it occurs more than N days after the last retained event (Panel A: $N = 15$; Panel B: $N = 30$). Within each panel, odd columns report the baseline specification with event fixed effects; even columns add bloc-by-Knesset-term controls. The omitted category is Center-left. *Right* includes Right, Far Right, Religious Zionist, and Orthodox blocs; *Arab* includes Arab party lists. *Settler perp.* equals one when the perpetrator is a settler and zero when the perpetrator is Palestinian. Implied gaps report the total bloc differential at settler-perpetrator events; in even columns these are averaged over Knesset terms weighted by the share of settler-perpetrator events in each term. Standard errors (in parentheses) are clustered by fatality event; implied-gap standard errors use the delta method. $^{*}p < 0.10$, $^{**}p < 0.05$, $^{***}p < 0.01$.

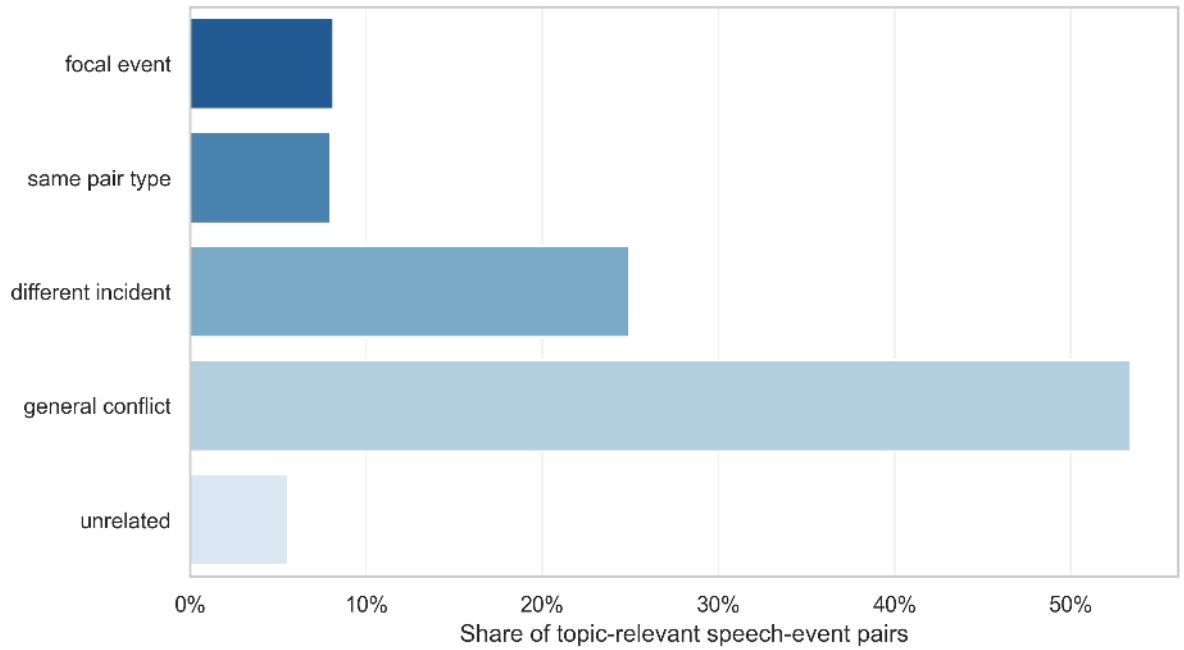
Figures and Tables

Figure I.1: Fatalities and Knesset Speeches



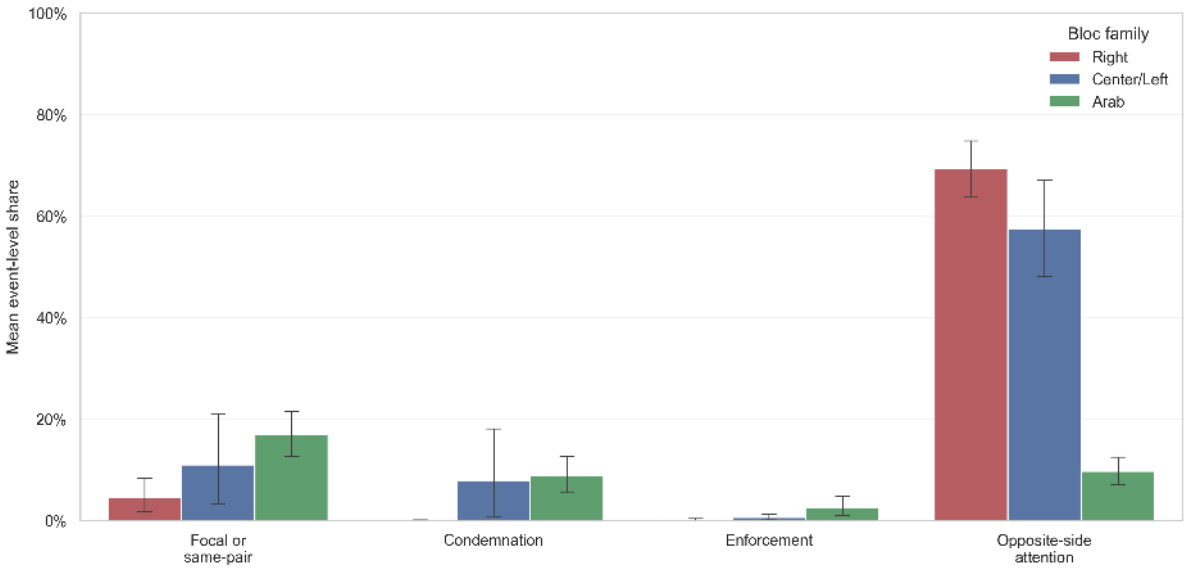
Notes: Fatalities over time in the West Bank and number of relevant speeches in the Knesset about said events, by perpetrator side. The figure only considers events in which Palestinians killed settlers or vice versa. The y-axis is the number of relevant speeches on political violence in the West Bank in a 15-day window from every single event. The speeches need not speak explicitly about the specific event.

Figure I.2: LLM Output: Relationship to Focal Event Categories

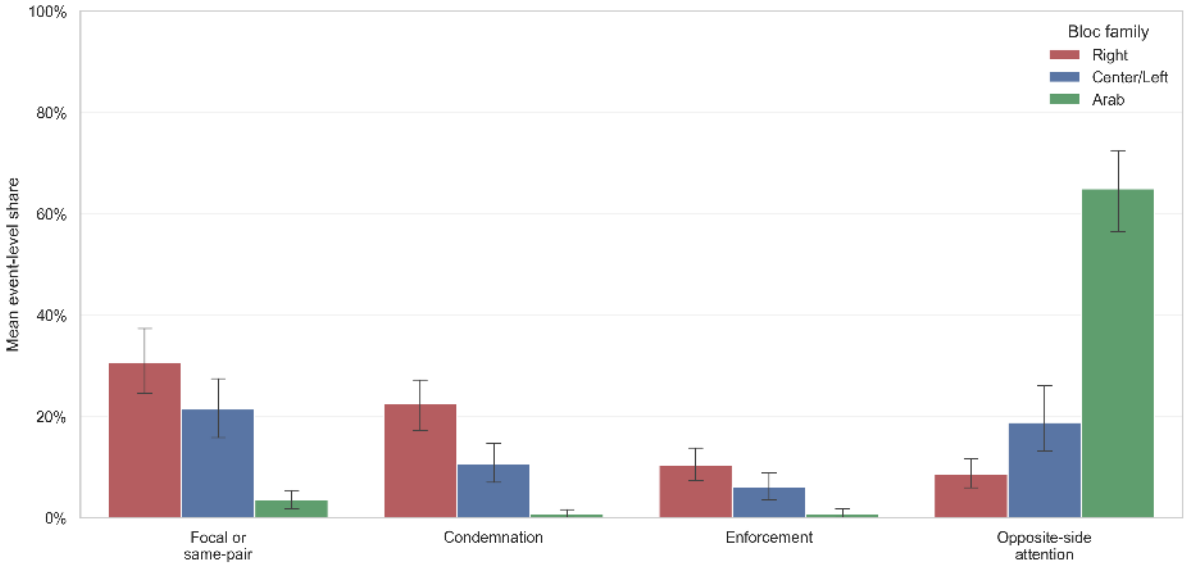


Notes: Distribution of LLM-classified mutually exclusive relationship categories of the filtered speeches. They can be classified as: 1) focal event, 2) same pair type, 3) different incident, 4) general conflict, and 5) unrelated.

Figure I.3: Selective Accountability



(a) After Palestinians Are Killed by Settlers



(b) After Settlers Are Killed by Palestinians

Notes: Mean event-level share of LLM-classified accountability categories in Knesset speeches following violent events, by political bloc (Right, Center/Left, Arab). Categories: focal or same-pair, strict condemnation of the focal perpetrator side, strict enforcement demand against it, and opposite-side attention. Error bars indicate 95% confidence intervals.

Table I.4: Israeli Knesset parties classified by political bloc

Right	**Center**	**Arab**
Ahi	Blue and White	Arab Democratic Party
Aliyah – Our People for a Renewed Israel	Gesher	Arab National Party
Tzomet	Center Party	Ta'al
Derekh Eretz	Yiud	Hadash–Ta'al
Herut – The National Movement	Gil (Pensioners' Party)	Balad
Independent MK Amichai Chikli	Kulanu	National Unity – National Progressive Alliance
Yisrael BaAliyah	Kadima	Ra'am–Ta'al
Yamin Yisrael	Shinui	United Arab List
Likud	The Movement	Joint List
National Union – Yisrael Beiteinu	National Unity	Joint List – Balad
New Hope	The Third Way	**Religious Zionist**
Yamina	Yesh Atid	National Religious Party
Yisrael Beiteinu	Yesh Atid–Telem	National Union
Far Right	**Left**	The Jewish Home
Moledet	Independence	**Orthodox**
Jewish Power	Labor	Agudat Yisrael
Strength for Israel	Labor–Meretz	Degel HaTorah
	One Nation	Independent MK Yosef Ba-Gad
	Meretz	Shas
	The Democratic Choice	United Torah Judaism
	Mapai	**Far Left**
		Hadash

Notes: Bloc–party classification as in Goldin et al. (2025).